

*Sponsorship, Service and Self-support
in a Changing World*

**THE FIFTY-SIXTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

*2006
Final Report*

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Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



56th GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE “Sponsorship, Service and Self-Support in a Changing World”

“Because we set such a high value on our great liberties, and cannot conceive a time when they will need to be limited, we here specially enjoin our General Service Conference to abstain completely from any and all acts of authoritative government which could in any wise curtail A.A.’s freedom under God. The maintenance of these freedoms in our Conference is a great and practical guarantee that the Conference itself will always remain democratic in action and in spirit.

“Therefore we expect that our Conferences will always try to act in the spirit of mutual respect and love — one member for another. In turn, this sign signifies that mutual trust should prevail; that no action ought to be taken in anger, haste, or recklessness; that care will be observed to respect and protect all minorities; that no action should ever be personally punitive; that whenever possible, important actions will be taken in substantial unanimity; and that our Conference will ever be prudently on guard against tyrannies, great or small, whether these be found in the majority or in the minority.”

With co-founder Bill W.’s words from Concept XII in mind, the 56th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada was held at the Crowne Plaza Times Square, April 23-29. The 136 members who make up the General Service Conference consist of delegates from the 93 service areas, Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees, and

directors and staff of the two corporations—A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Chairing this year’s Conference were Leonard Blumenthal (nonalcoholic) chairman of the board; Greg Muth, G.S.O.’s general manager; and Michael Scott, delegate chairperson. Rick Walker, G.S.O. staff, was Conference coordinator. Throughout, the Conference was ably assisted by staff and support personnel of the General Service and Grapevine offices.

The Conference officially opened Sunday afternoon with the roll call, followed by Greetings from Michael Scott, delegate chair, and the Keynote address, delivered by Robert Pelot, Eastern Canada regional trustee.

Guests observing at this year’s Conference were Valerie Martin, general manager of G.S.O. Australia, and Noriaki Nozaki, general manager of G.S.O. Japan.

At the open A.A. meeting that followed the Sunday evening dinner, Keith Hashimoto (Hawaii) chaired. The meeting was led by Gail Lee (Virginia) and speakers were: Meri Ray (Northern Indiana), Mike Nelson (North Dakota), George Martin (A.A.W.S. director), Gayle Solheim Riese (G.S.O. staff), and Howard Lowery (trustee).

This June marks the 10th anniversary of La Viña, the Spanish-language magazine equivalent of the A.A. Grapevine. On Monday afternoon, Hernán Merea, editor of La Viña, spoke on the history

of the magazine and plans for its future. The presentation was followed by the traditional anniversary cake with 10 candles.

Throughout the busy week Conference sessions began at 9:00 a.m. and often continued to 9:00 p.m. or beyond. There were presentation/discussion sessions (including one on this year's Conference theme, "Sponsorship, Service and Self-support in a Changing World"), reports, area service highlights, and "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions.

However, the major work of the Conference takes place during the meetings and deliberations of the eleven standing Conference committees. Delegates review background material on items forwarded to them, and any resulting committee recommendations are presented to the entire Conference for a vote. Thus the group conscience of the Fellowship results in Conference Advisory Actions. (Highlights of Actions appear on page 3.)

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected two new regional trustees. Madeline Parmley of Pocatello, Idaho will succeed Phyllis Halliday, as the Pacific regional trustee, and Denis Vezina of Brossard, Québec will follow Robert Pelot as Eastern Canada's trustee. The new general service trustee, who will serve as a director on the A.A.W.S. Board, will be Jane Sheppard, of Beasley, Texas.

Darryl Miller, Kentucky, will be the delegate chairperson for the 2007 Conference; Pat Long, Alberta/NWT, will be alternate chair.

Among the many activities during the week, New York Intergroup Association hosted a hospitality suite on Saturday, before the official Sunday opening, where early-arriving Conference members could get together for fellowship and coffee, greeting old friends and meeting new ones.

From Monday to Friday at 7:30 a.m., the G.S.C. Serenity Group held an open A.A. meeting, with topics based on readings from A.A. literature. The meetings were chaired by Bill Ciccaroni (SE New York); Mark Cruz (Illinois, Chicago) was secretary treasurer.

Tuesday afternoon Conference members and their guests visited the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices.

Throughout the week volunteer A.A. members led tours of the city for the approximately 85 guests (many were A.A.s or Al-Anons) who had accompanied Conference members to New York. A Circle Line boat trip around Manhattan Island and a tour of NBC studios were among the activities.

Friday afternoon the Conference officially closed with the Serenity Prayer, led by Patricia Roy in French, Francisco Almada in Spanish, Chip Berkley in English, and Noriaki Nozaki in Japanese.

Conference members met once more Saturday morning for the closing brunch. Farewell talks were given by rotating trustees

Phyllis Halliday, Robert Pelot and Ron Gauthier (general service trustee). Following the brunch, delegates boarded mini-buses for a trip to Bedford Hills, New York, to visit Stepping Stones, the home of Bill W. and his wife, Lois — a nice ending to this Conference experience.

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

It is an honor and privilege to serve as your delegate chair and I welcome you to the 56th General Service Conference. I look forward to working with you on this very moving and spiritual experience. This week will be very busy; we will start early and often finish late into the night. It may, at times, be tedious and confusing as we seek our Higher Power's will for our Fellowship as a whole. In the end, we will look back and see it come together. We will see how a power greater than ourselves can take recovering drunks from across two great countries and guide them in one of the most spiritual experiences that can be shared in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Last year, as I sat here, I knew that God had selected me, since my name was drawn out of the hat for delegate. I prepared the best I could by speaking with past delegates and my regional trustee. I studied background material, *The A.A. Service Manual*, Advisory Actions, and Conference Reports, but in true alcoholic fashion, I still felt inadequate. Like most newcomers to A.A., I just wanted to fade into the background. In spite of all I did to get ready, nothing could prepare me for the experience of the General Service Conference. As the week progressed, I had a very deep sense of being a part of the history of Alcoholics Anonymous. I was in awe of the process and in awe of being part of the process. I welcome and invite each of you to share that experience with me this week.

The theme of this year's General Service Conference is "Sponsorship, Service and Self-support in a Changing World." At the risk of being egotistical, I think a fourth word beginning with the letter "S" should be included: Spirituality. In this digital age of laptop computers, cell phones, pagers, MP3s, etc., it is often difficult to find the time to unplug and spend time with a Higher Power in pursuit of the spiritual instead of the material. A.A. is not a journey of collecting, but rather a journey of being and doing: being restored to sanity and being useful; doing the next right thing and doing the responsibilities set before me. I am reminded of the words on pages 124-125 of *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*. In Step Twelve it says, "True ambition is not what we thought it was. True ambition is the deep desire to live usefully and walk humbly under the grace of God." This is how I try to live.

Last year, at the Delegates Only dinner, we had the selection for this year's delegate chair and alternate. I was most surprised at the outcome because I wasn't seeking to be a leader of prominence. Someone sitting across the table from me said that I didn't look like a deer caught in the headlights, but rather a deer hit head-on by the headlights. My question was, as it so often is, "Why me, God?" The answer is simple. Once again I was willing to serve and this service is the path my Higher Power selected. We are each here today because this is our Higher Power's path for each of us. We are here because we are a service people. We are here to help the still-suffering alcoholic. We are here to lead by example, of words and actions, so that a new G.S.R. somewhere will want what we have and follow our path to get it. We are here to receive so that we may give. This is the spiritual part for me.

I have had to work and live the Steps, Traditions and Concepts more as a delegate than I ever have before. I have learned that



being a delegate is what I do for the Fellowship and not who I am. I was told upon my election as delegate that, "God doesn't always elect the qualified, but He does qualify the elected," and I have taken great comfort in this statement. I have learned at a deeper level that I am right where I am supposed to be. I have had to take a spiritual journey in trusting my Higher Power by doing the job of delegate. I have had to learn to trust Him more deeply than ever before by learning to trust the group conscience, trust the committee process, and trust the Conference as a whole. I have had to accept that I do not have all the answers and learn to listen and trust each of you. I don't believe that my journey of delegate is much different from any of yours. In welcoming you, I want to remind each of you that the job of delegate and the General Service Conference this week is a spiritual journey. A spiritual journey of trusting each other and trusting our Higher Power.

I would like to extend a special welcome to our Class A (non-alcoholic) trustees, who adopt our program, not out of necessity as the rest of us drunks do, but voluntarily. I can only guess that this experience is just as confusing at times and spiritual for them as it is for us. I deeply appreciate all that they give to our Fellowship. A final welcome to the G.S.O. and Grapevine employees, both alcoholic and nonalcoholic, who support this Conference and our whole Fellowship, both this Conference week and throughout the entire year. I am greatly impressed with their many years of loyalty and devotion to Alcoholics Anonymous.

The job of delegate is not the end of the line. It is merely another step along the path of sobriety. Some sitting here today will go on to serve our Fellowship as trustee, but each of us will rotate into some other service position, because that is who we are. We are a service people doing God's work and we will carry the message of sponsorship, service and self-support into a changing world.

Let me again welcome each of you here. When I realized that as delegate chair I would be giving this welcome, in alcoholic grandiosity I wanted it to be the best, most inspirational greeting ever. But, instead, I hope I have simply done as my Higher Power would have me do. I have shared with you some of my lessons of serving as delegate. As with each step in sobriety, I am grateful for the new friends, now extending across North America, I have made along the way. I hope each of you finds your delegate experience as rewarding as I have. I thank God for Alcoholics Anonymous and my sobriety. Thank you for allowing me to serve as your delegate chair for this 56th General Service Conference.

Michael Scott, North Florida

Keynote

My name is Bob Pelot and I am an alcoholic. It is a great privilege for me to have been asked to give the Keynote Address at our 56th General Service Conference. Our Conference theme this year is "Sponsorship, Service and Self-support in a Changing World." To be completely honest with you, I feel a little nervous—not of speaking on this subject, but to put it in writing. There is so much to say in such a short period. There are no doubt a lot of different opinions on the subject, but my presentation will be based on some of my personal experiences as well as A.A. literature.

Sponsorship: Going back to the autumn of 1934, Bill wrote, "Let's begin with my own sponsor, Ebby. When Ebby heard how serious my drinking was, he resolved to visit me. He was in New York; I was in Brooklyn. His resolve was not enough; he had to *take action* and *spend money*. He called me on the phone and then got into the subway; total cost, ten cents. At the level of the telephone booth and subway turnstile, spirituality and money began to mix. One without the other would have amounted to nothing

at all. Right then and there, Ebby established the principle that A.A. in action calls for the sacrifice of much time and a little money." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, pp. 140-141)

When I arrived in A.A., and attended my first A.A. meeting, I heard the word "sponsor" and found it quite ridiculous to hear grownups talking about this. I quickly realized that this only meant one alcoholic talking to another, helping him work his way through the Steps, to be available whenever things went wrong, or to simply share. In reading my A.A. material, it was clear how Bill was able to stay sober when in Akron. He realized that if he didn't find another alcoholic to talk with, he would start drinking again—thus his eventual meeting with Dr. Bob and the founding of our lifesaving Fellowship. A number of years later, sponsoring took another route when Bill starting making trips to Europe and saw how A.A. had taken a foothold, and would be able to continue and grow by country-to-country sponsorship. When I was D.C.M., back in 1991, a G.S.R. from another district was wondering why there was literature about sponsorship for sobriety, but no literature for "Service Sponsorship." He brought the idea to his district meeting and, following the usual channels, the 44th General Service Conference agreed that a section on "Service Sponsorship" should be added to the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship." Sponsorship takes several forms—from providing literature, the way Mexico does for Cuba, to sponsoring attendance at Zonal meetings, the way Japan helps Mongolia. The U.S. and Canada sponsor the Dominican Republic and underwrite the surplus expenses for the World Service Meeting.

On the subject of *Services*: The opening sentence of the chapter "Working With Others" in the Big Book reads, "Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics." And Dr. Bob's version of the importance of service is "Faith without works is dead." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 188)

The first service "job" I took was mopping the floor after the meeting. A little hard on my ego at the beginning—you see, I had an "important job" with an international corporation, and mopping floors was not exactly the type of profession I was accustomed to. However, one night after the meeting, I was passing the mop and I asked two members who were talking to move a little as there was coffee on the floor where they stood. One of the members looked at me and smiled and said "thank you." I can still picture that scene and remember what went through my mind—receiving a smile and a "thank you" for doing something so simple! I was convinced there and then of the importance of being involved in service work. I understood what Bill W. meant when he wrote that previously mentioned sentence and it was explained to me that most of the answers to my questions could be found in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

I got in the habit of writing to our General Service Office when I had a question I felt was important. It never took more than two weeks for an answer, and they really appreciated receiving questions. I also learned to move forward, one step at a time, and to take group service positions one at a time, first alternate G.S.R., then G.S.R. Then I let my name stand as alternate D.C.M., and D.C.M., and alternate delegate. In 1995, I let my name stand as delegate and was elected Northwest Québec's delegate to the 46th General Service Conference. I felt that I could not have fulfilled my delegate's function adequately had I not done the previous jobs, which had helped me understand some of the problems that D.C.M.s were having. I was able to make useful suggestions, having experienced some of the same problems. It is the same principle as one alcoholic talking to another, and most important, being part of a group conscience.

I would like to share with you an event from 1994, which without any doubt confirmed what "I am responsible" means to me.

I became involved in working with the native population the previous year, and was invited to a meeting in a prison in the northern part of my area. Present were a judge, several police officers, social workers, counselors from a treatment centre, our delegate, our Remote Communities representative and myself. The judge was sharing about the problems with alcohol, specifically with the Inuit population of Northern Québec. As he was leaving, he turned and looked at us and said, "I hope A.A. doesn't let us down this time." I assured him we wouldn't. Since October 1996, I and several other A.A. members have held weekly meetings for these people in a local prison, as well as a Federal Correctional Institution. Although I will be rotating at the end of this Conference, I don't have to worry about being unemployed.

And finally, *Self-support in a Changing World*: Is the world changing? We live in a world of constantly changing technology. There's not a day goes by that some new communication system isn't placed on the market and we must adapt to it. Did I adhere to this at the beginning? Definitely not. As a matter of fact, when I was delegate the question was raised here at the Conference about including online groups in the U.S./Canada meeting lists and intergroups. I was against it. An alcoholic had to come to a meeting to get sober—the type of alcoholic who spills the coffee all over himself and on the floor at his first meetings. Sometime later, my sponsor shared with me an experience he had had while flying to New York to a board meeting. He was reading his Twelve and Twelve when the man next to him asked if he was a friend of Bill, and my sponsor replied yes. The man said that he had come home one night drunk to find all the furniture gone. His wife had left and taken everything. The only thing left was his worktable and computer. He doesn't remember much after that, except that he woke up on the floor and the computer was on and indicated he had received quite a few messages. They were from alcoholics from different parts of the country who had suggested that he go to A.A., which he did and he had been sober now for two years.

Self-support: We can thank Mr. Rockefeller for refusing to give Bill W. a large amount of money. On p. 184 in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, it reads. "Gentlemen, you can all see that this is a work of good will. Its power lies in the fact that one member carries the good message to the next, without any thought of financial income or reward. Therefore, it is our belief that Alcoholics Anonymous should be self-supporting so far as money is concerned. It needs only our good will." Do we need money? Of course we do. As I already mentioned, it started with the ten cents that Ebby spent to visit Bill W. on Clinton Street. We probably all read the stories on the financial aspect of our Fellowship, starting with the janitor episode whereby Bill expected him to work for free.

There are a number of paid employees at G.S.O. who give services to the groups at our request, there's rent to pay, literature expenses, travelling, etc., etc., etc. For some reason, we seem to be shy to talk about this. Our treasurer will be making an excellent presentation, with all the details on how much we receive in contributions, what our expenses are, etc. I am not an accountant, but I do know that it takes money to make this thing work—my responsibility is to make sure that I do everything to help the still-suffering alcoholic. Bill understood this when Dr. Bob was dying and he knew that eventually he would

also. How would this lifesaving message get out to the world? Through our service structure, but it costs money. The majority of the groups in our U.S. and Canada Conference do not participate in our Seventh Tradition, and there must be good reasons. I find it a spiritual experience to know that the money I put in the basket is going to help someone to reach us.

I would like to close by saying that starting today, and throughout this coming week, we will be embarking on a road that could change how we will reach out to the still-suffering alcoholics in the future. We will be listening to a number of presentations, financial reports and budgets, voting will take place on various issues. We have been privileged to be able to participate in changes to our approach on doing Twelfth Step work, whether it be one alcoholic talking to another or through the Internet. I firmly believe that there will be a loving God watching over us so that the decisions that will be made will be in the best interest of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Robert Pelot, Eastern Canada regional trustee

Workshop: "Passing It On in a Changing World"

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups for workshop discussions based on the Conference theme "Passing It On in a Changing World." Following are questions and a summary of responses from those discussions.

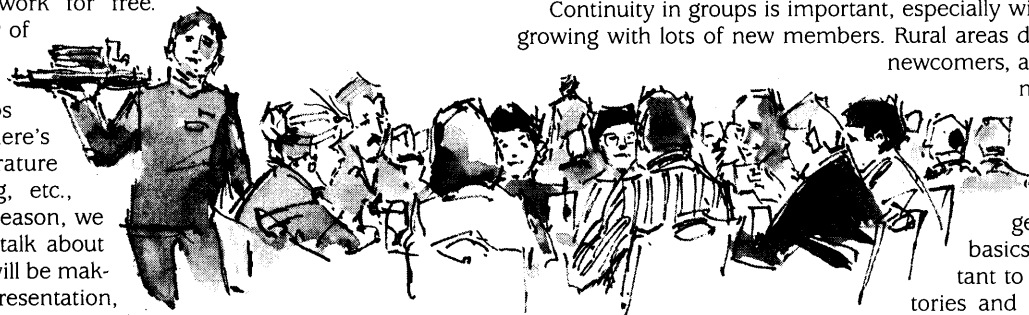
1. How does a changing world affect what your group is doing today to carry the A.A. message to newcomers?

Members carry the A.A. message to newcomers by greeting and welcoming them at meetings, holding Step, Tradition, Big Book, and speaker meetings, and encouraging strong sponsorship.

A.A. has one message, one program that is carried to all alcoholics. No matter what is happening in the world, one drunk sharing with another continues. One of the most important things is to shake the newcomer's hand and talk to them. Groups need to stick to the basics of our common problem and the solution, as well as keeping the meeting format flexible to focus on the newcomer, and holding frequent business meetings and inventories at the group, district and area levels. Continue to "show" the newcomer what an A.A. meeting is. Encourage them to get phone numbers, and call newcomers, rather than waiting for them to call us — as Dr. Bob and Bill W. did. Provide newcomers with Conference-approved literature, encourage them to read our history book, and go for coffee after the meeting for face-to-face contact. Assign sponsors or offer temporary sponsorship. Don't baby the newcomer. Keeping the A.A. message and A.A. service simple still works.

Continuity in groups is important, especially with some areas growing with lots of new members. Rural areas don't get many newcomers, and small communities who have no treatment or detox facilities have to get back to the basics. It is important to clear up directories and meeting information; one group has e-mail addresses on lists for newcomers.

Communicating the importance of identification and explaining our singleness of purpose to the newcomer are important. Stress singleness of purpose to dual-addicted newcomers. More members need to be willing to welcome those who are different



with love and then share about our program of recovery and singleness of purpose. One way is by using the literature (e.g., *Box 4-5-9* and the *Grapevine*). Remain aware that Internet knowledge does not necessarily transmit the message of A.A.; we need to give a clear message of what recovery is by using the literature and Twelve Step sponsorship. Encourage rotation and service and involvement in general service.

Be aware of *all* newcomers, not just the young people. It is important to have at least one meeting as a young people's group and incorporate activities to include young people. There is also an increase in cultural and language barriers at meetings. We need to remain inclusive and reach out to minority populations. Groups that have members from different cultures, who speak different languages, are attractive to newcomers. Recognize diversity.

Changes in technology have made everyone appear in a hurry and we don't take the time to get "back to the basics" of the A.A. program. One group has its own Web site to attract newcomers. Groups today have more vehicles for carrying the message (e.g., cell phones, Internet, etc.).

Some members report that more newcomers are attending A.A. through court orders and referrals from treatment facilities. Many attending A.A. through court orders have taken newcomer classes so they know how to behave and what to expect in A.A. meetings. Some areas have increased their jail meetings, while other members report that referrals from treatment centers and professionals are on a downward trend. Many newcomers from correctional institutions, treatment facilities, and hospitals have dual addictions. Everyone and everybody have been sent to our meetings and this is having an effect. Therefore, we need to encourage those with problems in addition to alcohol, or with *no* problem with alcohol, to start attending meetings of other fellowships, such as N.A., O.A., C.A., etc. Some groups have newcomer packets, which include the pamphlet, *Problems Other than Alcohol*. One group has male and female sponsorship chairs to help with initial identification (e.g., young people, those with mental illness, and other addictions). We have to take responsibility to educate treatment centers about what A.A. is and what it is not. We need to take the message to the treatment centers and not wait until they come to us. Newcomers from treatment still need to be Twelfth-stepped into A.A., and it's up to us to inform professionals and newcomers.

Remind folks to talk from the podium only about alcohol, sponsorship and service. At some Step meetings, members are asked not to share unless they have taken that Step with a sponsor. We need to follow and stay firm on our Twelve Traditions and have regular group inventories.

Don't be afraid to pass on the message, and to remember that our code is love and tolerance, to have compassion, and carry the A.A. message in a gentle but firm way. Offering love, tolerance, and hope with those who are not sure will help them to find where they belong. The changing world has not affected all groups. Strong A.A. groups can weather minor storms easily.

2. Bill W. originally called the Traditions "Twelve Points to Assure Our Future." How are the Traditions fulfilling that purpose 60 years later?

If A.A. has the same face 60 years later, it is because of the Twelve Traditions. The Traditions represent the spiritual part of our program; they keep us focused and united and they assure us that A.A. will be there for the still-suffering alcoholic in the future. They teach us to stand together through recovery, unity, our requirement for membership, common welfare, group conscience, primary purpose, anonymity, and self-support. They teach us how to be a "We." They protect us from ourselves as well as outside issues.

Sixty years ago the Traditions were rejected or largely ignored by the groups. Today we make the Traditions our own. At a personal level, we lead by example and attraction. Some groups use the Traditions Checklist at meetings, and share about the Traditions in groups, recovery talks, and as meeting topics. We learn about the Traditions in workshops, in 18-week Tradition commitment groups, weekend campouts, and by inviting past delegates to share their experiences. A.A. members can also learn about the Traditions by reading *A.A. Comes of Age*. Tapes of talks of the Traditions can also be useful. Some sponsors stress the Traditions before taking their sponsees through the Steps, or during, or after.

Concepts and Traditions meetings commonly have low attendance. Groups who stray too far from Traditions often get sick, split up, or die off. Not observing our "Vow of Poverty" invites disaster. We should not take the Traditions out of context, or bend them to fit our needs. The Traditions are getting watered down and, Tradition violators seem to be those with time in sobriety — not newcomers. G.S.O. in the U.S. and Canada, as well as in Japan, often get questions from groups asking if this or that are violations of Traditions.

It is good to keep in mind that outside referral rates are declining in the treatment field but rising steadily in the corrections field. Don't permit Al-Anon members to chair meetings. The Spirit of Sacrifice is being lost because of fear. Some quotes about the importance of the Traditions are "Steps keep us from Suicide and Traditions keep us from Homicide" and "Steps get us Sober and Traditions keep us Sober".

It's important to understand how we, as individuals, fit in A.A., what our role is, and that we are a small part of a big whole — then the Steps make even more sense. We learn from our mistakes just as we did in the beginning. In *A.A. Comes of Age*, Bill says, "For as long as He may needs us." Traditions counter anger, ego, and power-driving. We were asked to use all Traditions as tools and not use one Tradition as a club.

Our literature tells us that we are all guardians of the Traditions. Groups that talk about the Traditions focus on our Singleness of Purpose and our program so others can recover. The message of the Traditions has to be carried to newcomers.

3. How does your group convey that the responsibility for self-support includes giving of effort and time in addition to money?

The home group is the place where service starts; the group can create many opportunities for service, such as sponsorship, holding regular monthly business meetings, asking for coffee commitments and group chores, such as clean-up volunteers (e.g., one group still uses and washes real cups and dishes and A-ashtray, B-books, and C-chairs), and sending thank you letters to groups who contribute at the district and area levels. Other opportunities for service include repairing or improving meeting space, being courteous to meeting place neighbors and landlord, offering transportation to meetings, and inviting newcomers for social time after meetings. Encourage newcomers to help with clean-up and other tasks to become a part of the group. Experienced group members take new members to service events, educate them about the legacy of service, and pass on service literature.

Self-support includes money, time, and effort; it is about more than just money. Self-support requires commitment, showing up, leading by example, and behaving responsibly. The responsibility of self-support can be reduced to two words, "Group and Example" — everyone in a group can have a job. Each member should be made to feel that they have the right to participate, rather than only being told they have a responsibility.

The word "service" may be a barrier to some getting involved.

We need to emphasize how contributions of time and effort add to self-support, that there is a need for time as well as money. Length of sobriety does not exclude self-support responsibility. Folks need to be informed of service responsibilities and not be given jobs that they may not be qualified for or ready for. It's hard for many of us to get new members interested in service; we need to remember Rule 62 and have common sense.

Talk about participation and encourage representation at all service levels. We can also consider the notion of self-support in relation to challenges some members face. For example, women members with children and no babysitters — one group got together to solve this challenge by women members rotating care-taking so members in this situation could attend meetings. One member shared that on her sponsee's birthday she gives a card saying that she has given a gift to G.S.O. in their name. On the group level, members explain what the Seventh Tradition is used for on all levels of service. Another group holds annual round-ups for fun and to learn about the principles of A.A.

These questions will be used as a format for workshops, speaking, and including service as part of a local "Talk Show" on service commitments. Pamphlets are used to discuss service at group meetings. Some groups use blackboards and calendars to identify service opportunities, or share about meetings with other groups. Core members voice service opportunities; sponsors encourage service participation. One-on-one communication can not be replaced, even in this modern world. We give it away to keep it, and giving it away through service is fun.

4. What current issues do you think affect A.A. that need to be talked about? Why do you think they are important? What changes would you like to see as a result of these discussions?

Current issues that affect A.A. that need to be talked about include: spirituality versus religion, an emphasis on recovery instead of unity and service, and a lack of emphasis on our Traditions, primary purpose, singleness of purpose, unity, and anonymity. There seems to be a lack of connection with A.A. as a whole. These issues are important because they suggest a lack of understanding in the A.A. program. We would like to see more emphasis on the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions, and the spiritual foundation of our A.A. program.

Another issue is Twelfth Step work and the lack of experience working with wet drunks. Do we wait for them to come to us or do we know who/where the alcoholics are in our community? Are we attracting newcomers? Or are we relying on treatment centers to do our Twelfth Step work? These issues are important because they ask, "Who are we serving?" Some members say that we are not serving the Fellowship, and that we may be in danger of losing sight of the fact that we need to pass it on to others. We can change by making ourselves more available for Twelfth Step work.

Members also asked if there is a lack of effort on our part to reach the newcomer on a personal level? Do we hand our phone numbers over to the newcomer personally or on a meeting list? Are our meeting lists up-to-date? Are we practicing the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions in our own lives? There seems to be a lack of sponsorship. We can encourage more one-on-one communication and sponsorship and hold more sponsorship workshops.

Is there too much focus on intergroups and central offices, instead of home groups? Are groups conducting fearless inventories? It is important to belong and participate in the home group.

Some members thought the biggest current issue is the number of groups not participating in the service structure, as evidenced by the percentage of groups not contributing to G.S.O. When was the last time I wrote a check to G.S.O., no matter how small the contribution? It's hard to talk about the Seventh

Tradition without talking about them all. The Seventh Tradition is a spirited action. We can't be shy about saying we need money. How much do we invest in A.A.? It is important to remain responsible and accountable in order to make sure we are self-supporting for the future.

There seems to be a lot of activity in A.A., but little action, and there's ignorance of service preformed. One solution may be going out to groups and saying, "We need you." Watch "Doers" and be a "Doer"! Do we understand that service work is not a substitute for a meeting, and that a service position does not exclude us from making coffee, chairing, and doing the group tasks that we always did? There's not enough participation of knowledgeable members, with uninformed groups to guide others along the path of self-support and spiritual growth. Take personal responsibility, and don't pass the buck.

Some members are not carrying the appropriate A.A. message, or we are carrying the wrong A.A. message. We are having problems with poor communication in carrying the message, as evidenced by only 43 percent of listed groups participating and contributing. A large number of A.A. groups are not registered with G.S.O. The challenge is communication — the solution is communication, and communication with the next generation.

We need to take more risks on the Conference agenda and not come from a place of being afraid and closed, such as fear of offending D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s., and fear of offending members by talking about the Seventh Tradition. More focus on the D.C.M. structure and encourage D.C.M.s to have workshops with G.S.R.s, and new members in service. More inclusiveness at the trustee level. How do we get more young people involved in General Service commitments beyond the group level? Many groups don't have G.S.R.s. Watch out for "lecturers" in group, district, and area meetings. Are we having fun at group, district, and area meetings? Are we having fun as individuals? Let it show on our faces and by our actions. Don't be afraid to accept D.C.M. and G.S.R. responsibilities.

With changing cultures in our Fellowship, we need to address these issues and barriers. We might look at redefining "Remote Communities" to mean "access." There is a lack of minorities in A.A. — are we a society of older, white, Christian men? The people attending meetings don't seem to represent our communities — our membership survey shows the gaps. What is the role of treatment facilities and private publishers vis-à-vis A.A.? What do we do with problems other than alcohol? P.I. and C.P.C. committees need to explain to the public what our purpose is, what we are and what we are not. The Internet and online meetings are affecting attendance at meetings. The legal system (judges) is struggling with appropriate referral to A.A. for their clients. Are we failing at institutional sponsorship? We should talk more about how to reach others and inform corrections — both judges and institutions.

Other issues include the price of literature and justification for expenditure, groups having to have insurance, competition to A.A., being an entertainer when sharing stories, and growing factions within A.A. and how this affects A.A. as a whole. Fundamentalism — in contrast to keeping an open mind and being teachable. Although Bill W. spoke of God's will for A.A. being expressed in the group conscience, how do we know what God's will really is if we have limited participation?

If we are responsible, let's do something. Understand people's humanness, use of the hand of A.A. and what it means, more hugs, and looking into the eyes of newcomers when they arrive. Be a power of example in home groups and at all levels of service. Keep with the basics — getting sober and helping somebody else get sober.

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2006 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

- 1 To amend the Cooperation With the Professional Community Advisory Action:

The committee recommended that three short video segments be produced that can be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields [with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000].

By inserting the following language into the Advisory Action after medical fields:

"and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community"

So that it would read:

The committee recommended that three short video segments be produced that can be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice and medical fields, and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 2 The theme for the 2007 General Service Conference be: "Our 12th Step Responsibility—Are We Going to Any Length?"
- 3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2007 General Service Conference:
 - a) Inclusiveness in A.A.:

- 1) Our 3rd Tradition
 - 2) Growth of the Fellowship
 - 3) Reaching Out to All Who Want It
- b) Our Primary Purpose:
 - 1) Attraction Rather Than Promotion
 - 2) Working with Wet Drunks
 - 3) Practicing These Principles in All Our Affairs
 - c) Humility and Responsibility:
 - 1) Expressed by Anonymity
 - 2) Are We Resting on Our Laurels?
 - 3) Raising Literature Prices or Footing the Bill?

- 4 The following be the workshop topic for the 2007 General Service Conference: "Spiritual Value of Our A.A. Dollars."

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 5 Three short video segments be produced that can be accessed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, with a total cost not to exceed \$60,000. [See Floor Action]

CORRECTIONS

It was recommended that:

- 6 An informational media presentation be developed featuring someone highly credible in the corrections field introducing A.A. to training academies and in-service training programs for corrections personnel and be brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Corrections. [The estimated cost of production and distribution is \$50,000]



¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

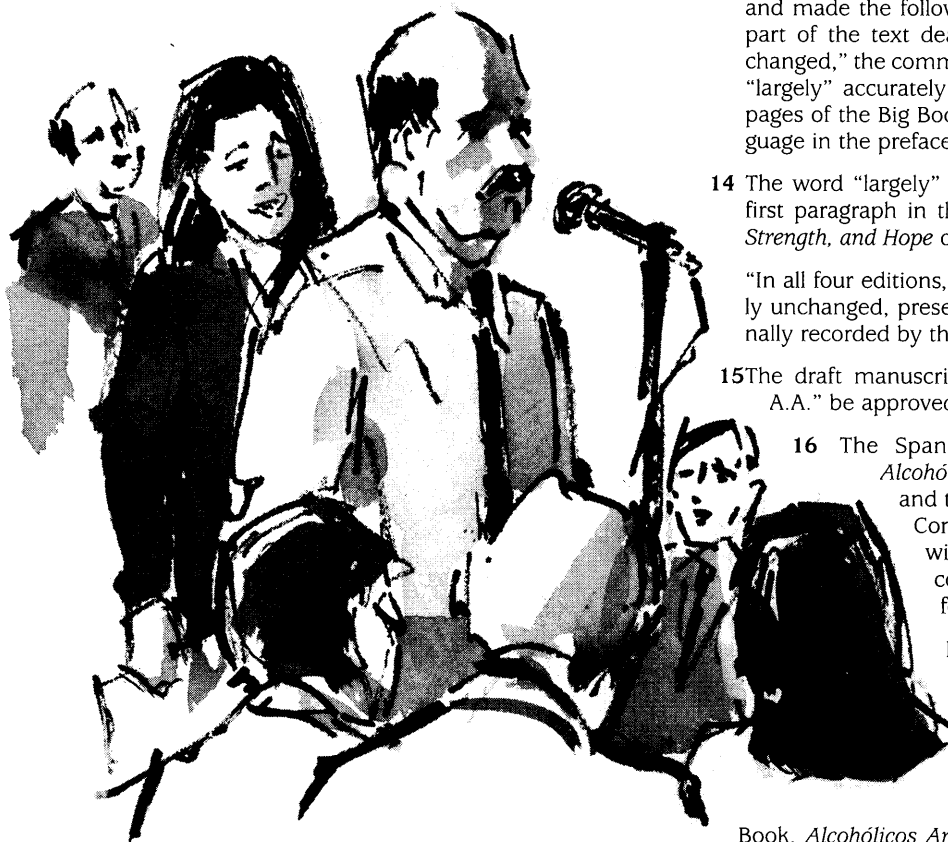
The following should be reflected in the presentation:

- a) What A.A. is and is not.
 - b) How to contact A.A.
 - c) An inmate's chances of maintaining sobriety on the outside are improved by participation in the A.A. program of recovery.
 - d) Correctional facilities usually regard A.A. as contributing to the objectives of their institution.
- 7 The draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be approved and that the Publications Department maintain standard editorial responsibilities.

FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 8 The word "donation" be replaced with the word "contribution" in A.A.W.S. literature as it comes up for reprint.
- 9 The following be added to the end of the Q & A section of the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix":
Q Does A.A. have any specific information for our group or group treasurer about how to handle our group's finances?
A Yes. There are two excellent publications available from G.S.O., A.A. Guidelines on Finance and the pamphlet "The A.A. Group Treasurer," that provide specific information to groups regarding practical matters related to their group finances, such as setting up bank accounts, obtaining tax ID numbers, and outlining the responsibilities of a group treasurer.



GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

No recommendations.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

- 10 The revised draft pamphlet "Too Young?" be approved.
- 11 The revised draft pamphlet "It Happened To Alice!" be approved.
- 12 The pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American" be revised.
- 13 The word "largely" be added to the second sentence in the second paragraph of the preface to the Fourth Edition on page xi, as it originally appeared in the preface of the Second Edition, so that the sentence reads:

"Therefore, the first portion of this volume, describing the A.A. recovery program, has been left largely untouched in the course of revisions made for the second, third, and fourth editions."

Note: Keeping in mind the note that was included with the 1955 General Service Conference Advisory Actions, "In presenting the updating of the first edition of the Big Book, Bill described the background of his long-range writing project and made the following point(s): 1. 'Not an iota' of the first part of the text dealing with recovery principles had been changed," the committee agreed that the addition of the word "largely" accurately reflects revisions made to the first 164 pages of the Big Book and is consistent with the original language in the preface to the Second Edition.

- 14 The word "largely" be added to the second sentence in the first paragraph in the Introduction to the book, *Experience, Strength, and Hope* on page ix, so that the sentence reads:

"In all four editions, the first 164 pages have remained largely unchanged, preserving A.A.'s message just as it was originally recorded by the founding members."

- 15 The draft manuscript of the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." be approved.

- 16 The Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, continue to be developed and that a report be brought back to the 2007 Conference Literature Committee, in keeping with a 2004 Conference Advisory Action on contents, story solicitation, and process, as follows:

I. Contents

- a) The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book to be similar in page count to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.
- b) The first 164 pages of the Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, the Preface, the Forewords, "The

Doctor's Opinion," "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," and the Appendices will undergo a complete review to assure accuracy of translation and consistency of style and tone throughout the text. As in translations of all languages, the Publications Department strives to reflect the best possible translation of Bill W's writings and does not require Conference approval.

c) Personal Stories:

- Retain selected stories from current Spanish-language Second Edition.
- Select stories from A.A.'s La Viña magazine.
- Select new stories from Spanish-speaking membership.
- Stories to be designated to three main sections similar to the English Fourth Edition Big Book.



II. Story Solicitation

- a) Within the United States and Canada and internationally to Spanish-speaking countries.

III. Story Selection Process

- a) To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book.
- b) Story selection subcommittee:
- All bilingual — Spanish and English.
 - Spanish editors.
 - Spanish-speaking staff members.
 - Chair to appoint some subcommittee members from the Fellowship.
- c) Basic Selection Criteria:
- To use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W's recommendations.
 - Each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution.
 - Each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

- 17 The pamphlet "Letter to A Woman Alcoholic" be discontinued.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 18 Valerie Martin, general manager of the G.S.O. for Australia, and Noriaki Nozaki, general manager of the G.S.O. for Japan, be admitted to the 56th General Service Conference as observers.
- 19 Current General Service Board members and G.S.O. staff members from other countries be granted admission as observers upon their request to the annual General Service Conference of the U.S. and Canada; that admission is not to exceed two countries and two representatives per country, one being a board member and/or one G.S.O. staff member at each General Service Conference; that the request for admission be made through the General Service Office in New York; and that decisions regarding responsibility for guest observer expenses be at the discretion of the General Service Board.
- 20 The 59th General Service Conference be held April 26 - May 2, 2009, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 21 The television public service announcement (P.S.A.) "Testimonials," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved, completing a four-year replacement schedule initiated by the 2002 General Service Conference.
- 22 The 2002 Advisory Action that states, "After the initial four years, this cycle would continue with the oldest P.S.A. being replaced each year" be reaffirmed and that a new P.S.A. be developed for review by the 2007 Conference Committee on Public Information at a cost not to exceed \$40,000 and the oldest P.S.A. in the four-year plan be replaced.
- 23 The television public service announcement (P.S.A.) "Testimonials" be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$31,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.
- 24 The section on "Marital Status" in the "A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" be revised and retitled as "Domestic Status" with the following four options:
- ☐ Married
 - ☐ Single
 - ☐ Divorced
 - ☐ Other (please specify) _____.
- 25 The option "Internet" be added to the "2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" under Question 11: "Please indicate no more than two of the following entities that you feel were most influential in your decision to come to your first A.A. meeting."
- 26 The "2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" be approved.
- 27 The videos "Young People and A.A." and "A.A.: Rap with Us" be replaced and that the trustees' Committee on Public Information develop an idea for a film, video tape or some other such instrument targeting young people, including storyboards and estimated costs, taking into consideration the findings in the January 2006 trustees' report on Videos for Young People with the widest possible diversity range, and that a report be forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

28 The graphic, "Service Structure Inside the A.A. Group," as it appeared in the 1998-1999 edition, be restored in Chapter 2 of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

29 The following descriptive sentence be added to the second paragraph on page S63 of *The A.A. Service Manual* in the section "Trustees-at-large":

"In the year between the World Service Meetings, the trustees-at-large may attend a Western Hemisphere zonal meeting, the Meeting of the Americas, as delegates representing the U.S. and Canada."

30 The statement on page ii of each A.A. Directory located below the box "An A.A. Group" be revised to read:

IMPORTANT INFORMATION ABOUT THIS DIRECTORY

As embodied in the Fourth Tradition, the formation and operation of an A.A. group resides exclusively within the group conscience of its members. While, hopefully, every A.A. group adheres closely to the guiding principles of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, A.A.W.S. neither monitors nor oversees the activities or practice of any A.A. group. Groups listed in this directory appear at their own request. A directory listing does not constitute or imply approval or endorsement of any group's approach to, or practice of, the A.A. program.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

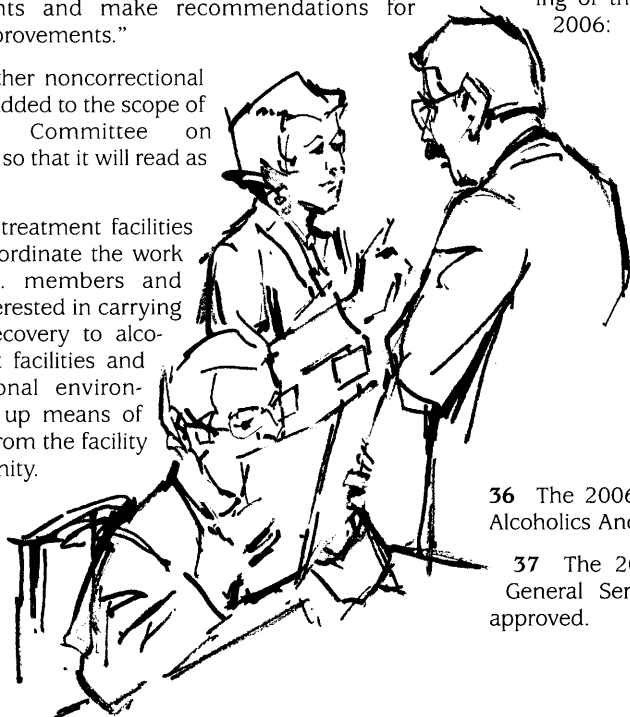
It was recommended that:

31 The word "institutional" be deleted from the scope so that the second paragraph on the scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities will read as follows:

"The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements."

32 The phrase "and other noncorrectional environments" be added to the scope of the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities so that it will read as follows:

"The purpose of a treatment facilities committee is to coordinate the work of individual A.A. members and groups who are interested in carrying our message of recovery to alcoholics in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments, and to set up means of 'bridging the gap' from the facility to the A.A. community."



"The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements."

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

33 The following slate of trustees be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., in April 2006:

Class A

Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.	Herbert I. Goodman
Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.	Vincent E. Keefe
William D. Clark, M.D.	Jeanne S. Woodford
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	

Class B

Charles J. Barta	Robert Mayer
Paul Cleary	Madeleine J. Parmley
Gary Kluksdahl	Michael D. Perry
Tom Kraemer	Arnold L. Ross
Howard Lowery	Jane Sheppard
Murray McIntosh	Denis Vezina
Raymond Massey	Dorothy Wilson

The following slate of officers be elected at the second quarterly meeting of the trustees of the General Service Board in April 2006:

Chairperson	Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.
First vice-chairperson	Allen L. Ault, Ed.D.
Second vice-chairperson	Herbert I. Goodman
Treasurer	Vincent E. Keefe
Secretary	Gary Kluksdahl
Assistant Treasurer	Donald W. Meurer
Assistant Secretary	Eva Sanchez

34 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of A.A. World Services, Inc. in April 2006:

Charles J. Barta	Greg Muth
Paul Cleary	Eva Sanchez
Roberta Lindeman	Jane Sheppard
Howard Lowery	Jane Tolar
George G. Martin	

35 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., in April 2006:

James Branscome	Raymond Massey
Robin Bromley	Robert Mayer
Herbert I. Goodman	Arnold L. Ross
Dorothy L. Hurley	John Skilton
Tom Kraemer	

36 The 2006 revised Bylaws of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., be approved.

37 The 2006 Restated Certificate of Incorporation of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., be approved.

Presentations and Reports

LA VIÑA

The first presentation of the Conference was Monday afternoon, a celebration of La Viña's 10th anniversary. Michael Perry, chairman of the Grapevine Board, moderated and the presentation was followed by a traditional anniversary cake.

La Viña—The First 10 Years

Our May/June issue marks the 10th anniversary of La Viña, but it is worth remembering that efforts to provide Spanish-speaking A.A. members with a tool equivalent to the Grapevine were under way for several years before La Viña came into being. As many of you know, in 1991 there was a Conference Advisory Action recommending that the Grapevine publish at least one article in Spanish every month. These articles appeared between September 1991 and June 1996. Then, in 1995, the Conference recommended that a special edition of the Grapevine in Spanish be produced (this issue came out in July 1995) and that a bimonthly Spanish magazine be created as a five-year experiment. After the five-year trial period, in 2001, the Conference recommended that "La Viña continue to be published by the A.A. Grapevine and supported by the General Service Board as a service to the Fellowship."

Service always has additional benefits, and we can safely say that the Fellowship has gained a lot by helping La Viña. The magazine fosters unity and a sense of belonging among Spanish-speaking A.A.s, and makes it possible for the voice of the Spanish-speaking A.A. member to be shared. Many trusted servants begin their service careers as RLVs (La Viña reps) at the group level and later find their way to other positions in the service structure.

Sponsorship: Like a good sponsor, the Grapevine has generously shared with La Viña all that it knows about producing a magazine for alcoholics. Starting almost as a carbon copy of the English magazine, La Viña slowly developed its own identity, graphic design and editorial content. As Spanish-speaking A.A.s from around the world have embraced the magazine, La Viña now prints mostly original articles in Spanish. The Grapevine, too, publishes our articles in translation from time to time.

A changing world: A lot can change in 10 years. The Hispanic population of the U.S. went from 22.4 million in 1990 to more than 35 million in 2000 (58% growth), and now accounts for more than 14 percent of the population of the United States. On a worldwide scale, Spanish is about to overtake English as our planet's second most-spoken language. In the A.A. world this means that the number of Spanish-speaking alcoholics is also growing, and the U.S./Canada service structure continues to see an increase in the number of Spanish-speaking groups, districts and intergroup/central offices.

When the General Service Conference responded to an expressed need by Spanish-speaking A.A. members 10 years ago, it did more than create a new publication for Spanish-speaking A.A.s. It made it possible for the hand of A.A. to be there for "anyone, anywhere" who needs help in the Spanish language.

And now the big question: Is La Viña self-supporting? Not yet. But let's remember that while the Grapevine grew organically with the Fellowship and was initially produced by volunteers, La Viña was brought into being by Conference action and inherited its basic format and cost structure from its parent publication. La Viña and the Grapevine, with the support of the General Service Board, work together to maximize efficiencies in production, and there is an ongoing discussion about what the best way of accomplishing our mission is. If we look too narrowly at the financials,

we might lose sight of the magazine's purpose and value. What is the value of saving one, ten, one hundred alcoholics? We know from the letters that reach us that La Viña helps Spanish-speaking alcoholics achieve and keep their sobriety. We hope to keep doing that for many years to come.

So I believe there is ample reason to celebrate these first ten years.

¡Feliz Aniversario, La Viña!

Hernán Merea, La Viña editor

REPORT: RELOCATION STUDY, 2005

Monday afternoon, a summary of this report was given by Ron Gauthier, A.A.W.S. director, followed by questions and sharing. A complete report is available, upon request, from G.S.O.

Current Situation and Needs

The current relocation study, which you were given to review, was prepared by the general manager and G.S.O. employees using the Project Management Office (PMO) approach in order to consider the current needs and to provide information in a timely manner in the event a recommendation was approved to relocate the General Service Office. Using this approach, which for the first time was completed in-house, a project plan and analysis model was created that focused on concrete financial factors, i.e., recurring costs and nonrecurring costs, as well as subjective factors, particularly staff impact and the history and heritage of Alcoholics Anonymous. With this study, the current location was compared with three geographically diverse metropolitan areas. During the review by the A.A.W.S. Board and the General Service Board, the view was expressed that the outcome was a high-quality report that is comparable to previous third-party reports.

The following key issues were considered by the A.A.W.S. Board in its review:

1. Existing lease expires in December 2008—Opportunity exists to benefit from current lease rates at whatever location.
2. Some capital improvements are needed in the existing office space, i.e., replacement of carpets, that would be done at our expense—Better to wait until confirmation of longer-term tenancy at the Interchurch Center.
3. The Grapevine, which sublets space from A.A.W.S., is planning to give up 1,500 to 2,000 square feet of space and thus requiring a smaller space of 8,000 to 10,000 square feet.

In reviewing this relocation study, the following key items are summarized:

- The annual difference in operating costs of \$5.1 million at the present location were compared with the three alternative locations, with two being higher and one slightly lower.
- Nonrecurring costs associated with a relocation of the General Service Office to assumed alternative locations ranged from \$6.6 million to \$7.7 million. In all three cases, the two major components of these costs, representing about 68% of the total relocation costs, consist of office construction averaging \$2.3 million and of the same severance cost of \$2.5 million. Costs of moving to a new location would be a significant drain on our current Reserve Fund and reflect a minimum of 44 years to recover these nonrecurring costs. More detailed information can be found in the formal Relocation Report.

The report conclusions are as follows and are similar to the 1996 Ad Hoc Report:

1. A concrete financial case for moving from the current location cannot be made at this time.

2. The small reduction in recurring costs is overshadowed by the substantial one-time costs associated with a move.

3. The subjective implications of moving G.S.O. to another city, regardless of cost savings, are significant, considering the history of the office in New York.

Based on these conclusions, the recommendation was not to relocate the General Service Office. The current office location meets our needs and allows G.S.O. to function effectively.

Following the acceptance of this report, the A.A.W.S. Board unanimously voted at the January 2006 meeting to authorize the general manager to negotiate a lease renewal for a 10-year period based on the length of time offered by the landlord. Following a prior similar process, the A.A.W.S. Board also forwarded a copy of the relocation study to the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee for review and disapproval, if any, which in turn forwarded it to the General Service Board for review. In turn, the G.S.O. Relocation Study 2005 report has been presented to the Conference, with this summary presentation being provided as part of the review.

Through our years of shared experience, the approach for reviewing the appropriate location of the General Service Office is part of a sound and prudent long-range planning process on the part of the general manager and the A.A.W.S. Board. As presented, the A.A.W.S. Board has approved the plan to remain at the current location with the general manager authorized to negotiate a 10-year lease renewal. With this plan, we will be able to lock in current rates as part of a continued effort at cost savings. It also allows us to avoid major cost of relocation, which would place significant demands on the Reserve Fund at a time when other critical issues affecting the Reserve Fund are under consideration. I hope that this summary report has been helpful and informative in presenting the importance of maintaining the General Service Office at its present location, and that it has conveyed the attention we gave to financial and historical considerations.

It seems appropriate to emphasize the continued need for our Fellowship to be self-supporting. As Dr. Jack reported in 1977 regarding the financial health of the Fellowship, "At the direction of the Conference, we are trying to bring about a better balance between group contributions (which should go up to be truly self-supporting) and income from literature sales (which should go down as it becomes possible to reduce literature prices)."

He went on to say that a first step was taken in 1977 to define what constitutes a Prudent Reserve, with "...income above that figure that is not needed as operating funds can be returned to the Fellowship at large in the form of lower literature prices or increased services." As we have seen recently, considerable discussion regarding the Reserve Fund continues and is directly connected to the larger discussion of self-support.

Ron Gauthier, general service trustee

REPORT: FINANCE

Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by a sharing session, was given by Vince Keefe, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Vince Keefe and I am a grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. I consider it a privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report today to the 56th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, will be included in the Finance Section of the *Final Conference Report*. Our audit partner, Kevin Sunkel, is in attendance this afternoon. Also available are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and

Eugene O'Brien, controller of the A.A. Grapevine. We are fortunate to be blessed with an extremely competent finance team.

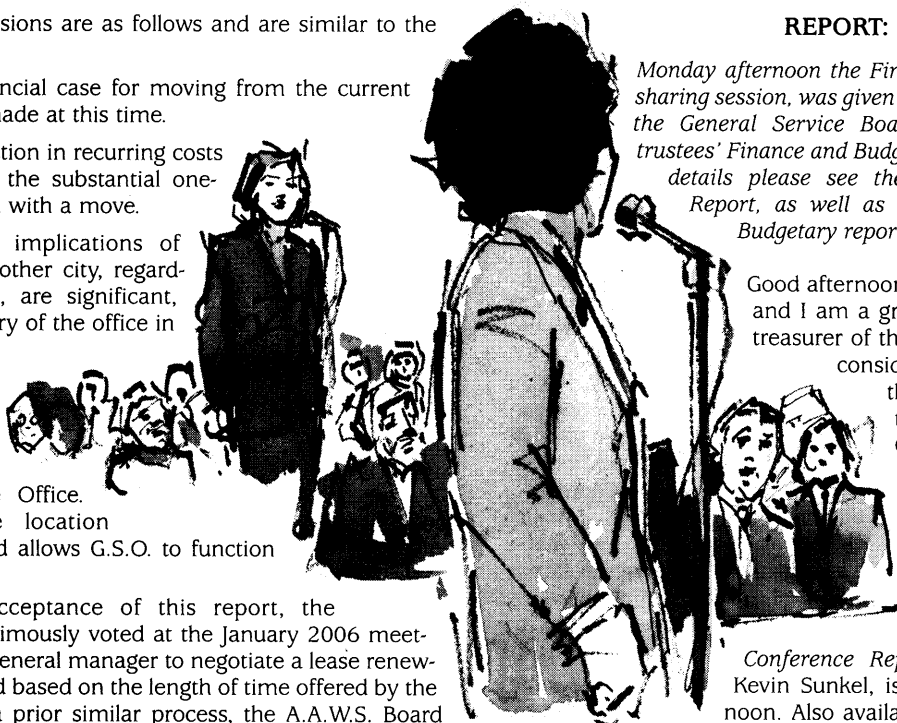
The format for this presentation is designed to communicate the key aspects of our financial position. The goal is to communicate the broad aspects of where we are and where we are going.

I have organized this presentation into six components, namely: (1) our General Service Office, (2) A.A.W.S. Publishing activities, (3) La Viña, (4) The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., (5) the General Service Board Reserve Fund, and (6) a financial summary of the Toronto International Convention held last July. We will primarily focus on the results for the calendar year 2005; however, prior year results and the 2006 budget are also included to create a broader perspective.

Our first chart summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at our General Service Office on behalf of the General Service Board. I am sure that we are all familiar with each function listed, with the possible exception of the last line entitled Supporting Services. Supporting Services includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. The individual service functions would not be able to operate without this support structure. The total cost of the General Service Office functions for 2005 is \$7,443,295, approximately \$178,994, or 2.3%, less than the \$7,622,289 spent in 2004.

Next, Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. A contribution of \$6.14 per member, or \$136.85 per group in 2006, would allow the Fellowship to be fully self-supporting from contributions. I would call your attention to the 2006 budget for group services. We are budgeting \$7,946,337, which is an increase of approximately \$503,042, or 6.7%. The reason this increase is so large is that it includes several items that did not occur in 2005, such as the World Services Meeting coming up in 2006, increased pension costs, and the first funding payment to the Retiree Medical Benefits Program.

Next is a detailed breakdown of the Group Services activities. This will help all of us communicate more clearly when groups ask



just what is it that the General Service Office does for each group.

The next topic to explore is the question of how we pay for these important service functions. The General Service Board has three sources of funds: group contributions, A.A.W.S. literature profits, and transfers from the Reserve Fund. In 2005 the General Service Board received group contributions of \$5,417,046, composed of \$5,282,000 from groups and members, and approximately \$135,000 received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Fund. We are very grateful for the broad base of voluntary contributions that supports our General Service Office. Group acceptance of the responsibility to pay for our service functions reinforces the commitment to our primary purpose of reaching out to the still-suffering alcoholic.

While contribution dollars were slightly higher, so too were the number of groups reported. Interestingly though, again this year, the number of groups was slightly higher, while the percent of groups contributing appear to be decreasing ever so slightly. It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Now to summarize the financial performance of our publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2005 amounted to \$11,923,840, which is 2.6% greater than the previous year. After deducting the cost of goods sold and shipping and warehousing costs, there remains a gross profit of \$6,683,440, or 57.5% of sales. This gross profit percent is 7% higher than 2004, mainly due to the successful savings of manufacturing costs, and selected literature price increases during 2004 and 2005. The final profit from literature sales after deducting the administrative costs is \$2,999,830, resulting in an increase over 2004 of \$882,000. The staff, management team, and board of A.A.W.S. have worked very hard this past year to produce this wonderful result. Great work.

Next we look at La Viña. The General Service Board continues to fund La Viña, the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. The average monthly subscriptions increased in 2005 to 9,453, which is an increase of 137. La Viña incurred an overall loss of \$107,740 in 2005. The General Service Board has invested \$1,100,000 since the inception of this magazine.

At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with last year, while average circulation was down 3.7%. The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. still managed to have a good financial year in spite of this continuing decline in monthly subscriptions. The Grapevine showed a profit of \$44,198 on magazine income of \$1,910,799. This outcome is undoubtedly attributable to the good work performed by the Grapevine Board and management team throughout 2005.

Let's look at the financial results of the International Convention, held last July in Toronto. On a budget of just under \$4 million, the final result is a loss of \$39,040, or 1% of the total. It would be very hard to come much closer than that to breaking even. Our hats are off to the entire International Convention team for a job well done.

At this point we can combine the individual parts into a summary income statement for the year ended December 31, 2005. The cost of services of \$7,443,295, less contributions of \$5,417,046 and interest of \$2,592, leaves a shortfall of 2,023,657. This is offset by the profit from literature of \$2,999,828, resulting in a surplus of \$937,131. After taking into account the loss on the International Convention of \$39,040, the Grapevine profit of \$44,198, and the La Viña loss of \$107,740, we are left with a positive result for the year of \$873,589.

The last part of our analysis will cover the Reserve Fund of the

General Service Board. The Reserve Fund ended 2005 with a balance of \$9,253,935, equal to approximately 8.7 months of operating expenses. This means that we are now at the lower end of the acceptable range in terms of the number of months of expenses covered.

It should be noted that the surplus from 2005 will not increase the Reserve Fund balance until the cash is actually transferred in 2006. Once the \$626,000 is transferred, the Reserve Fund balance will be the equivalent of approximately 9.3 months of operating expenses.

I would like to review the key actions that have been taken in recent years to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. We have:

- Reduced the price of the Big Book by \$1 coincident with the publication of the 4th edition.
 - Restored the price of the Big Book in July 2004 by raising the price by \$1.
 - Announced increases in certain book prices and handling charges effective July 1, 2005.
 - Accomplished a major cost reduction program at the General Service Office to lower our annual operating costs.
- As a result of these actions the Reserve Fund has fluctuated between 12 equivalent months of operating expenses in calendar 2000 to 9.3 months at the end of 2005.
- On the surface we could consider our financial performance quite adequate. But is it? Or is there something wrong with our approach. What I find troubling is that we continue to depend on profits from the sale of literature to balance the budget. The year that just ended illustrates this point very well. There are three pleasant surprises in the A.A.W.S. financial statement for 2005:
- Net literature sales exceeded the budget by \$476,000, which added approximately \$275,000 to our bottom line.
 - Savings in manufacturing costs added approximately \$560,000 to the bottom line. A special kudos to our Publications team for this good work.
 - Group contributions exceeded the budget and added approximately \$142,000 to the bottom line. This is another outstanding accomplishment and we need to give special recognition to every group that sent in a contribution and made this increase possible.

With the help of these three items totaling \$977,000, our Reserve Fund now stands at 9.3 months after the transfer that will occur this month. But what if they didn't happen. This would mean that we would not be making a transfer this month to the Reserve Fund to bring it above the nine-month threshold. We would start off 2006 with a balance that would cover approximately 8.7 months. This would put us below our lower range, so most likely another price increase would already be in the planning stages. It will get harder, not easier, in future years. There are no large cost savings on the horizon and sales may not increase at the same pace as last year. Inflation increases will most likely outpace the increase in group contributions, creating future literature price increases as the only way to maintain the Reserve Fund balance.

I read this statement recently that is right on target for our topic today: *If We Keep Doing What We Are Doing, We Will Keep Getting What We Are Getting.*

In other words, as long as we have such a large part of the Fellowship not sending in any contributions, we will continue to rely on literature price increases to balance budgets or face the hard task of reducing services. The simple fact is that we need to increase group contributions, especially from those groups who do not participate. This is not so much a "money" issue as it is a

responsibility issue. When we embrace Tradition Seven and decline outside contributions, we take on the individual responsibility to pay our bills from group and member contributions. This is a responsibility that every member of the Fellowship shares. Shared responsibility only works when every member shares.

If our contributions remain at the same level, we will continue to rely on literature price increases to cover our service structure costs? And what happens if we follow this path?

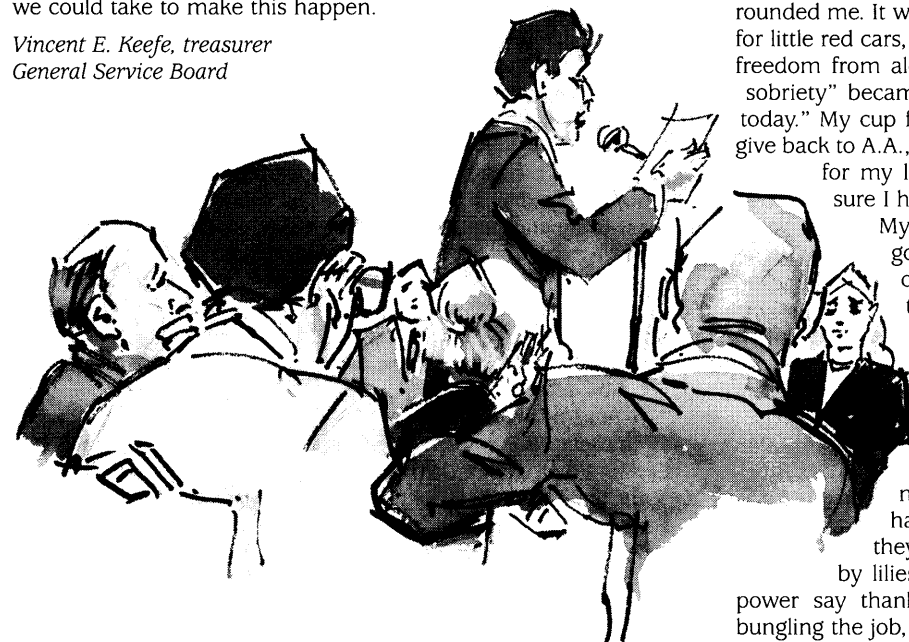
- Higher prices will result in fewer pieces of literature being purchased and fewer alcoholics being reached.
- Higher prices will create more opportunities for outside enterprises to print A.A. literature.
- Services may have to be cut in the future.
- Our trusted servants will continually struggle with the challenge of raising prices or cutting services.

If the entire Fellowship shared this responsibility to contribute we could easily be self-supporting from contributions. The benefits of being self-supporting from contributions would be enlightening for all of us:

- Literature could be priced at cost.
- Lower prices would mean that more literature would be available to reach the still-suffering alcoholic.
- Who, other than Alcoholics Anonymous, would want to produce and sell literature at cost? And as long as we produce the literature, we can maintain the clarity of the message.
- There would be no profits from outside interests to worry about.
- Complete control over all A.A. literature would rest within the Fellowship.
- We would establish a strong financial base to insure that our Service Structure remains in place to serve future generations.
- Most importantly, the entire Fellowship would have a stronger spiritual connection.

This is a simple, yet challenging concept. I am very interested to know if the 56th General Service Conference agrees with the idea of being self-supporting from individual and group contributions. If you do, I would also like to know what steps you think we could take to make this happen.

Vincent E. Keefe, treasurer
General Service Board



SPONSORSHIP

Following dinner Monday evening Tom Kraemer, Western Canada regional trustee, chaired the presentation/discussion session.

Presenting A.A. to Newcomers

We were given a precious gift at A.A.'s 30th Anniversary International Convention in 1965, and it reads: *I Am Responsible. When anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible.* (As Bill Sees It, p. 332) Does use of this declaration help instill a sense of responsibility in newcomers?

A.A. members in my little city of Cortland, New York, with its 10 or 12 nearby groups and 30 or so meetings a week, hear The Promises (*Alcoholics Anonymous*, p.83-84) read often at meetings. Many newcomers go to lots of meetings, and bring up their problems as topics for discussion. First thing they know, the "promises" are coming true! They feel better—physically and mentally. Some of their lives get so good they stop coming to meetings. They think they got what they came for—recovery from alcoholism. You and I know they are selling themselves short; they have never taken ownership of A.A.

Self-will run riot! That defined me when I got to Alcoholics Anonymous. Early on, my home group exposed me to the Responsibility Statement. At about the same time, they made me greeter. I thought I was the hand of A.A., feeling useful and needed as I shook hands in greeting and kind of swung people around and pointed them toward the coffeepot. I remember when Tall Gene showed up. Ducking shyly through the door, he asked me who was in charge. With a thousand explanations running through my head, trying to sort them out and to keep it simple, I said, "I am." This got him in the door, and he always laughed about it afterwards.

It dawned on me after a while that I am a miracle, and I got into the habit of thanking God every day for my sobriety. I bought a sweet little red Pontiac—four cylinders, standard shift, 176,000 miles. Crazy Richard from my home group made me a tape for my first ever tape player in a car. One day, flying over the hill between Dryden and Cortland, I shoved that tape into the tape deck and was absolutely thrilled as the sound of trumpets surrounded me. It was "The Lone Ranger!" Suddenly, I was thankful for little red cars, beautiful days, and wonderful music, as well as freedom from alcohol. My prayer of "Thank you, God, for my sobriety" became "Thank you, God, for everything in my life today." My cup filled and started to run over. I felt the need to give back to A.A., but was still smarting from chastisement, given for my latest, ignorant breaking of traditions; I wasn't sure I had much worth giving.

My involvement in A.A. made it possible for me to go back to church. It was announced that we could bring flowers for Easter and leave them in the sanctuary. "Well," I thought, "I could at least buy some flowers." So I showed up the next Saturday with a pot of yellow tulips. The whole altar area was full of white lilies. Damn, I couldn't even buy flowers right! I hid the tulips over behind the lilies. I'd let the church ladies decide whether to throw them out or not. Easter morning, I looked to see if the tulips had been included in the floral display, and there they were! Front and center, elevated, surrounded by lilies. It was the first time I ever heard my higher power say thank you to me. I was worth something! Even bungling the job, if I tried my best, I could do something good.

Things got better in A.A. as I paid attention, asked for help, and became part of the functioning group. I stayed in A.A. because of a feeling of personal worthiness and responsibility. I learned to accept with thanks and give with thanksgiving.

It seems that a few stalwart group members are conscientious in defending and protecting Alcoholics Anonymous. Somehow, we learned this responsibility, but are we teaching it? More members might stay and recover if they were instilled with an ownership of all of A.A., not just their own recovery. Accepting responsibility brings the virtue of living the Seventh Tradition of self-support. Joy comes with the humble recognition of a higher power at work in our lives, and acknowledgment that we belong to and care for Alcoholics Anonymous.

Bill Wilson said, of the Responsibility Declaration: "This is the legacy of world-service responsibility that we vanishing oldtimers are leaving to you, the A.A.s of today and tomorrow. We know that you will guard, support, and cherish this world legacy as the greatest collective responsibility that A.A. has or ever can have." (*As Bill Sees It*, p. 332)

Folks, let's pass it on!

Liz Croop, Central New York

Changes in the Alcoholic Coming to A.A.

Thank you for the opportunity to share on this very important and relevant topic. Please remember that this presentation is merely my own personal observations and opinions and may have nothing to do with the reality of current A.A. events.

Have alcoholics coming into A.A. today really changed? Are they really different? Are the newcomers worried about how they are "different," or are we? Actually, I felt different when I got to Alcoholics Anonymous. I saw people older than me. But I still felt hope from my very first meeting.

The times we live in are different. Society has changed: things move faster, we have computers, instant communication, cell phones, SMS, computer games, body piercing, different fashions (or lack of them), high-powered energy drinks, new dances. The list goes on and on. Older people who can't relate to the latest technologies or trends, the things that young people take for granted, will often distance themselves, thinking that they have nothing in common.

My topic is "Changes in the Alcoholic Coming to A.A.," but I ask you again, have alcoholics really changed? We alcoholics are still getting into all sorts of trouble. We're still ending up in hospitals, divorce courts, getting kicked out of schools, being disowned by our families, racking up debt and being thrown in jails. Any changes I perceive in alcoholics of today are really only superficial ones.

One big change (probably a new observation) I have seen lately is how people have been forcefully sent to A.A., and the struggle that this causes between members and newcomers, in how we relate. On one side, the older member tries to convince the newcomer that he may be an alcoholic. On the other side, the newcomer thinks, "What am I doing here?" I cannot emphasize enough the importance and need for good C.P.C. work. As we know, many alcoholics are sent to A.A. by professionals, many who are our friends, rather than coming on their own because they feel they have a problem and want to stop drinking.

Yes, there are also some who suffer from grave emotional problems and need to be on medications. I am not a physician, and

that is an issue between them and their doctors. However, more and more members are coming into A.A. today being treated through medications first, by well-meaning doctors, for a seeming mental problem. Yet, we suffer from a spiritual malady, and the Big Book tells me that when the *spiritual malady* is overcome, we straighten out mentally and physically. One challenge for a sponsor in a changing world is how to not have opinions on medical matters between a doctor and their patient, yet still try to help the drunk through the Steps and to have a spiritual awakening.

The disease of alcoholism is the common problem we all share. If I can see in others the emptiness, the loneliness, the confusion, the shame, the guilt, the remorse, the anger, the fear, I am sure that I can approach *any* alcoholic and be able to relate to them, regardless of any outside circumstances, because I am relating to them at their core. At that level, alcoholics haven't really changed at all.

My experience with newcomers, especially those people I thought I wouldn't relate to, demonstrates that when I talk about the emptiness and loneliness in my life as an alcoholic, they also connect with me by understanding through their own experiences. As a recovering A.A. member, I am responsible for making every newcomer feel welcome, regardless of anything. I cannot give away something I do not have. Sharing in that common problem and our common solution is the strongest tool that we have.

Sponsorship in a changing world will always require lots of compassion, tolerance, perseverance and unconditional love. Sometimes I think that the reason we reject newcomers who have additional problems other than alcohol is that we are not willing to make the effort necessary to take them aside and guide them with our example of love and tolerance.

There is no doubt that A.A. as a whole should be open to discussing ways to improve communication with newcomers in a changing world, but how far should we go? Do we need more or different kinds of groups to fit every single generation with different social problems, or can we return to the basics: "Sponsorship," one alcoholic helping another alcoholic. Why can't we just keep it that simple? Why?

Thank you for being a part of my life.

Francisco Almada, California Northern Coastal



Sponsorship Into Sobriety, Into Service

"In the earliest day of A.A., the term 'sponsor' was not in the A.A. jargon. Then a few hospitals in Akron, Ohio, and New York began to accept alcoholics ... as patients—if a sober A.A. member would agree to 'sponsor' the sick man or woman. The sponsor took the patient to the hospital, visited him or her regularly, was present when the patient was discharged, and took the patient home and then to an A.A. meeting." (*Living Sober*, p. 26)

Today many of us do the same thing as the early A.A.s. Sponsorship is Twelfth Step work on a continuing basis, helping the newcomer adjust to a new way of living without alcohol. Sponsorship is not a causal relationship with another person. It is a relationship carefully structured to serve a specific purpose within the program. It is, above all else, a *sacred trust* that we have accepted. It is not a burden, but a gift; and it carries specific responsibilities and obligations.

When I accept the responsibility of sponsoring someone, there are several things that come into play. First, I ask them two questions; 1) "Do you want to stop drinking entirely?" 2) "Are you willing to go to any length to stay stopped?" When the answers are "yes" then the sponsee is ready to move forward in the process. If either of these answers is "no," then we will need to have a long talk before going any further. During our first meeting I make it very clear that confidentiality, mutual honesty, working the Steps, meeting attendance and frequent contact are essentials in this process of recovery. I will not argue or debate; I only have my experience, strength and hope to share. We do not have to see eye-to-eye to walk hand-in-hand down this road of recovery.

There are four basic things that produce effective sponsorship. They are: *Listen, Learn, Love, and Lead*. Let's consider these one at a time.

Listen—I must listen closely to what the sponsee is saying, remembering that they are sick people. If I listen closely, they will tell me many things about themselves. Most newcomers have never had someone who would listen and not condemn or criticize them for expressing their feelings and thoughts.

Learn—I can learn by listening for deep-seated resentments, anger and fear. I can learn much about their drinking history, family and what false beliefs they may have acquired about how to live life. From my mistakes, I can learn how to be a better sponsor in the future.

Love—Practicing unconditional love toward the sponsee is essential for me as a sponsor. I should be kind, patient, not boastful or rude, not self-seeking or easily upset. I should encourage them as they make progress in the Steps and, when the difficult times arrive and they have an emotional upset, be compassionate and suggest, "Don't quit five minutes before the miracle happens." It is very important that I tell them the truth in a loving way and I must let them know that "*I care more about saving their life than I do about hurting their feelings.*"

Lead—"The basis of all sponsorship is to lead by example. Service sponsors can impart to their sponsees the pleasure of involvement in the work of Alcoholics Anonymous. This is best done by stressing the spiritual nature of service work and by pointing out the usefulness of simple footwork and faith." (*Questions & Answers on Sponsorship*, p. 29)

My sponsor demonstrates how to live the spiritual principles of the A.A. program. He led me into service work in my home group and district. Then I was encouraged to study the history and service structure of A.A. He showed me the different aspects of service; making coffee, serving on committees, setting up a meeting, participating in conferences, etc. Now I sponsor people into service. I let them know that they are a vital part of the whole and they can make a difference in the survival of A.A.

Dr. Bob summed up the meaning of the Twelve Steps in two words, love and service. That summary could apply to the meaning of sponsorship as well. We hold sponsees, like a bird, in the palm of our hand. If we squeeze our hand, we will keep the bird, but we will smother it. If we open our hand, we allow the bird to live and grow. But we also allow it the freedom to leave us and fly away. If we take action to help sponsees grow enough in the program to leave us—that is the true measure of our love and courage.

When we let people come into our lives we should also be willing to let them leave, because we are all on loan to each other. Nothing is permanent in life except the love that passes between us.

May God continue to give us the strength and courage to give back what was so freely given to us.

Charles Pederson, Southeast Texas

SERVICE

Tuesday afternoon's presentation/discussion session was moderated by Bill Clark, Class A trustee.

Performing Service Without Expectations

When I first saw the topic I was to present on, my first thought was, can I get a different topic? Then as I began to reflect on Performing Service Without Expectations, I realized this is a perfect topic for me to share about, due to the fact that I have fallen short in doing this many times.

In May 1935, Bill Wilson was pacing the lobby of the Mayflower Hotel in Akron, Ohio. (see *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, pp. 65, 66) Bill talks about the moment he realized he was going to get drunk, but the thought occurred to him that he needed to work with another drunk. Bill remembered that his thought was, "You need another alcoholic to talk to. You need another alcoholic just as much as he needs you!" We all know the story. Bill met Dr. Bob for the first time and shared with him the language of the heart—one alcoholic sharing with another alcoholic his experience, strength and hope. Bill took a taxi that day to Henrietta Seiberling's home, and Dr. Bob was going to give him 15 minutes, but they talked for hours. Bill put no expectations on Bob that day. He went with the idea that if he didn't give away what he had, he was going to drink after being sober six months. I often ask myself, would I have been that willing or as willing as many of the early pioneers of our program were?

When I think about that day when Bill met Bob for the first time and the countless sacrifices that the pioneers of our Fellowship have made, I realize just how much I fall short in performing service without expectations. When it comes to the newcomer and other areas of A.A. I think of my home group, the New Life Group in Huntington, West Virginia. We are an open meeting and usually at our meetings, patients from the local treatment facility join us. I cannot tell you how many times I have been asked by these patients for my phone number. My typical reply is, "Call me." Not once recently have I done as I was taught to do and asked one of the guys if they were allowed to have visitors, and would they care if I came in to sit down with them and go through the Big Book. I am always expecting them to call me. To be honest, there are times when a newcomer asks me for my number and right away I get concerned. Instead of thinking, "great, a newcomer to work with," I may think "how much of my time is this going to take?" After all, I have so much going on with being an A.A. member, husband, work and area delegate. I have to remem-

ber that all these things I have because of A.A. members who took the time out to perform service without expectations toward me when I needed help. Yet I am worried about a newcomer taking up too much of my time. The real kicker is that I am the one who will benefit from carrying this message of A.A., far more than the newcomer or any alcoholic who is still suffering. Whatever work I put into A.A., without expecting anything in return, I get back tenfold. It has always been a simple formula that I have complicated more than once. Can you imagine if Bill had told Henrietta Seiberling to have Bob call him when he was ready?

One other question that comes to mind with this topic: Do I or have I ever expected special treatment because I have been blessed to serve as delegate and in other service positions? This is yet another pitfall I can fall into with my ego—expecting some kind of special attention, because after all I am a delegate.

I have a friend in Kentucky who will jokingly tell people that I am president of A.A. in West Virginia. Now you know and I know that this couldn't be further from the truth. But there are times I need to be reminded that I am not any different from any other A.A. member, nor do I have any authority in A.A. just because I serve as delegate or serve in any other capacity within this great Fellowship. I thank God for a sponsor, solid home group members, other Area 73 committee members, and past Area 73 delegates, who help me keep my ego in check. I also thank God for the group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous, which is our only political authority. One of my favorite pieces of A.A. literature is "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," or as I like to call it, the Twelve Traditions for Dummies. The illustration about Tradition Two, which shows the A.A. member getting out of control and the group conscience pushing him back down, illustrates perfectly the need for me not to expect any special treatment when performing service work, and the dangers when I do so. I hope to strive to be the leader that is quoted by Bill in Concept IX in the section "Leadership in A.A.: Ever a Vital Need." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 38) There are many days I fall short of this ideal. Thank you for your time and attention. God bless you.

Al Siebel, West Virginia

Leadership—An Ever Vital Need

Concept IX states: "A leader in A.A. service is therefore a man (or woman) who can personally put principles, plans, and policies into such dedicated and effective action that the rest of us want to back him up and help him with his job." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 39)

I believe that leadership is all about leading by example, not dictatorship. Over my few 24-hour periods of sobriety, I have had the opportunity to observe, listen to and share with those who have gone before. I have witnessed people who have the ability to truly listen. These members, involved in setting an example of what Alcoholics Anonymous is all about, are compassionate, tolerant, and have the courage to speak assertively. They share their experience with new members, respect others, and have a vision for today, as well as for our future. A leader believes it is vital to encourage others to become involved in service, to protect our Steps, Traditions and Concepts, and to have a service sponsor. I remember well my first service position—being elected Public Information representative for my home group. I knew nothing of what the job required and proceeded in straightening up the literature rack and writing down what was missing. It was mentioned, loud and clear, that that was not my role.

At the district G.S.R. meetings I questioned the methods used in handling the business of the district. I am sure I tested many other service members to the limit. After much frustration on my part, my sponsor informed me that perhaps I should have a service sponsor. Yes, this folks, was the answer. I soon learned that the Traditions and Concepts worked very well and were what kept Alcoholics Anonymous united. Service sponsorship is paramount in order that we may learn as we climb down the ladder from when we first entered the doors of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Hopefully, as I have grown in the Fellowship of A.A., I, too, have learned to listen, to remember where I came from, that my way is not the only way to do something, and that you also have a right in sharing your view and doing your part.

Hopefully, I will always remember to be grateful, and to be active in the program of Alcoholics Anonymous. In Concept IX, Bill W. reminds us that although we are a society of equals, who serve one another like all societies, A.A. must have good leadership. Here Bill W. is speaking mainly of our trustees, as he believed that it would be the trustees who would, of necessity, function as A.A.'s primary leadership in world service. He also cautioned us that our leaders need not be perfect, but that they do need to be people of experience and to have the vision to see the larger picture and long-term needs.

Bill W. felt that vision was also the essence of prudence. Today, we seem to dwell on our differences, which only keeps us separate, rather than on our similarities, which unite us. One example: some people new to the program will state their name and that they are drug addicts, cross-addicted. I am finding that when this happens the "pure alcoholic" may refuse to acknowledge alcoholism along with "other problems."

In some cases we have bosses who rule, rather than trusted servants who do not govern. Unfortunately, this type of thinking is spiritually divisive. When this kind of issue arises I believe I have a choice. I can either choose to ignore the situation, or I can ask myself if I have an obligation to speak with the new person and to attempt to explain that even though they may have a problem with other addictions, our Fellowship is focused on alcoholism only and that there are other twelve step programs for drugs, smokers, overeaters, etc. Certainly, he or she is welcome at Alcoholics Anonymous to stay sober and to share with others on their alcoholism.

I cannot carry the message all on my own. Our Fellowship needs to work together to produce literature, videos, public service announcements, posters, newsletters, etc. It is my role to attract new people to service and to share why we are self-supporting, and to let them know that at a certain point in our sobriety we become grateful and want to give back to the Fellowship of our time and money. We learn that we feel good when we reach out to others. Self-interest is waning. We are finding a new freedom and happiness. We believe that there is more than just hope—there is true happiness in recovery and we want to keep in this frame of body, mind and spirit.

A leader is someone who can say when they are wrong and thank the person who pointed out that there is another way. To share my belief in a loving God of my understanding and that I really do care about my fellow man allows others to see this kind of action, which I believe is all part of being a leader. Do not walk in front of me without showing me the way; do not walk behind me as I am no better than you. Please walk beside me and call me a friend. Together, we can walk the path to happy destiny.

Barbara Kelly, Eastern Ontario

Responsibility With Accountability

When I first received the notice on this topic, my thoughts were "right on." Then I started doing a little writing, a little research, a little writing and a little more research. Please note I said writing first and then the research. You see, I am one of the lucky ones in this Fellowship who has been "responsible" since that Tuesday night during my third week in treatment when my treatment counselor sent me to another meeting, saying if I was going to stay sober, I needed to be involved. She was so right. So since that third week, my sobriety date is July 2, 1982, I have been "responsible." And those that know me get tired of my referring to the home group and district structure, which I sobered up in, but "responsibility with accountability" was the only option.

As a treatment rep for my home group, if I didn't go to the monthly District Treatment Committee meeting and sign our group up for hosting a treatment or detox meeting the following month, I was held accountable at the next group business meeting. As a group treasurer, G.S.R., D.C.M. and every position I have served in the area, being held accountable was expected. As a G.S.R., helping my home group make an "informed group conscience" on district and area agenda items was expected. As a D.C.M., helping the G.S.R.s understand the agenda items was expected. In each of the six elected positions that I have served the Western Washington Area, responsibility with accountability has been expected. When we serve as a sponsor or service sponsor, we have taken on a responsibility that, if we are not accountable, can have a direct impact on both the sponsee and sponsor.

The Seventh Tradition is a great example of "responsibility with accountability." A group can hardly hold its regular meetings on a street corner, with an empty basket. The principles of Tradition Two are crystal clear. Bill asserts that A.A. groups are to be the final authority and their leaders are to be entrusted with delegated responsibilities only.

Concept II delegated to the Conference complete authority for the active maintenance of our world services and thereby made the Conference—excepting for any change in the Twelve Traditions or in Article 12 of the Conference Charter—the actual voice and the effective conscience for our whole society. If the groups were to carry on their primary purpose, they would have to delegate their leadership role to a General Service Conference. They do this by electing a general service representative (G.S.R.).

My final reference will be to Concept III and the "Right of Decision." At all levels of service, every trusted servant and every A.A. entity has the right "to decide ... how they will interpret and apply their own authority and responsibility to each particular problem or situation as it arises." This right also means the Fellowship must have trust in its "trusted servants." If the groups instruct their G.S.R.s, rather than giving them a "Right of Decision," then the area assembly is hamstrung. If the G.S.R.s instruct the area delegates rather than giving them a "Right of Decision," then this Conference is hamstrung.

It is a great honor to be of service to our Fellowship. With that:

I am Responsible when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help,

I want the hand of A.A. always to be there.

And for that: I am responsible.

Dick Donahue, Western Washington

SELF-SUPPORT

The Wednesday afternoon session was moderated by James Branscome, Grapevine director.

Gratitude Through Self-Sacrifice

"Who has a topic for today's meeting? O.K., let's talk about gratitude." Following this announcement, we hear expressions of heartfelt thanks for A.A. and for being sober today. While these are no doubt sincere reflections of one's experiences, I am somehow saddened by the limitations of their definition. With the many possibilities to express our gratitude, why do we limit ourselves to those found solely in our day-to-day recovery?

My sponsor believed in gratitude as long as it was linked to action. In fact, the often quoted phrase in my home group was, "gratitude is an action word." Into action was an accepted responsibility to give back what I had received for free. The examples around me showed that it worked, which supported another common saying heard around the tables, "if you want what I have, do what I do." And so I wasn't surprised to find the dictionary state that gratitude is a feeling of being thankful to somebody for doing something.

Being at the appointed place, on time and doing the work that was asked of me, was a beginning. It was a sure cure for my self-pity, self-centeredness, self-sufficiency and selfishness. Whether it was pouring coffee in my home group, or going on a Twelfth Step call, I was entering a new pattern of thinking, not only of myself, but of others. A picture of Unity began to form. The smile from my face traveled to my heart. No matter how desolate my condition, I learned to feel grateful for the day.

Early on I learned about the spiritual connection of our Seventh Tradition by participating when the basket was passed at meetings. I was taught that gratitude would sometimes mean a sacrifice of money, despite one's financial condition. During my first year, my purse often contained only coins. I believed I had to keep every cent for my own personal needs and reasoned that when I had more money, I would put my dollar, or more, in the basket. This was my thinking until I found a sponsor. Dorothy made it clear that, as an act of gratitude, I could begin by putting a nickel in the basket. I had to exercise the faith that despite my financial fear, I would have enough money to live.

From this, I learned two important lessons: that I was a part of A.A. and that in giving whatever amount I could afford gave me trust in the process and of my higher power—and I always had enough money to pay the bills.

We had fine presentations this week on our financial picture, accompanied by charts and statistics. We saw where our money goes and heard the forecast for the future. This is important information for us to understand and share. But as we know, our tradition of self-support has been and always should be more than a set of figures.

It may be time for us to place emphasis on participation rather than contributions. It seems logical that one follows the other. With full participation comes self-support. This is true whether or not members are involved in service or members of their home groups. I believe that once we fully understand, we take the right course of action. The message of who we are, what we are, what we do and why we do it, the basics of our program, need to be shared. They need to be shared in our home groups, our service meetings, in P.I. and C.P.C. work and, most importantly, one person talking to another.

We should encourage self-support through contributions and always have that as a goal. Not for the monetary value but the value of continuing as one society in Unity.

The Seventh Tradition is about participation, and participation is the key to Unity. The simple act of contributing is an action taken in gratitude for our life. It is a way we can be a part of—a spiritual and financial payment of what we have so freely been given.

As we turn the pages of A.A. history, we are humbled by the many examples of dedicated service from the very formation of the program that we live today to the years of growth.... With these recollections, we are truly thankful for what we have. Yet we know this will not and cannot continue without our help. To continue to move A.A. forward from today and into the next generation we each play a critical role.

As A.A. members and groups, we have certain basic responsibilities. These are outlined in our literature and shared by our sponsors. We are entrusted with this knowledge and have a responsibility to pass it on.

Through the many portals of service we have been given many ways to express our gratitude. So we might ask ourselves, "Are we fully participating in A.A. as a whole by our actions and our self-support?" And in our groups, are we taking every opportunity to explain what services G.S.O. provides? Do we need to consider a card or sheet of information on the breadth of services from G.S.O.? Do we talk about services beyond our own structure to include our world services? And do we take the time when the basket is passed to read the Seventh Tradition, followed by an explanation of where our contributions go? Are we self-supporting at all levels of service? These are small but significant steps that pay great dividends, for it takes sacrifice and action by us all to maintain our spiritual fitness and ensure our existence as individuals and as a society.

Which leads me to ask, "Where are we today with self-support?" I believe we can all agree that we are self-supporting. This is seen when we look at how we receive monies—through the sale of our literature and voluntary contributions. In fact, Concept XII, Warranty Two, Bill W. reminds us that self-support includes sale of literature as well as voluntary contributions. If our aim is to be fully self-supporting through our contributions alone, it will require even greater sacrifices from us all.

So I have not talked about numbers but about the gratitude and spiritual significance of participation in self-support through participation and how it affects us all.

Whatever direction we take, A.A. cannot survive without our help. We have a tremendous responsibility and a joyful opportunity. A Twelve Step call, sponsoring, group services, G.S.R.s to trustees—all a vital part of keeping our Fellowship alive and growing. Gratitude, a result of being informed, getting involved—a blessing of change within and expansion of love to our fellow man. And with this we see full participation in our Seventh Tradition as the fullest expression of our gratitude.

Phyllis Halliday, Pacific regional trustee

An Informed Group Conscience

I believe that from the time Bill W.'s group members told him that they didn't think he could accept Charlie Towns' offer to become a therapist, up until today at this Conference, that a loving God expressing Himself through our group conscience has been one of the most spiritual aspects of Alcoholics Anonymous.

I would like to share a little of my experience with the Second Tradition. I was sober a couple of years before I found a group that held regular group conscience meetings. I was excited to find this group and to participate in the business meetings. Growing up in a family that debated politics at the dinner table, I was primed to give my opinion on all the issues being discussed at the group conscience meetings. It was exciting to see how business meetings work in A.A., especially when a minority opinion was given and

votes changed. However, the group started to make decisions that I did not think were correct. I started to get frustrated and upset. Through the suggestion of an oldtimer I began reading our literature and I came across the answer to my problem in *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*. I found that we are to take an informed group conscience. That was it! Clearly my fellow group members were not as well informed as I was. If they were they would agree with me. So I started trying to inform my fellow A.A. members.

Fortunately, due to sponsorship and loving oldtimers, this period of time was relatively short. I came to realize that a loving God is speaking through my group's conscience. I learned how a group conscience becomes informed. As Bill states on page 78 of *The Language of the Heart*, "Daily experience informs and instructs this conscience." It is not what we read or what we know that informs us, it is our experience.

This understanding has made Tradition Two very freeing for me. I no longer need to worry about the decisions we make in our group conscience. Sometimes God is expressing Himself through our group conscience to make us more effective in carrying our message to the still-suffering alcoholic. Other times He is setting up experiences to make us better informed. In any case, it is God, as the ultimate authority, working through our group conscience.

The importance of the informed group conscience is vital when it comes to our Tradition of self-support. My first home group did not have business meetings, and there was no reporting on how the money put in the basket was spent. In fact, three months a year, we would pass a second basket and send the money to a local homeless shelter. Not knowing about our Traditions, I thought that this was a very charitable act by the group.

As I became involved with another group, which had regular group conscience meetings, studied the Traditions and had a treasurer's report, I started to understand how the money in the basket is spent. When I became the treasurer of a group, I realized the importance of telling my fellow group members where the money was going. As I continued my journey in service at the district and area levels, I have helped in keeping our members informed on how the money that is contributed to us by the groups is used. During times when we were short on funds, I came to believe that if there is a need and the groups are informed, they will respond with contributions. As delegate, I believe a part of my job is to keep the Fellowship in my area informed on group service and Twelfth Step activities being done in A.A. as a whole, and the continuing need to contribute to these activities.

I have been fortunate enough to participate in the informed group conscience process on many different levels—the home group, district, area and intergroup, but nothing has matched participating in the informed group conscience as being part of the Conference process we partake of this week.

I came to last year's Conference with the informed group conscience of the Southern Minnesota Area. I had this informed group conscience in part by participating and listening at my area's assemblies and pre-Conference workshop, but mostly from my experience of 16 years of being an active member of the Southern Minnesota Area. I came prepared with my area's viewpoint but knowing, as *The A.A. Service Manual* tells me on page S44, my job was not to represent the conscience of my area but to become fully informed during the Conference discussion and vote in the best interests of A.A. as a whole.

Through the week of listening to trustees, A.A.W.S and Grapevine reports; participating in committee discussions and deliberations; listening to committee reports; and deliberating committee recommendations I was able to see an informed group conscience developed. I left the Conference engulfed in the spiritual experience of witnessing a loving God as He expressed Himself through

our group conscience; a desire to bring back what I experienced here to the A.A. members in my area; and with gratitude that I would once again be part of the process this year.

Mark Miller, Southern Minnesota

INTERNATIONAL

Thursday afternoon there were two presentations on A.A. Around the World. Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, was the moderator.

A.A. Around the World

I have the privilege of serving our Fellowship as trustee-at-large/U.S. In this capacity, I serve as one of two delegates from the U.S./Canada Conference structure to the World Service Meetings and the Zonal Meetings. A World Service Meeting is a biennial meeting of delegates from countries with an organized service structure. The meeting alternates between New York City and another country. This year the meeting will be held in Dublin, Ireland, on October 15-19. On the off years, we have the Zonal Meetings. I attended my first Zonal Meeting on October 5-9, 2005, in Puerto Plata, Dominican Republic. This meeting was the Meeting of the Americas—also known as the “Redela Meeting.” “Redela” in Spanish means “Reunion de las Americas.” The theme was “Sponsorship: Gratitude in Action, Country-to-Country.”

There were thirteen delegates from eleven countries present. Countries represented were: Brazil, Canada, Colombia, Costa Rica, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, Mexico, Peru, the United States, and Venezuela. This was a very intense business meeting, not unlike the General Service Conference. We started out with a flag ceremony, similar to the one held at the International Convention. As each country was called, the delegate from that country went to the banner and pointed to their flag and everyone cheered. This was an emotional time, because everyone was grateful to be able to be there. Every one of us was there for the same reason – to discuss how we can best reach the still-suffering alcoholic, not only one-on-one, but country-to-country. The statement of purpose was read, and the keynote address was given by Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada. Delegates gave their country highlights. Most of these countries suffer from the same difficulties: lack of participation, lack of a good service structure, lack of communication, lack of unity, how to reach the indigenous people, rough terrain, government, poverty, etc. Throughout the week, we had presentations, workshops, committee meetings and general sharing. We had a problem with translations, but the language of the heart was felt. The second day we got an announcement that the delegate from Cuba had been granted a visa and there were shouts of joy. Cuba has never been able to have a delegate attend. Evidently, there were other complications, so they again were unable to attend. Everyone was saddened by the announcement. There was a discussion about what we can do as members of the Redela to better serve the countries not represented. We have country-to-country sponsorship, but that is only a beginning.

The theme for the 56th General Service Conference is “Sponsorship, Service and Self-support in a Changing World.” When we talk about sponsorship, what do we mean? A sponsor is someone who takes responsibility for another person or thing. So, how is sponsorship at this Conference and the Redela similar? It has been my experience that if I am grateful, I will want to share what has been given to me. Through sponsorship, every one of us gives away what has been so freely given to us, be it person-to-person or country-to-country. When the message of

experience, strength and hope is shared, we will all live in a changing world. No matter when or where the language of the heart is spoken, people and countries change and want to pass this message on to someone or somewhere else. In person-to-person sponsorship, we share our recovery by telling what we were like, what happened and what we are like now. In country-to-country sponsorship we share what works and what doesn't work in carrying the message in our service structure. At the Redela and World Service Meetings, some countries sponsor other countries financially, making it possible for them to send a delegate to the meeting. They also help each other by purchasing and publishing literature, etc.

Let's take a look at the word “service.” Service is gratitude made visible (action). Bill W. wrote in *The A.A. Service Manual* (p. S1) that an A.A. service is anything whatever that helps us reach a fellow sufferer—ranging all the way from the Twelfth Step itself to a ten-cent phone call and a cup of coffee, and to A.A.'s General Service Office for national and international action. The sum total of all these services is our Third Legacy of Service. Our service work begins long before the General Service Conference, Zonal Meetings, or World Service Meetings are held. This is an ongoing process. We are here today because our Higher Power has a job for us to do, and that job began when we entered the rooms of Alcoholics Anonymous and became responsible. World Service Meeting delegates attend the meetings to share with other countries the importance of unity and service through our structure. We also carry with us the responsibility of reaching those countries that do not have a service structure. It doesn't matter where we serve, what matters is that we have the willingness to be of service.

“Self-Support.” Concept XII, Warranty Two states, “Our attitude toward the giving of time when compared with our attitude toward giving money presents an interesting contrast.” (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p.64) Sometimes members are so busy with their business positions, etc. that they feel their contributions at table tops are sufficient. We need to remember that we cannot separate money from spirituality and spiritual sacrifice. We cannot replace any amount of service with any amount of money. “A.A.'s hand is your hand.” Bill W. stated: “For A.A. to survive it needs a little money and a lot of hard work.” We are all asked to give our best to A.A., and in return, we know from our experience in recovery that A.A. will give back to us tenfold. As A.A. members, we need to help other members to fully understand what we belong to, to treasure each of our Traditions, and to support A.A. at all levels of service and in all countries with our contributions. This effort requires that each member understand that self-support goes to the heart of Alcoholics Anonymous spiritually and practically, for we understand that our Traditions (including the Seventh) keep us unified and able to carry the total message to the suffering alcoholic, wherever he or she may be.

On the last day of the Redela Meeting, members of the Fellowship were allowed to attend, and the delegates were asked to share their experience of the meeting. They shared that they now felt a part of something and knew they had a purpose. They felt the love of God and knew we could work in harmony. They were tired, but had the spirituality to keep working with their brothers. When God chooses us to serve, we must forget we are tired, because we have work to do and His strength will carry us through. One man said he will never be the same again. Everyone was emotional because we all felt we were a part of a great whole. Is this a changing world? Yes, we have had a spiritual experience and we are not the people we once were!

Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S.

Our theme this year, "Sponsorship, Service and Self-support in a Changing World," holds significance not only for us as A.A. members in the United States and Canada, but also for our fellow members in the international A.A. community.

I am perhaps the last of a generation connected to grandparents whose main mode of local transportation when they were growing up was the horse and buggy. Even by train or steamship, way back then, it could take days or weeks to travel to other parts of the country or to international destinations. This past August, I sat down on an airplane and in half a day, I was in Tokyo. On a recent trip, it took six hours for me to go to Dublin, Ireland. If the ground traffic were not so bad, you might be able to commute between New York and Toronto—it only takes 55 minutes to fly there. Our ways of communicating are changing, too. The general manager of the G.S.O. in Turkey called last month on his cell phone—he was driving around Istanbul looking for a parking place. I communicate, in seconds, via e-mail with members in Croatia, Bhutan, Bahrain, China and Venezuela, and I can do this sitting in an airport with my laptop and a wireless connection. For the past two Conferences, you have received reams of background material, scanned onto a CD. There's a whole new language of communication. We have Web sites and search engines and blogs and iPods and Dashboards. And you know the world has most certainly changed when some of the young men you sponsor have no idea who Spencer Tracy or Gary Cooper was.

In Bahrain, I met an Arab member whose sponsor lives in California; they talk several times a week using cell phones and the Internet. The European Service Meeting, which is one of the Zonal Meetings that takes place in the year between World Service Meetings, has an electronic newsletter so the delegates can keep up with what is happening in each other's countries. Recently, the entire translation of the Big Book in Sinhala, a language spoken in Sri Lanka, was sent to me electronically. There are Web sites that list meetings in the Middle East, India, Europe and Southeast Asia. I did a search on the Internet of "Alcoholics Anonymous" and nearly six million listings came up.

We have well-established online meetings. These groups may have members located around the world; the chairperson may be here, the treasurer in Germany and the secretary might be in India. We certainly live in a changing world.

For some time now, there has been what is called "country-to-country sponsorship." This service generally involves one country assisting another where A.A. is emerging by providing them with literature and sharing experience about our three Legacies. Assistance is also provided so that delegates from some of these countries can participate in Zonal Meetings or the World Service Meeting. Mexico sponsors Cuba, Japan sponsors Mongolia, Switzerland assists Croatia, we sponsor the Dominican Republic, while New Zealand and Australia help delegates in Cambodia, Thailand, Indonesia, and Vietnam attend the Asia Oceania Service Meeting. The European Service Meeting has a reserve fund developed from contributions made by participating countries, a part of which is earmarked to help delegates from less well-heeled European countries attend the ESM. The service structures of the United States/Canada and Great Britain shared in sponsoring the Second Sub-Saharan Service Meeting in Africa last year. In 2007 in Cameroon, the French and the United States/Canadian structures will share in sponsoring the First West Central African Service Meeting, bringing together delegates from French-speaking Africa. We also sponsor a substantial portion of the World Service Meeting.

As we know from our individual experiences, sponsorship, service and self-support require sacrifice; most of the principles and activities in Alcoholics Anonymous ask us to sacrifice many of our own self-interests for the good of the whole. We sacrifice

time and effort to sponsor a newcomer or attend an area meeting. A monetary contribution is a sacrifice and from such giving flow many benefits—a group's rent is paid; an intergroup or central office can take care of its phone bill; a district can place Big Books in libraries; an area can send a delegate to the Conference; and G.S.O. can translate, publish and ship our literature to fledgling A.A. communities in other countries. This can be a challenging effort for us as members, as well as for groups and service structures. But the major benefit is saved lives.

All of us are charged with the responsibility of working together in this spirit of sacrifice. The importance of doing service and the need for A.A. to be self-supporting is ideally passed on through sponsorship from one member to another, just as sharing the experience of recovery through the Twelve Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous is passed on from one member to the next. Sponsorship, service and self-support help sustain A.A. unity on a worldwide basis.

In *AA Today*, a special publication by the A.A. Grapevine commemorating the 25th Anniversary of Alcoholics Anonymous, Bill W. wrote:

"Our fellowship has been permitted to achieve—though still in miniature—the 'one world' dream of philosophers. Ours is a world in which we can hotly differ, yet never think of schism or conflict as a solution. As a fellowship, we ask nothing of wealth or power. As we better use the 'language of the heart,' our communications grow apace: already we find ourselves in safe passage through all those barriers of distance and language, of social distinction, nationality and creed, that so divide the world of our time.

"For so long as we remain sure that our 'one world of A.A.' is God's gift rather than any virtue earned or created by ourselves; and for so long as our 'one world' continues to be evermore inclusive of those in need; and for so long as we speak and try to perfect the language of love—for just so long may we count upon making whatever rendezvous with destiny that God would have us."

Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff member

ARCHIVES

Friday morning, the last presentation/discussion session was chaired by Don Miller, A.A.W.S. director.

A.A.'s Service Legacy

I have perhaps the least A.A. tenure here, having been at the General Service Office for only forty-some days. But I hope to be here to assist A.A. in celebrating its centennial, 29 years from now. At the moment I'm just trying to get up to speed.

I'd like to speak briefly of my own history with A.A. The organization has been a big part of my life, as my father, his father, and his brother, sisters, aunts, uncles, and cousins have all been A.A.s. This Fellowship, along with Al-Anon, saved my family. The Goldsmith Lane Group, which meets Wednesday nights in Louisville, Kentucky, has been full of Filiatreaus since 1963, and is still like a weekly family reunion.

I grew up immersed in A.A. I attended my first open meeting, one of my father's birthday meetings, when I was about twelve years old. I knew well all the men my father was sponsoring. They were like family. I knew he would be gone every Wednesday evening and sometimes twice more each week at meetings, and I knew that every year he would be attending the 2:00 a.m. Christmas Eve meeting, trying like so many others to stay sober during that difficult time. Occasionally he would have to leave abruptly to go pick someone up at the jail or at the hospital. I wit-

nessed the good he has done, and how he does it—quietly and without desire for recompense or acknowledgement. These acts moved me just as much as his sobriety. A.A.s not only help fellow alcoholics; in many ways they show the rest of us how to live, too.

This activity takes place all over the world, every day, and has since A.A.'s founding. Service and sponsorship—themes of this Conference—are played out as one human helping another, driving him or her to meetings, giving him or her an option not to drink. Answering the phone. This is how A.A.'s history is made; individuals deciding to serve and sponsor.

Very few organizations value their history the way A.A. does. I've served as archivist for many organizations and corporations, and I've never seen a place that so consistently and unabashedly looks to its past, its founders and founding principles, for guidance in addressing the future. Usually, historians and archivists are begging their institutions' leaders to remember the past, clamoring to get people to use wisdom gathered through hard experience. But, to be frank, we are usually completely ignored.

In too many organizations, the past is considered dusty and useless, and is cast aside in search of something new, jazzy, and gaudy. Few individuals consult history to make sure they aren't repeating mistakes. Archivists have to work to prove the relevance of history, though their efforts are too often to no avail. It can be a frustrating experience.

From what I have seen in my time here, A.A. is exactly the opposite. It is a beautiful thing for an archivist. The history is vital and living. Individual members all over the world revere the history and study it carefully. You actively participate in it by preserving records in your area, ensuring that the records of today will survive to become the history of tomorrow. A.A. seems to understand that history is not, by definition, *old*. It is being made right here and in your local groups today.

Bill and Dr. Bob both understood the value of the history of Alcoholics Anonymous and endeavored to capture it before it faded. Bill, though, had hesitated before sitting down to write *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, feeling that other demands on his time would prevent him from doing as good a job as the task merited. As he later wrote in a letter around the time of the book's publication: "I am sending you a copy of 'A.A. Comes of Age.' As you see, it is a sort of symposium which adds up to a make-shift history of A.A.—the best that I could do. I was reluctant to even try this, but concluded that something direct from me to A.A. was better than nothing at all. It has been better received, however, than I thought it might be."

Bill understood, too, that there was a need not only for published histories, but for oral and video recordings of A.A. members and events. He said, "It isn't hard to prepare a fact sheet of what happened... the hard thing to lay hold of is the atmosphere of the whole proceedings and anecdotal material that will make the early experience live."

The G.S.O. Archives is fortunate to have thousands of audio and video recordings, many of them recorded speeches and words of Bill W. and the early events of the Fellowship. Most of these recordings were made on cassette or reel-to-reel tape, and were deteriorating quickly. Thankfully, we have been able to preserve these, converting them to digital recordings on high-quality archival CDs.

The fruits of these labors are clear—we now have cataloged hundreds of early recordings clearly articulating the Steps, Traditions, and the Three Legacies. Many of these recordings address the themes of this Conference—Service, Sponsorship and Self-support. These are powerful recordings, wonderful to hear.

In a letter in 1959, Bill wrote to Estelle Silverton, whose husband Hal had just died. Hal and Estelle were A.A. pioneers who started groups in San Diego back in 1940. He wrote: "As you know, there is a singular, a unique bond between us old timers.

We shall be gone from the scene and I trust that history will record we left something worthwhile behind us."

In the spirit of the theme of Service, and with these remarks from Bill in mind, I would like to play for you an excerpt from a recording that illustrates his thought process surrounding these issues, as A.A. was growing up. Bill gave this talk in 1954 in front of a group of A.A.s in Fort Worth, Texas. He spoke at length about A.A. history, and specifically, of the development of the Third Legacy:

...So there was a long discussion, in which I had a sad falling out with a good many of my friends, some of whom had been trustees, and it was quite a bitter and harrowing chapter in our affairs, which none of you know about.

This struggle, to see whether this movement would always be headed by a self-perpetuating hierarchy of oldtimers, or whether these affairs, so vital to the welfare of A.A. all over the world, should be turned over to you.

And finally, after six years of hassling about it, I finally got the consent of the Board of Trustees to come out to you, and tell you this story, and to say:

"Here is a means, which in an experimental form, we have put in a pamphlet marked 'The Third Legacy:'

"Here is a means by which you can get some delegates and state committeemen, and send folks up to New York, to take charge and to take over what is now your business.

"And so why don't you come up there and look this deal over, and the trustees will agree to make themselves responsible to you instead of to nobody.

"And you look it over and see what you think about it, and if at the end of four years you like the way that it's temporarily laid out, then we'll drive a plug in this thing, then we oldtimers up there, including yours truly, will say, 'Look folks, these vital services are yours, to have and to hold.'

"This Conference of delegates shall hereafter be the custodians and the guardians of our Traditions. This is yours. This is the remainder of your Third Legacy. Will you accept it?"

So, since 1951 we have been holding these yearly Conferences, to see whether this movement was interested enough, was responsible enough, felt those services were worthwhile enough, to maintain so long as God will need this society.

And I think it's the conclusion of every delegate who has been there that yes, we should take these things over.

So, in 1955 we purpose to hold an International Convention, at which time, on behalf of the oldtimers, and of Smithy and me, we shall say to you, here is the remainder of your Third Legacy.

This Conference shall become our successor.

To you we hand the last torch. Carry on. Face your destiny with surety and courage, and God love you.

His words demonstrate that men and women like you are shaping Alcoholics Anonymous, past, present and future. You make the history of A.A. by your actions each day and your service to this Fellowship.

I look forward to continuing the monumental efforts of my predecessors, the archivists who came before me, and the archivists working at the local level, to gather the history you have made. Together we can continue to preserve these works and make them accessible to the Fellowship.

Amy Filatreau, G.S.O. archivist

Reports from the General Service Board and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

Trustees' report: Once more we are entering that significant week of the year when we come together from all corners of Canada and the United States to meet, discuss, inform, and share our collective experience, strength and hope. The timing of this Conference is especially significant in that we are entering the second half of the first century since Bill W. turned the ongoing stewardship of the Fellowship over to the Conference. Our theme this year is particularly appropriate in that it conveys the sacrifices each participant continues to make to ensure that A.A. is a spiritual experience for all who work to foster our Three Legacies.

A highlight for all of us this last year was the International Convention, held in Toronto, Ontario. Over 44,000 A.A. members, families and friends from 88 countries joined together for a joyful celebration of A.A.'s 70th Anniversary. This event involved lengthy and careful planning by the G.S.O. staff and board members, the commitment of volunteer workers and the enthusiasm of participants to make it a successful and memorable experience. For the first time, members from Cuba, Mongolia and Peoples Republic of China participated in the opening Flag Ceremony on Friday evening. At Sunday's closing meeting the 25th millionth Big Book was presented to San Quentin State Prison in California, in memory of our dear friend of A.A. and pioneering warden, Warden Clinton Duffy.

Since the 55th Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Portland, Maine; Great Falls, Montana; Houghton, Michigan; Rogers, Arkansas; and Winnipeg, Manitoba. A Special Forum was held in Homer, Anchorage, Fairbanks and Juneau, Alaska. Each of these Forums was a celebration of the "s" words—singleness of purpose, self-support, sponsorship, spirituality and service.

This year we welcomed six new trustees to the board: Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee Jeanne Woodford, as well as five Class B (alcoholic) trustees: Paul Cleary, general service trustee, Howard Lowery, Southeast regional trustee; Ray Massey, general service trustee; Robert Mayer, East Central regional trustee; and Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S. At the close of this annual meeting, three trustees will rotate: Ronald Gauthier, Phyllis Halliday and Robert Pelot. We are grateful for their dedication, self-sacrifice and tireless service on behalf of the Fellowship.

Several years ago the Grapevine was outsourcing some of its operations and asked A.A.W.S. to present a proposal. The General Service Board discussed this in executive session. One trustee observed that the General Service Board has two corporations that are both publishing and providing service. The chairs of the AA Grapevine, Inc. and A.A.W.S. and the general manager of G.S.O. were appointed to a committee to look into this matter. That committee met for the first time in December 2003 and defined their mission: "To develop an agenda for discussion and inventory taking by the General Service Board with regard to the structures of the three corporations and the relationship between the three boards. No actions will be taken without prior knowledge and/or where appropriate, approval from the General Service Conference."

This resulted in the formation of two committees to consider where we are going and the most efficient ways of operating. One committee was asked to explore various aspects of the AA Grapevine, A.A.W.S. and the General Service Board. The other committee was appointed to review the Bylaws and Certificates of Incorporation of all three boards.

The work of the first committee led to three additional General Service Board meeting weekends devoted entirely to inventories of the three boards. The inventory of AA Grapevine, Inc. took

place March 19-20, 2005, the A.A.W.S., Inc. inventory happened December 10-11, 2005 and the General Service Board took its inventory March 18 -19, 2006. The inventories were productive, with good suggestions for improvements. The board will be looking at ways to implement some of the suggested changes.

The second committee carefully reviewed the Bylaws and Certificates of Incorporation of all three boards. Its suggested changes to AA Grapevine and A.A.W.S. Bylaws and Certificates of Incorporation have been reviewed and accepted by the relevant boards and will be presented to the members of the General Service Board for approval at its annual meeting following the Conference. Changes to General Service Board Bylaws and the Certificate of Incorporation must be approved by the General Service Conference. The Conference Committee on Trustees will be considering two recommendations from the General Service Board to revise its Bylaws and Certificate of Incorporation.

In response to the 2005 Conference Policy and Admissions Committee's additional consideration requesting that the General Service Board furnish a report on the feasibility of more balanced composition/structure of regions, I appointed a "Regional Composition and Structure Inventory" ad hoc committee. The committee includes four regional trustees, one general service trustee and a trustee-at-large. Aside from preparing the feasibility report, the charge of the ad hoc committee remains wide open. It was agreed that the scope of this committee would involve a review of extensive background material and a broad discussion on all aspects of "regions" and "regional trustees" before a final report is submitted to the board. This week the feasibility report prepared by the ad hoc committee and forwarded from the board will be reviewed by the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In November, Gary Kluksdahl, Southwest regional trustee, Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., Greg Muth and I participated in an event called "Spiritual Homecoming Comes Alive" in St. Louis, Missouri. It was a national (U.S./Canada) event commemorating the 50th anniversary of A.A. coming of age and was coordinated by a committee of past delegates from Area 38, Missouri. It was a tribute to the General Service Conference and its historic significance in carrying the A.A. message around the world.

In January we were delighted to welcome the delegate chair and chairpersons of the Conference committees to the quarterly General Service Board meeting in January. The chairpersons attended an orientation meeting at G.S.O. and sessions of their corresponding trustees' committees as guest observers. They were invited to attend other meetings of the trustees, including the board meeting. Having the delegate chairpersons present for this quarterly meeting continues to be an integral part of the sharing that brings us together at this Conference.

In February, we welcomed our new G.S.O. archivist, Amy Filiatreau. Amy assumed Judit Olah's responsibilities following Judit's resignation in August 2005. We remain deeply grateful to Judit for nine years of dedicated service and for her professional contributions to the enlarging, cataloging and preservation of A.A. history. I hope you will take the time this week to meet Amy. A certified archivist, Amy has a record of leadership and success in administering collections, as well as deep experience in preservation and access of collections for corporations, museums, libraries and archives. In addition to her academic accomplishments, professional knowledge and skills in Archives' management, Amy brings solid project-management experience, advanced technical skills and goal-oriented abilities to her position with G.S.O.

At the 55th General Service Conference, it was reported that the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, is available in 52 languages

worldwide. Currently the translation for the Big Book in Hebrew is near completion, and the Arabic *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* is in progress. It is the board's continuing responsibility to safeguard the integrity of A.A.'s written message in all languages. Toward that end, your Publications Department is responsible for overseeing translations of Conference-approved books. I am happy to report that since last April, the *Daily Reflections* in Simplified Chinese and Latvian became available.

Publications staff also maintains contact with General Service Offices or committees in other countries to achieve accurate translations of Conference-approved pamphlets. Among some of the pamphlets translated in the last year are: Hmong, "44 Questions," "A Newcomer Asks," "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," "This is A.A." and "Is A.A. for You?"; and in Danish, "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?" Nearing completion are several pamphlets in various languages. In each case, the translation reflects the original (English) manuscript, and the practice of assuring that the basic A.A. message is tied to our principles and primary purpose.

Last summer, as Hurricane Katrina's devastating forces struck Louisiana, Mississippi and Alabama, our heartfelt thoughts and prayers extended to those in its path. Shortly afterwards, G.S.O. received an outpouring of calls and e-mails from loving and concerned groups and members wishing to help A.A.s in the affected communities. Because of continuous and generous contributions from A.A. groups and members to the General Service Board, our Publications Department was ready to respond to requests for literature received from local offices and committees involved in setting up A.A. meetings for evacuees far from home. As communication lines opened, G.S.O. staff attempted to contact delegates, trustees and local offices to offer support and to fill any literature needs they might have. The International Council of Young People in A.A. (ICYPAA) Convention and the 10th National Archives Workshop (NAW), which were scheduled to take place in New Orleans that week, naturally, were postponed.

Every A.A. dollar received at G.S.O. on behalf of the General Service Board is used on a priority basis to carry A.A.'s message when a need is expressed. This includes responding to literature needs after all types of disasters: hurricanes, fires, floods, earthquakes, mud slides, etc. In order to be able to respond whenever, wherever, there is an expressed need, we do not accept A.A. funds that are earmarked for disaster relief or any other specific project.

In January, G.S.O. hosted an EAP (Employee Assistance Program) and Human Resources Day of Sharing. This event was the brainchild of Elaine McDowell, trustee emeritus, and Joanne Pilat, Regional EAP Representative at United Airlines, over a meal in Venice, Italy. Many months later, the Day of Sharing came to fruition with eleven national and regional EAP and HR professionals, Elaine, Greg Muth, myself, and staff members Irene Kontje, Doug Richardson, Rick Walker, Julio Espallat, and Robin Bromley. Our guests heard what A.A. is and about A.A.'s history of cooperation with the professional community. We gained insight on how A.A. might approach EAP/HR professionals to provide information and shared experience. Our guests welcomed ideas for providing A.A. information to their workforce and the potential for linking to A.A.'s Web site, utilization of our Public Service Announcements, and the availability of local C.P.C. committees as a resource. The Spring 2006 *About A.A.* newsletter for professionals features an article about this event.

Early this year, the U.S. Department of State contacted G.S.O. to arrange a visit to the office for eight professionals from Russia who are concerned about alcoholism in their country and interested in Alcoholics Anonymous. In February, the delegation from Russia, including Siberia and remote communities of eastern

Russia, along with their translators, visited the General Service Office. Joining me for this special visit were Elaine McDowell, Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., Greg Muth and two G.S.O. staff members. Following introductions and welcoming remarks, a sharing session took place where questions about A.A. were raised and addressed. The visitors were also invited to attend the open A.A. meeting at G.S.O. to learn more about how the A.A. program of recovery works and to hear the language of the heart.

Our Russian friends spoke of the immense challenges they face in dealing with alcoholism in the rural communities of Siberia. The visit coincided with new opportunities to be of service. Greg Muth and Doug Richardson were already arranging travel to Russia in the summer following Mongolia's 2nd A.A. Convention, and agreed to include a visit with one of our new friends and a federal health committee in Moscow. These arrangements are being made with the full cooperation of the Russian General Service Board and G.S.O. in Moscow.

This week you will hear presentations and read reports from our trustees-at-large and the staff on international trips and events such as zonal meetings and service meetings in countries that include Australia, Bahrain, Belarus, China, Cuba, Dominican Republic, Germany, Great Britain, Ireland, Japan, Russia, South Africa and Tahiti, where there were opportunities for participants to share experience on carrying the A.A. message worldwide.

When we read Bill W.'s three Convention talks on the Legacies of Recovery, Unity and Service, we are reminded of the inspiration of our co-founder and the God-given ability he possessed in articulating them. These Legacies continue to be the template against which we can measure ourselves, our actions and our decisions that will shape and guide Alcoholics Anonymous into the future.

Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D., chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation. The trustees of the General Service Board are the members of A.A.W.S. and elect the A.A.W.S. directors, who are responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), which provides group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature. The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the last Conference to receive G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group services activity and progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations; review financial reports; price new or revised publications; review publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature; and address other matters as they arose.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors. Currently, four are trustees, including two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three are nontrustee directors; and the G.S.O. general manager and the staff coordinator also serve as directors. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are the senior advisor to the general manager, G.S.O. staff members, the controller, publications director, human resources manager, archivist, board secretary, and a representative from the Grapevine office. The board welcomed guests, trustees, appointed members of trustees' committees, delegates and other A.A. members to its meetings during the year.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services, which considers the needs of all service assignments; Publishing, which reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance, which oversees salary and budget, audit review, and

retirement; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole.

Visitors and Special Guests — G.S.O. welcomed 1,818 visitors during 2005, as well as several groups of 15-50 members, some traveling great distances to spend a day in their office. Following the 2005 International Convention, a small group of the staff and employees opened the office on July 5th, an office holiday, to welcome over 200 excited Convention-goers who visited New York and our office en route home.

A delegation of eight professionals from Russia, including Siberia and remote communities, visited G.S.O. for a half day of sharing on February 10. Leonard Blumenthal (chair of the General Service Board), Elaine McDowell (trustee emeritus) and Dorothy Wilson (trustee-at-large/U.S.), joined Greg Muth and Doug Richardson in providing information on Alcoholics Anonymous. The U.S. State Department coordinated the visit in response to the delegation's expressed interest in A.A. as a resource.

New Groups — A net total of 1,100 new A.A. groups registered with G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact received A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with the local structure and to support Twelfth Step service work. G.S.O. welcomes every opportunity to share with A.A. members and groups.

Hurricane Katrina — G.S.O. staff contacted central/intergroup offices in the devastated areas and beyond to express G.S.O.'s support of services for the many A.A. members who sought refuge in communities far from home. Local office staffs expressed gratitude and shared that groups and members were actively engaged in Twelfth Step work, and that no request was unfulfilled. We learned that several central/intergroup offices had encouraged members to contribute literature through orders placed with G.S.O. for shipment to the local office(s). A.A. members responded to those requests with generosity and compassion. Additionally, our Publications Department fulfilled literature requests from affected offices.

When major disasters such as Hurricane Katrina occur, the G.S.O. staff receives numerous calls from members asking how they can help their fellow A.A.s. The October/November 2005 issue of *Box 4-5-9* included a special insert to address frequently asked questions about helping A.A.s in affected areas.

Group Records — The annual update of group records began in mid-November when our Records Department sent a letter to all area registrars/secretaries asking that each select a preference for receiving data, on Del/Area program disk, printed group information sheets, or both. This cooperative process between G.S.O. Records personnel and area registrars/secretaries culminates with publication of A.A. Directories in the summer. Plans are underway to rewrite the Fellowship data base to make it operate more efficiently and provide easier access for area registrars as they help us keep our records current. This will help area record keepers with the challenges faced in maintaining accurate group records.

Regional and Special Forums — Since the 55th Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in five Regional Forums: Northeast in Portland, ME, May 20-22; West Central in Great Falls, MT, September 30-October 2; East Central in Houghton, MI, November 4-6; Southwest in Rogers, AR, December 2-4; and Western Canada in Winnipeg, MB, February 24-26. Trustees and staff also attended a Special Forum in Homer, Anchorage, Fairbanks and Juneau, Alaska, August 19-22.

International Convention — The 70th Anniversary International Convention of Alcoholics Anonymous took place in Toronto, Ontario, June 30-July 3, 2005, with over 44,000 A.A. members, families and friends in attendance. At Sunday's closing meeting the 25-millionth Big Book was presented to San Quentin State Prison in California, and was accepted by Warden Jill Brown. The

Convention also marked the 50th Anniversary of co-founder Bill W.'s turning over responsibility for A.A.'s future to the General Service Conference. This memorable and successful Convention incurred a deficit of \$39,040, less than 1% of the total Convention expenses.

Annual Intergroup Seminar, September 30-October 2 — Chris Cavanaugh, Andrea Brennan, Carole Harley, John Hackett—as well as Tom Jasper and Warren Stafford—attended the 20th Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar in Charlotte, North Carolina. Managers from various offices around the U.S. and Canada expressed gratitude for the then upcoming major accounts' online sales capability.

Annual Day of Sharing, August 24 — Irene Kontje and Rick Walker participated in the annual Day of Sharing hosted at Al-Anon's World Service Office in Virginia Beach, Virginia. The Day of Sharing also included participation of representatives from the National Council on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence.

World Convention of Narcotics Anonymous, September 1-4 — As a guest of the N.A. Board, Greg attended the 31st World Convention of Narcotics Anonymous in Honolulu, Hawaii.

Spiritual Homecoming, November 25-27 — Greg Muth attended the "Spiritual Homecoming Comes Alive" event in St. Louis, Missouri, commemorating the 50th anniversary of co-founder Bill W.'s turning over responsibility for A.A.'s future to the General Service Conference in 1955 in St. Louis.

EAP Day of Sharing, January 12 — Eleven regional and national level EAP/HR representatives attended a day of sharing hosted by G.S.O. Leonard Blumenthal, Elaine McDowell (trustee emeritus), Greg, four G.S.O. staff members and Grapevine's executive editor, Robin Bromley, participated in the event. The EAP/HR professionals learned more about A.A. and how A.A. cooperates with professionals.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site — The board approved the 2005 Annual Web Site Activity Report, and forwarded it to the trustees' Public Information Committee. In 2005, there were over three million visits to the Web site, 27% more than in 2004.

The board approved recommendations from the Intra-Office Web Site Committee to include the A.A.W.S. policy: "Translation of A.A. Literature, including Publication and Licensing Considerations" under the policies section of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and the inclusion of a break-point between G.S.O.'s A.A. and the Grapevine Web sites.

The redesigned Web site (www.aa.org) was launched on schedule, December 31, 2005, providing visitors to the site expanded access to historical and current information on Alcoholics Anonymous.

Postings to the G.S.O. Web Site — The Pamphlets "Understanding Anonymity," "A.A. for the Native North American," "Can A.A. Help Me Too?," "A.A. for the Woman," "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" and "Problems Other Than Alcohol"; calendar of G.S.B. and A.A.W.S. events; and, the Archives CD — *History of Services*.

International — Trustees and G.S.O. staff traveled overseas to share with A.A. members and trusted servants in other service structures.

Adrienne Brown attended the Second Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting in Johannesburg, South Africa, June 3-5.

Greg Muth and Chris Cavanaugh visited the General Service Offices in Moscow, and Minsk, Belarus, and met with board members, July 12-17. The purpose of this trip was to establish a distribution relationship between G.S.O.s for Moscow and Minsk. It has become increasingly difficult to prudently print and distribute Russian literature for A.A. in Belarus. After considering options, a purchase order was issued to G.S.O. Moscow, authorizing a specific printing of literature at cost, and direct delivery of the order to G.S.O. Minsk.

Following a visit to G.S.O. in Sydney, Australia, Greg Muth and Doug Richardson attended the 6th Asia/Oceania Zonal Meeting in Surfer's Paradise, August 9-16. August 24-September 4, Doug visited the service office in Beijing, China, the G.S.O. in Tokyo, and attended the 30th Anniversary Convention of A.A. Japan held in Fukuoka. Doug attended the 13th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany, and visited Germany's G.S.O. in Munich, September 30-October 3. As a guest observer, Doug attended the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA), October 5-9, held in Puerto Plata, Dominican Republic, where trustees-at-large, Murray MacIntosh and Dorothy Wilson participated as zonal delegates. Doug attended the 5th Annual Gulf Coast Countries Convention in Manama, Bahrain, November 15-20, and witnessed the formation of a service committee, "The Middle East Regional Committee." Doug and regional trustee Bob Pelot, attended the 1st A.A. Convention in Papeete, Tahiti, celebrating 27 years of A.A. in French Polynesia, where they participated in several service meetings and met with professionals, December 15-22.

February 19-22, Don Meurer (chief financial officer), John Kirwin (event planner), and Doug traveled to Malahide, Ireland, for on-site planning meetings for the 19th World Service Meeting that will be held October 15-19. Doug also visited Ireland's G.S.O. in Dublin and Great Britain's G.S.O. in York.

Financial — (Details available in the Report of the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.) A summary of financial results for 2005 reflects gross sales of \$11,923,800, approximately \$524,000 (4.6%) greater than budgeted and \$303,000 (2.6%) greater than in 2004. Contributions from groups and members totaled \$5,417,000, compared with \$5,275,000 budgeted and \$5,191,634, for 2004. Contributions from foreign countries to assist the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund amounted to \$135,000 for 2005, compared with \$128,000 for 2004.

Total revenue of \$12,103,100 for 2005 was \$1,092,000 (or 10%) greater than budgeted and \$1,213,700 (about 11%) ahead of last year. Operating expenses came to \$11,126,900, approximately \$32,000 (2%) more than budgeted and about \$90,000 less than 2004. Net profit was \$976,170 compared with a budgeted loss of \$83,500 (after mid-year adjustments) and was \$1,069,000 better than budgeted. This compares with the loss of \$312,151 in 2004.

Mid-Year Budget Adjustments (2005) — The board approved and forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee mid-year 2005 budget adjustments totaling \$100,000 to cover the cost of items requested by the 2005 General Service Conference that include a rewrite of the pamphlet "Too Young?," tracking and distribution of PSA "Living in Chaos," PI video study to replace two young peoples videos, start of next PSA series and test footage for proposed Corrections video. In addition, the board discussed a request from the Archives Department for \$55,000 in immediate funding to cover the cost of an emergency preservation project and agreed to notify the trustees' Finance Committee of this over-budget expense.

2006 Budget — Upon recommendation of the A.A.W.S. Finance Committee, the A.A.W.S. Board approved the 2006 budget and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review. The board approved the recommendation for additional funding to the Pension Plan of \$141,000 for fiscal year 2005. The board also approved the resolution and authorizations for new checking accounts and signature cards.

Publications: Unit Distribution of Books — In 2005, G.S.O. distributed a total of 2,104,525 units, down 5% from 2,219,591 units in 2004. In 2005, A.A. purchases totaled 1,670,763 units; while non-A.A. purchases accounted for 433,726 units, or 21%.

Big Book Sales (all editions) — For 2005, 974,880 book units were distributed, compared to 1,201,569 units in 2004.

International Convention Items — The Publications Department was responsible for design, production and on-site sales of several new products to be introduced at the International Convention that included the 2005 Souvenir Book (English, French and Spanish) with companion DVD (English); Archives CD "History of Services," with talks by our founding members and early friends of A.A. selected from our vast collection; an archival souvenir bookmark; a special wallet card commemorating the 2005 Convention; and 60,000 International Convention programs.

Publication of the Summer/Fall 2005 A.A. literature catalog was distributed in June and includes instructions for calculating the shipping fee. The 2005-2006 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* (English, French and Spanish) and *Advisory Actions of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous* (English) were updated to include the actions of the 55th General Service Conference.

Pricing — On July 1, 2005, the \$1.00 price increase on all books (except all formats of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*) and the implementation of a 10% service charge on all orders under \$250.00, with a minimum service charge of \$3.00, became effective. This was approved by the board in January 2005 and reported at the 55th General Service Conference.

Consistent with previous policy, the board approved a price of \$10.00 for the remaining inventory of the Approved Souvenir Book/DVD (until current stock is exhausted) and Archives Audio CD *History of Services*. The Archives Audio CD sold for \$15.00 at the International Convention.

The board also forwarded to the trustees' Archives Committee the following proposed agenda item for consideration by the 2006 Conference Archives Committee: "That the Conference Archives Committee annually review a list of proposed archival recordings (format to be determined by A.A.W.S.) to be produced for sale by A.A.W.S. so that the Conference might provide guidance prior to production."

The board approved a price of \$10.00 for the 2005 Conference-approved Television Public Service Announcement, "Living in Chaos."

Translations and Licensing Projects — Translations completed include: updated Romanian and Russian, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, that include the Foreword and the Twelve Concepts from the Fourth Edition; Sinhalese, "Information on A.A."; Simplified Chinese, A.A. Guidelines on "Central and Intergroup Offices," "Clubs" and "For Members Employed in the Alcoholism Field" and *Daily Reflections*; Czech and Korean, "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous"; Larvian, *Daily Reflections*; Hmong, "44 Questions," "A Newcomer Asks," "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," "Information on A.A.," "This is A.A.," and "Is A.A. for You?"; Danish, "Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?"

Licenses were granted to boards or committees serving A.A. in their countries to translate and/or print and distribute: Japanese, *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*, A.A. Guidelines on "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Professionals," "A.A. in Treatment Facilities," and "Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?"; Swedish, *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers* and "Pass It On"; Arabic, "Information on A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks," "Is A.A. For Me?," "44 Questions," "This is A.A.," "Is A.A. For You?," *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, and *Alcoholics Anonymous* (4th Edition); Ecuador to print and distribute Spanish *Living Sober*; Dutch, "A.A. in Your Community," "Understanding Anonymity," "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," "Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends" and "Problems Other Than Alcohol"; and, Polish, *Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers*; Portuguese, "Questions & Answers on Sponsorship" and "The Jack Alexander Article about A.A."

Canadian and Overseas Fulfillment — We phased out the Toronto ASL Distribution Center, are planning to stop shipping from the Vienna warehouse, and completed the transfer of inter-

national literature inventory and fulfillment to DataMart in Montreal, Quebec. As a result, pick/pack costs for orders will go down about 37% from \$13.50 U.S. per order to \$10.00 CAN (\$8.50 U.S.). In August, production manager Carole Harley and order entry manager Andrea Brennan visited our new distribution center in Montreal to go over computer systems and practices with both executives and hands-on employees.

Online Ordering System — In response to the board's approval of the Publishing Committee's recommendation in 2005 to establish a Web-based, wholesale ordering system for area, districts, central/intergroup offices and other large purchasers, online ordering was implemented on March 13, 2006, to qualified purchasers.

G.S.O.'s Record System under Construction: As mentioned previously, plans are underway to rewrite the Fellowship data base to make it operate more efficiently and provide easier access for area registrars as they help us keep our records current. Our aim is to implement a secure password-protected Web based portal for area registrars/secretaries to use when updating group records at G.S.O. The Project team is currently gathering functional requirements and will distribute a Request for Proposal (RFP) by June, with implementation scheduled for yearend.

Board Actions and Other Subjects: New Officers of A.A.W.S. Board — We elected a slate of officers to serve through the 56th General Service Conference. June 2005, the board welcomed West Central regional trustee Charles Barta as a new trustee director and new directors, George Martin, Jane Tolar, and Eva Sanchez, who, on rotation of G.S.O. staff, became staff coordinator, a position that entails serving as an A.A.W.S. director for two years.

Retirement Plan: The board approved an amendment to the Employees' Retirement Plan regarding payments of accrued and vested amounts of \$5,000 or less to former employees as required by law.

Employee Insurance Plans: We concluded meetings with our health care benefits consultant and transferred medical and hospitalization insurance coverage for our retirees to an accessible, cost-effective health plan with improved coverage at no additional cost to retirees or A.A.W.S. A majority of G.S.O.'s employees are now covered under the Direct HMO medical plan, resulting in significantly reduced costs. In addition, the Direct HMO plan was modified to limit a premium increase to 10% this year. After careful review and analysis of competitive proposals provided by our consultant, we changed to a new dental insurance carrier with a 6% reduction in the combined annual premium for A.A.W.S. and Grapevine. We are also evaluating proposals provided by the consultant on Long Term and Short Term Disability and life insurance which may achieve a cost reduction of over \$30,000 per year.

Certificate of Incorporation and Bylaws of A.A.W.S. World Services: The board approved the proposed revisions to the Certificate of Incorporation and Bylaws of A.A.W.S. World Services and forwarded them to the General Service Board.

Flexible Spending Plan Extended to Grapevine Employees: The board approved a combined Flexible Spending Plan available to employees of A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine.

Emergency Response/Business Continuity Plan: The board reviewed G.S.O.'s Disaster Recovery Plan, which includes an Emergency Response Plan developed in-house that focuses on the entire organization, including protection and recovery of

information technology. The board authorized management to begin implementation.

G.S.O. Relocation Study: Following a thorough review of the G.S.O. Relocation Study 2005 Report, the board approved G.S.O.'s management request to enter into negotiations with the Interchurch Center for a new 10-year lease and forwarded the report to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review and disapproval, if any.

A.A.W.S. Policy on Literature Pricing — The board considered two areas: requests for the 2006 General Service Conference to: (1) Consider the elimination of the freight charge of 10% for literature orders under \$250.00; and (2) Consider the elimination of volume discounts on literature orders. In addition, the board reviewed a request from an area that the shipping charges be dropped to those purchasers of less than \$250.00 or that the 10% postage and handling charge be inclusive of all purchasers. The board agreed to respond to the delegates by reaffirming the policy, approved January 2005, and to forward all correspondence to the trustees' Conference Committee.

The board considered a request from a member in Southern California who stated that it was the desire of members in that part of California to be allowed to form a local General Service Office with the stated purpose of publishing A.A. literature at reduced cost. The consensus of the A.A.W.S. directors was that the current policy of licensing only one entity per country, or General Service Conference structure, to publish A.A. literature as defined in *The A.A. Service Manual* be continued. The purpose of this policy is to protect the integrity of the A.A. message. The board responded to the member, advising of this policy.

The board held a sharing session on Communication with D.C.M.s in March to inventory how well G.S.O. and the A.A.W.S. Board communicates with D.C.M.s.

G.S.O. & Staff Operations — At year-end, G.S.O. had

77 full-time employees, plus 6 part-time/students.

G.S.O. archivist Judit Olah resigned in August. We remain deeply grateful to Judit for her dedication throughout her tenure, and for her professional contributions to the enlarging, cataloging and preservation of A.A. history. We are also grateful to assistant archivist, Michele Mirza, who took on added responsibilities during the search process to fill the vacancy. In mid-February, we were pleased to welcome Amy Filiatreau as the new G.S.O. archivist. Amy is a Certified Archivist and graduate of the University of Chicago with a B.A. in Arts, Anthropology and Archaeology, and holds a Master's Degree in Library and Information Science from the University of Texas. In addition to her professional knowledge and skills in Archives' management, Amy brings solid project-management experience, advanced technical skills and goal-oriented abilities to her position with G.S.O.

The migration of our Information Technology (IT) back-room functions, including our main servers, was completed in June. With Invision, an outside vendor located approximately 60 miles away, we now have 24/7 monitoring of our servers. Our thanks to Don Meurer, Charlie Shell, Carl Osborne and employee teams in each department for these achievements, which were accomplished without interruption of services.

Gary Kluksdahl, chairperson



Literature Distributed — 2005

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	464,907
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover-)	341,706
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print-)	34,746
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	132,097
Daily Reflections	179,452
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	206,520
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	13,518
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	205,385
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	20,156
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	66,820
A.A. Comes of Age	14,323
As Bill Sees It	44,934
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	31,867
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	12,817
"Pass It On"	11,726
Experience, Strength & Hope	14,647
Total	1,795,621

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/	
Twelve Concepts for World Service	28,919
Living Sober	182,125
Came to Believe	74,718
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	21,898
Total	307,660

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	9,840
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	25,791
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	31,703
A.A. for the Native North American	14,409
A.A. for the Woman	104,566
The A.A. Group	86,509
A.A. in Your Community	42,288
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	23,319
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	21,656
The A.A. Membership Survey	39,160
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	94,188
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	30,417
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	14,611
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	113,156
Circles of Love and Service	35,963
Bridging the Gap	23,322
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	18,015
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	13,252
Do You Think You're Different?	112,050
44 Questions	221,237
G.S.R.	40,929
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	20,751
How A.A. Members Cooperate	17,461
How It Works	61,955
If You Are a Professional	36,123
Inside A.A.	48,911
Can A.A. Help Me Too?	33,328
Is A.A. for You?	346,561
Is A.A. for Me?	95,628

Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	16,771
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	75,286
It Happened to Alice	46,766
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	46,394
The Jack Alexander Article	23,911
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	13,585
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	72,164
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	48,609
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	35,919
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	10,197
A Newcomer Asks	309,923
Problems Other Than Alcohol	122,949
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	277,568
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	18,840
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	32,815
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	69,730
Twelve Tradition Flyer	6,531
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	53,491
This Is A.A.	256,908
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	19,020
AA for the Older Alcoholic (Lrg Print)	54,594
Too Young?	80,527
Understanding Anonymity	57,000
What Happened to Joe	51,839
Young People and A.A.	114,594
Total	3,693,030

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	296,526
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	46,861
Wallet cards-Anonymity	33,136
Anonymity Display Card	2,346
Parchment-scrolls	2,387
Placards	529
C.P.C. Workbook	1,469
Archives Workbook	625
Correctional Facilities Workbook	819
P.I. Workbook	1,827
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,245
Treatment Facility Kit	450
Big Book on computer disk	138
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	139
A.A. Guidelines	63,721
Group Handbook	2,252
Wire Racks	2,063
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	1,097
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	2,608
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed cassette album)	134
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	199
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	1,353
TV Public Service Announcement	138
Radio Public Service Announcements	205
Twelve Steps Shade displays	1,882
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	1,861
Fact File	1,913
Table Top Display 12 & 12	437
Pioneers of AA (Cassette Album)	67
Living Sober (Cassette Album)	170
Total	468,597
Grand Total	6,264,908

SPANISH

Libros y Librillos (Book & Booklets)

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	21,444
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	9,176
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	8,143
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	5,374
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,606
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	3,415
Transmitelo (Pass it On)	3,964
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	10,426
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	15,962
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	4,904
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	24,412
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	8,609
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	5,949
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	6,874
Total	132,258

Folletos (Pamphlets)

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	5,624
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	25,176
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	25,081
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	62,515
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	4,597
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	6,233
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	5,715
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,994
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,620
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,540
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	13,126
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	7,063
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	9,094
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	2,662
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	10,176
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	9,539
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	4,906
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	5,274
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	1,396
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	12,805
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	3,469
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	11,077
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	2,851

Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	7,808
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	5,899
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,011
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	2,495
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,621
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,610
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,219
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	8,042
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	6,709
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings	1,675
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	6,004
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	2,012
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,724
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	11,629
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the older alcoholic)	3,304
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	6,548
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love & Service)	3,274
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,631
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	3,331
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	2,068
Total	323,681

Diversos (Miscellaneous)

Guías (Guidelines)	6,886
Parchments, Spanish	335
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	10,569
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album)	
(Big Book on cassette)	691
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album)	
(Twelve Steps on cassette)	813
Total	19,294
Grand Total	475,233

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	5,221
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format souple)	1,769
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	397
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format relie)	1,881
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format souple)	1,036

Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve - format poche)	714
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	675
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,379
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	5,114
Dr Bob et les pionniers (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	681
Total	19,867

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,783
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,112
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,594
Total	6,489

Brochures (Pamphlets)	
Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	8,598
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	1,977
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	14,971
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,709
Collaboration des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	497
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail? (Is there an alcoholic in the workplace?)	1,663
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	826
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	436
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	200
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,225
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	310
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	661
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	307
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	276
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	463
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	496
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	1,060
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,062
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	347
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,551
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	636
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	1,117
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	1,510
Les membres du clerge se renseignent (Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	503
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	298
Message a l'intention d'un detenu (Memo to an Inmate)	1,318
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	661
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,294

Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,766
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,543
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	111
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	815
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	2,120
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	348
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	2,012
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,205
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	686
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	1,117
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	645
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	720
Sondage sur les membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2115
Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	1,473
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,505
AA pour l'alcoolique plus age (AA for the older alcoholic)	975
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	5,104
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,167
Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	204
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,516
Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	361
Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord (A.A. and the Native North American)	241
Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	1,753
Total	78,474

Plaquettes (Booklets)

12 & 12 (cassette album)	66
Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	67
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	2,474
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity wallet card)	400
Video Cassettes	29
Notre Methode (How It Works)	10,704
Manuel de Groupe	57
Pochette de l'Information Publique	16
Pochette des Centres de Detention	8
Pochette de la CMP	8
Prière de la Sérénité (12x16) (Parchment Serenity Prayer)	52
Pochette des Centres de Traitement	28
Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	752
Total	14,661
Grand Total	119,491



THE A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Directors' report: One of the operating arms of the General Service Board, the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. publishes and distributes the A.A. Grapevine magazine, the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and collections of its articles in a variety of formats, including books, audio CDs, and an online digital archive. The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. also publishes *La Viña*, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, along with Spanish- and French-language editions of Grapevine books, signs, and recordings.

The directors of the A.A. Grapevine Board have met five times since the 55th General Service Conference: three times for board meetings held during quarterly General Service Board weekends, once by phone, and once during a Planning Committee meeting to take action on a specific item. The directors will convene a sixth time as a board during the General Service Conference week. In addition, the directors met as a Planning Committee in June, September, December and March to review the corporation's finances and operations and take formal actions during board meetings; to discuss matters of broad policy, and to develop plans for the corporation's future at Planning Committee meetings. This year, the board developed a Restated Certificate of Incorporation for the A.A. Grapevine and revised the Bylaws of the corporation.

Board Structure — The Grapevine Corporate Board is composed of nine directors: two general service trustees, two regional trustees, and one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; three non-trustee directors; and the executive editor. This year, the board forwarded the name of general service trustee Arnold Ross to succeed me as chair of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board following the 2006 General Service Conference. Eastern Central regional trustee Bob Mayer will fill the vacancy for regional trustee when I rotate this May.

This year, the board's chair appointed six committees to support the board's oversight of the corporation. The nominating committee, chaired by Tom Kraemer, regional trustee from Western Canada, facilitated the nomination of the board's incoming regional trustee. The finance and budget committee, chaired by the board's treasurer, general service trustee Ray Massey, worked with the controller and executive editor to draft the corporation's 2006 budget and report on the corporation's financial standing each quarter. The committee on *La Viña*, chaired by non-trustee director Dorothy Hurley, reviewed the challenges and opportunities that *La Viña* faces and led a discussion of the corporation's long-term goals for the magazine. The risk management subcommittee, chaired by general service trustee Arnold Ross, helped set policy for documenting the Grapevine and A.A.W.S.'s use of each other's copyrighted material and led the board's review of A.A. Grapevine's Restated Certificate of Incorporation and its Revised Bylaws. Chaired by non-trustee director John Skilton, the board development committee reviewed the orientation offered new directors and the directors' manual and developed a framework for the board's assessment of its performance, instituted this March. The Circulation Committee, chaired by nontrustee director James Branscome, established the need to survey former and current

Grapevine subscribers, encouraged the use of online surveys, and suggested expanding the way the corporation measured its success to include such benchmarks as the number of manuscripts received and back issues distributed in addition to the circulation of the print magazines and financial results. A recent survey of 3,000 random nonreaders produced valuable data. Another valuable asset is our Editorial Advisory Board—a group of professionals that meets every other month with the senior staff to creatively discuss editorial content of the magazines, web development and GV items.

The Grapevine Office — As the chief executive of the corporation, the executive editor defines the operational goals of the corporation and oversees their administration. Operations are divided among four departments: editorial, finance, circulation, and Internet operations. The finance department, supervised by the controller, is responsible for payroll, accounts payable and receivable, financial reports, and assists in the preparation of the annual budget. The controller also oversees the services provided by the fulfillment house, which include customer service as well as subscription and order fulfillment. A customer service coordinator serves as a liaison between the Grapevine office, central/inter-group offices, and the fulfillment house. The editorial staff consists of a senior editor, freelance art director, production manager, assistant editor, and part-time editorial assistant. They are responsible for the content, design, and production of the magazine and all other Grapevine publications. The director of Internet operations manages the Grapevine's Digital Archive and Web site as well as the production of the Grapevine's CD and MP3 recordings. The editor of Spanish resources manages the publication of *La Viña*, *La Viña* items, and Grapevine items in Spanish translation, with the assistance of a part-time art director, copy editor, and part-time editorial assistant. Circulation of both magazines is the responsibility of the executive editor and a circulation manager, scheduled to join the staff in May. Our office manager and GvR (Grapevine representative) coordinator are calling Area GvR chairs monthly, and the GR section of our Web site has been redesigned to include things like Photo Gallery of GV displays from GvRs or RLVs (*La Viña* representative.)

Financial Report — For the twelve months ended December 31, 2005, the Grapevine Corporation realized a profit of \$44,200 in comparison to a budgeted profit of \$17,780. Circulation averaged 104,356 a month for the period. This is 2,144 lower than budget and 4,070 lower than 2004. Total Magazine Income was



\$1,910,800, which was \$27,520 ahead of budget and \$14,841 ahead of the same period in 2004. Direct costs of the Grapevine magazine, \$747,800, were \$10,250 lower than budget, resulting in a gross profit on the magazine of \$1,163,000. This is \$37,771 ahead of budget and \$11,119 less than 2004. Other publishing income of \$566,340 is \$84,630 lower than budget and \$930 below 2004. Gross profit on related items is \$343,510. This is \$118,409 lower than budget and \$60,620 lower than 2004. Total gross profit is \$1,506,500, which was \$80,640 behind budget and \$71,740 behind the same period in 2004.

Editorial costs of \$411,670 are lower than budget by \$55,090 due to the timing changes of new hires since the budget was prepared. Circulation and business expenses are \$954,440. This is less than budget by \$41,160. This is due to selling expenses, which are below budget by \$23,680 and salaries that are below budget by \$34,541. General and Administrative expenses are \$156,480 or \$2,799 lower than the budget. Total Grapevine expenses were \$1,522,600 or \$99,050 lower than the budget of \$1,621,420. Combined with cash flow and interest from the Reserve Fund of \$60,280, total income was \$1,566,790, which resulted in a Net Profit of \$44,200, which is \$26,640 ahead of budget.

Editorial Overview — Like other publishers, the Grapevine is responding to the rapidly changing technology in communications and the growing demand for information in a variety of media. "Our Meeting in Print" remains the Grapevine's flagship publication. With an average monthly circulation of 102,000, an annual income of \$1,910,800, a pass-along rate of at least three readers, and the sale of approximately 75,000 back issues a year, the print magazine is not only financially viable, but carrying the message to a quarter million people. This year, it supported the recovery of A.A. members and their Twelfth Step work with magazines that focused on alcoholics in their 'tweens and teens, tools of sobriety, relapsing, and the impact of alcoholism and A.A. on families. It also reported on the growth of A.A. worldwide, the rebuilding of a home group after Hurricane Katrina, and A.A. members celebrating fifty-plus years of sobriety.

The Grapevine is now reaching people in other media as well: In 2006, 120,000 people visited the Grapevine's redesigned Web site, 3,590 subscribed to the Digital Archive, 1,600 listened to MP3 recordings of Grapevine stories. This summer, online recordings (known as the AudioGrapevine) will be extended, so that members can subscribe to a recorded version of the current magazine, which they can listen to from desktops, iPods, or on the road in MP3-compatible CD players for \$4.95/month; \$44.95/year, or you can get both the Audio Grapevine and print magazine for \$49.95.

This year, the Grapevine also published a new collection of stories about different aspects of Twelfth Step work called *I Am Responsible*, an updated version of *The Home Group: Heartbeat of AA*, and *The Best of Bill* in large print, its first publication in that format. This winter, it began work on a new printing of the Grapevine issues that commemorated A.A.'s co-founders, which was published in April, and the production of two new CDs on the history of A.A. remastered from audiotapes. *Emotional Sobriety*, a collection of stories by A.A.s practicing the principles of the program to lead spiritually rich, emotionally rewarding lives, came out this year. At the International Convention in Toronto, directors and staff joined

with Grapevine and La Viña representatives and subscribers in an enthusiastic round of workshops, plays, and meetings to celebrate the 70th birthday of Alcoholics Anonymous and the magazines that reflect its worldwide growth.

Operations — In April, customer service was outsourced to the company that handles fulfillment of the magazine. This, along with the 2001 outsourcing of fulfillment, has resulted in a reduction of staff by ten people and the need for less office space. Therefore, the board approved a plan to request a reduction in space from its leaseholder, A.A.W.S., which, if approved, would result in a savings of approximately \$27,000 in rent a year. In January, the Grapevine moved the printing and distribution of the magazines to a new printer, to increase efficiency and reduce costs. The April 2006 issue was the first Grapevine printed by this company; the first La Viña printed by the company will be the May/June 2006 issue.

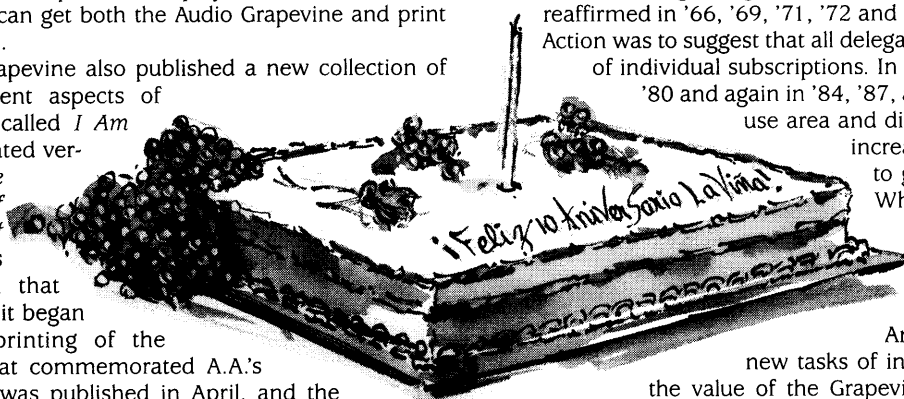
La Viña — This year, La Viña focused on a variety of important topics, including dealing with resentments in sobriety, carrying the message to young people, sponsorship, and the national convention in Cuba. This spring, La Viña is celebrating the tenth anniversary of the magazine with a special issue and the release of its third audio CD with stories on Steps Seven to Twelve. In those ten years, La Viña has grown from a magazine that offered translations of Grapevine stories to one that reflects the experience of Spanish-speaking A.A.s throughout the world. By sharing stories with the Grapevine, it has also become a means of fostering communication between English- and Spanish-speaking A.A.s and nurturing the unity that is essential to the Fellowship and the recovery of its members.

Financial results for La Viña show a net loss of \$107,740, compared to a budgeted loss of \$93,840, which is \$13,901 behind budget. Income from the magazine was \$81,360, which is \$4,100 ahead of the budget. Gross profit from CD sales was \$17,740, behind budget by \$10,010. Total Gross Profit for La Viña and the CDs was \$21,650. Editorial costs of \$67,350 were under budget by \$390. Circulation and Business Expenses of \$57,298 were under budget by \$1,840. General and Administrative Expenses were \$250 over budget.

As delegates and members of the General Service Conference, you, by past Advisory Actions beginning as far back as 1954, are now fully vested as Grapevine reps. The 1954 Advisory Action suggested that all delegates include the Grapevine in their reports and encourage the election of Grapevine reps in groups. In 1962, the Advisory Action stated that all retiring delegates become Grapevine reps. This was reaffirmed in '66, '69, '71, '72 and '73. In 1975, the Advisory Action was to suggest that all delegates make members aware of individual subscriptions. In 1977 (reaffirmed in '78 – '80 and again in '84, '87, and '98), that all delegates use area and district service structures to increase GV awareness and try to get a GvR in every group. Who could have guessed that being elected delegate would carry such awesome responsibilities?

And now, charged with your new tasks of informing the Fellowship of the value of the Grapevine as a tool of recovery; encouraging readership of our "international journal" and "meeting in print"; increasing Grapevine subscriptions, I welcome you all to the Grapevine family, and wish you good luck in your new assignment.

Michael Perry, chairperson



ENGLISH

Book Units

Best of Bill (hardcover)	3,920
Best of Bill (softcover)	10,312
Best of Bill/large print (softcover)	1,401
Best of the Grapevine I (softcover)	1,639
Best of the Grapevine II (softcover)	1,731
Best of the Grapevine III (softcover)	1,353
I'm Responsible: The Hand of AA (soft-cover)	5,009
The Language of the Heart (hardcover)	6,107
The Language of the Heart (softcover)	2,866
The Language of the Heart/Big Book Set	112
The Home Group	2,461
The Home Group (revised/soft-cover)	3,385
A.A. Around The World	1,731
Thank You for Sharing	2,643
Spiritual Awakening	7,887
Total:	52,557

Cassette Tapes

Attitudes	309
Character Defects	331
Classic Tapes #1	152
Classic Tapes #2	82
Classic Tapes #3	80
Maintaining Spirituality	232
Pathways to Spirituality	279
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 1	121
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 2	92
Our Experience Has Taught Us	107
Practice These Principles	173
Back to Basics, Vol. 1	153
Back to Basics, Vol. 2	116
Sponsorship, Vol. 1	253
Sponsorship, Vol. 2	138
History Lights the Way	143
What We Were Like	143
Youth Enjoying Sobriety	113
Old-Timers Corner	144
Total:	3,161

CDs

Pathways to Spirituality	944
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 1	463
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 2	378
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 3	336
Not for Newcomers Only	714
Partners on the Journey	586
Total:	3,421

Miscellaneous

AA Preamble	1,629
Facsimile of first Grapevine	615
Grapevine Binder	600
Man on the Bed	1,778
Serenity Prayer	3,529
Slogans	1,525
Traditions Checklist	469
Wall Calendar 2006	11,235
Pocket Planner 2006	11,880
Victor E. Poster - English	457
Total:	33,717

SPANISH

El Lenguaje del Corazón (Language of the Heart)	3,805
Lo Mejor de Bill (The Best of Bill)	6,785
Sonidos de Sobriedad	1
Historia de La Viña/CD	808
Historia de La Viña Vol. II/CD	1,458
Victor E. Poster - Spanish	121
Preámbulo (Preamble)	395
Lemas (Slogans)	364
La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)	1,004
Tradiciones (Traditions Checklist)	1,011
Total:	15,753

FRENCH

Best of Bill - French (Soft-cover)	2,443
Le langage du coeur	634
The Home Group - French	437
Les Sons de la Sobriété (Sounds of Sobriety)	84
Slogans - French	385
Victor E. Poster - (French)	9
Total:	3,992
Grand Total:	113,602

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2006	APRIL 2005	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	935	1,017	-82
Alaska	538	535	3
Arizona	1,778	1,750	28
Arkansas	552	572	-20
California	8,958	6,185	2,773
Colorado	1,718	1,748	-30
Connecticut	1,557	1,619	-62
Delaware	449	351	98
District of Columbia	200	184	16
Florida	5,132	6,069	-937
Georgia	2,242	2,460	-218
Hawaii	494	450	44
Idaho	593	574	19
Illinois	3,650	3,678	-28
Indiana	1,440	1,567	-127
Iowa	1,217	1,248	-31
Kansas	904	1,188	-284
Kentucky	884	996	-112
Louisiana	709	900	-191
Maine	666	641	25
Maryland	1,473	1,427	46
Massachusetts	2,711	2,445	266
Michigan	3,257	3,483	-226
Minnesota	2,565	2,886	-321
Mississippi	491	577	-86
Missouri	1,549	1,790	-241
Montana	591	699	-108
Nebraska	904	944	-40
Nevada	730	750	-20
New Hampshire	785	744	41
New Jersey	2,727	2,867	-140
New Mexico	656	712	-56
New York	9,880	6,278	3,602
No Carolina	2,177	2,422	-245
No Dakota	340	400	-60
Ohio	2,684	2,904	-220
Oklahoma	826	929	-103
Oregon	1,431	1,454	-23
Pennsylvania	4,766	4,597	169
Rhode Island	351	370	-19
So Carolina	966	989	-23
So Dakota	366	388	-22
Tennessee	1,150	1,215	-65
Texas	4,128	4,295	-167
Utah	523	541	-18
Vermont	389	408	-19
Virginia	2,100	1,928	172
Washington	2,425	2,509	-84
West Virginia	491	435	56
Wisconsin	2,406	2,057	349
Wyoming	312	283	29
Puerto Rico	30	82	-52
U.S Possessions	41	73	-32
Subtotal U.S.	90,837	87,613	3,224
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	347	780	-433
British Columbia/Ykn	429	904	-475
Manitoba	90	388	-298
New Brunswick/ Prince Edwards Island	148	150	-2
Nova Scotia/ New Foundland/Labrador	221	386	-165
Ontario	1,299	2,983	-1,684
Quebec	130	211	-81
Saskatchewan	90	349	-259
Subtotal Canada	2,754	6,151	-3,397
FOREIGN			
	1,287	1,267	20
Grand Total*	94,878	95,031	-153
LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*			
	Jan/Feb. 06	Jan/Feb. 05	
	7,410	7,056	

(*does not include monthly orders)

Trustees' Committees and G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: The committee supports G.S.O. Archives' commitment to maintaining a role in supporting academic and scholarly research, as well as ongoing availability of our historic heritage to our Fellowship.

The committee received updates on the ongoing project to preserve and restore the majority of reel-to-reel tapes, audio cassette tapes and phonograph recordings that are a priority. The cataloging and transfer of other audio material is ongoing. A subcommittee continues examining preservation principles and priorities, as well as the criteria for determining ongoing preservation needs, with the goal of moving from handling preservation emergencies to setting up preservation schedules that safeguard the critical records of the Fellowship.

The committee accepted the report on a new project to restore and preserve the collection of films and videos held at the G.S.O. Archives. The report included background research on film preservation, a list of the G.S.O. Archives' films and videos collection, collection assessment and priority recommendations for preservation of film material. The main goal of the film preservation project is to maintain the historical sights, sounds, and valuable information contained within the films in our care.

Two issues of *Markings*, the Archives newsletter, on the topics "Alcoholics Anonymous and Industry" and "A.A. and Medicine Forge a Durable Relationship," were published. A subcommittee was appointed to explore the feasibility of expanding distribution of *Markings* in response to increased interest in the newsletter.

We worked on additions and revisions to the Archives Workbook, which will be reported in detail to the 2006 Conference Archives Committee.

The committee approved three additions to G.S.O.'s Archives "Statements of Policy" document, including "Terms and Conditions of Access"; the heading, "Use of the Archives"; and a citation to the section, "Policies for Copying and Reprinting."

The committee accepted the assistant archivist's report on the existing security procedures, as well as primary concerns regarding the safety and security of the holdings. Security concerns will be part of the development of an Archives disaster plan, which will be presented to this committee in the near future.

Herb Goodman, chairperson

Archivist's report: The G.S.O. Archives supports academic and scholarly research, as well as inspiring interest in archival work within the Fellowship. It is our responsibility to ensure that the original message of recovery, unity and service is not distorted as our Fellowship progresses into the 21st century.

The Archives area at the 2005 International Convention in Toronto was an outstanding success. The specially designed exhibit was well received, along with the souvenir items that were developed for the event. The exhibit area featured four pods that included historical imagery, used to demonstrate the consequences of drinking before Alcoholics Anonymous; images illustrating the beginning of our story in Akron and New York; and the remarkable efforts and challenges that preceded the publication of the Big Book. We also displayed local A.A. histories in a variety of presentation styles: published booklets, pamphlets, leaflets and binders.

A double CD, "History of Services," which included a selection of talks and excerpts focusing on the development of services, was developed for sale at the Convention. The first CD is a humorous narrative by Bill W. on the history of the early struggles, when the early alcoholics tried to locate funds to publish the Big Book. The second CD contains four audio segments reflecting on the creation and growth of the general service structure.

A complimentary souvenir bookmark, which consisted of a montage of all four distinct themes of the exhibit pods, was available in the Archives exhibit area.

Letters were sent to all the International Convention Archives volunteers, thanking them for their dedicated service in assisting our numerous visitors and tirelessly answering their questions.

Our entire collection of photographs and negatives have been organized and encapsulated in protective enclosures — a task that took us a few years to complete. Preservation work on Bill's correspondence, early Foundation letters, early group correspondence, minutes of the Alcoholic Foundation and Works Publishing, etc., continues.

The audio preservation work progresses as we move to the next phase of preserving other historic recordings, which includes oral history, Regional Forums and World Service Meetings. Our database now holds over three thousand audio records, which are catalogued by the following classifications: "Bill W.," "International Convention," "General Service Conference" and "CD" (includes oral history recordings and other interesting material).

This year marks the beginning of a new preservation project of restoring and preserving all films and videos. The recordings include original broadcasts, original productions by RKO, and a short film of Dr. Bob, Anne and Bill W. recorded in color in 1945. It took about two months to complete identifying priority problems, analyzing, cataloging and assessing the entire collection.

The Archives continued to enrich its collection of treasures received from donors, including early printings of A.A. books and other A.A. related material.

Michelle Mirza, assistant archivist

AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee, formed in 2003 by the General Service Board, consists of four trustees in addition to the board treasurer, who chairs the committee. The committee was created to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor. The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity.

Vince Keefe, treasurer



CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee met three times since the 2005 Conference, and reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 56th General Service Conference, "Sponsorship, Service and Self-support in a Changing World." The committee also discussed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires and of a Post-Conference Sharing Session.

The committee approved the updated 2006 Conference week schedule, including presentation topics approved by the 2005 Conference, and the workshop questions for distribution in the Communications Kit that was mailed in December. In addition, we reviewed the list of suggestions for the theme, presentations and workshop topics for the 2007 Conference.

We reviewed and approved the revisions to the 56th General Service Conference Evaluation Form, with an added heading "Suggestions for the 57th General Service Conference" on page 5. A daily reminder to fill out the Evaluation Form has been added to the schedule.

The committee discussed a request that the "two-minute timer" procedure at the Conference be flexible. We agreed to request that the Conference allow additional time at the microphone for those who speak English as a second language and may need additional time to express themselves, and suggested that the request be presented to each Conference for agreement in the review of mechanics of the Conference during the Sunday Opening Session.

The committee addressed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2006. Thirty items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference committees, or to the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards.

The committee reviewed an area's request that "proposals carrying delegate area support by substantial unanimity (at least 2/3 majority vote), which are submitted for General Service Conference consideration, shall be placed on the appropriate Conference committee's agenda." After lengthy discussion on the impact of this request, the committee took no action, agreeing that current, long established procedures, by which board committees exercise discretion in determining agenda items for the Conference, are in the best interest of the Fellowship and should not be changed.

We considered a request that the agenda of the 56th General Service Conference include an item to form a General Service Conference Access [special needs/accessibilities] Committee and took no action. We reviewed the history of similar requests and the impact of the creation of a new committee on the full Conference. The committee noted that fewer than half the areas currently have special needs committees, and also reviewed the increased activities of G.S.O. staff in sharing information about special needs activities and materials, including the Special Needs Catalog.

A subcommittee was appointed to look at ways of improving communications on the Conference committee process. The committee accepted the final subcommittee report that offered the following suggestions for making additional information about the Conference committee process available:

- Develop a service piece that talks about the intended design of the Conference and committee processes, including sharing about Concept III and the "right of decision," trust, and a listing of other resources available on these topics.
- Expand the service piece "How the Conference Operates," especially the section that discusses how the committees work.
- Provide the Conference an opportunity for sharing on how the committee system is operating.

- Include articles in *Box 4-5-9* and the Grapevine that emphasize the committee process.

Our committee sincerely hopes that we will all continue to enjoy the wonderful life that has been given to us in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Arnold Ross, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

Created in 1951, the annual meeting of the General Service Conference became in July 1955 "...the guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetrators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successor of its co-founders, Doctor Bob and Bill." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, S93-S94)

A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference. Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

None of this work would be possible without the help of a very capable staff assistant and an "in house" team of extraordinary G.S.O. employees working behind the scenes to ensure that the Conference week is a memorable experience for all.

Rick Walker



COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/ TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2005 General Service Conference the committee has met three times.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

The committee reviewed the contents of the C.P.C. Kit, including the C.P.C. Workbook, and oversaw the inclusion of shared experience in the C.P.C. Workbook on ways local committees approach professionals in addition to writing letters.

The committee discussed a request to explore the idea of a pamphlet aimed at the legal profession or criminal justice profession as a whole. After reviewing current C.P.C. literature, the committee agreed that current literature provides easily accessible information on singleness of purpose, open and closed meetings, proof of attendance at meetings, anonymity and how to contact A.A. locally.

The committee also reviewed requests to reprint the chapter "To Employers" in pamphlet form and took no action. The sense of the committee was that taken out of context, the chapter contains dated practices. It was noted that professionals have access to the chapter in the Big Book, both in print and on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

We considered the cost and feasibility of producing short video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields that could be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, and forwarded the idea to the 2006 Conference Committee on C.P.C.

The committee reviewed the 2005 list of 55 exhibits as well as the exhibit evaluations. Offers to exhibit at professional conferences are considered based on expanding the range of professions and on new geographical locations.

Treatment Facilities — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions (H&I) and Bridging the Gap (BTG). Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit.

The committee continued their discussion of the scope and activities of treatment facilities committees.

In response to a request from the 2005 Conference Committee on Public Information to update the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous*, the committee viewed the video and decided that it was not sufficiently outdated to warrant the expense of an update at this time.

The 2005 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, staff, and the trustee's Committee on Treatment Facilities reviewed text changes which will be incorporated into the Treatment Facilities Workbook at the next printing.

Allen Ault, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With The Professional Community (C.P.C.) — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet few know what A.A. is, or what we do, and

fewer have been to an A.A. meeting. The staff member on the C.P.C. assignment, along with a capable assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

In 2005, the C.P.C. desk responded to more than 1,900 inquiries from professionals, 963 of which were associated with visits to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, other requests coming by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of those professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees, who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. includes the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.* Two issues of *About A.A.* were published in 2005. The Spring issue shared how A.A. cooperates with treatment facilities to help alcoholics. The Fall issue focused on the 2004 A.A. Membership Survey. Currently, more than 14,000 professionals are receiving *About A.A.*

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 55 national or international conferences of professionals. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. In addition, 24 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles were published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities throughout the year. This created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend "open" A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Irene Kontje



Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office currently lists 85 Area Treatment Facilities (T.F.) committee chairpersons, plus 398 district and other T.F. chairpersons, as well as 22 Area Bridging the Gap (BTG) and 21 Area Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons; 142 BTG and H&I district and other chairpersons are also listed. The total list comprises 668 T.F.-related trusted servants. Each is involved in one or more facets of providing A.A. meetings and/or information in treatment settings.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information and Treatment Facilities Committees. Periodically, we share highlights from the trustees' meetings and activities from the T.F. staff assignment with area, district and other T.F. chairs, for the benefit of the committees they chair. In addition, we are always grateful for local T.F. experience that may be included in an activity report or in a *Box 4-5-9* article.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the Treatment Facilities Kit and/or Workbook, A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date, confidential list of all Area T.F. committee chairs so that they can share experiences and activities. Correspondence, including requests for sharing and for G.S.O.'s collected experience, is always welcomed from local committees.

Some committees are invigorated through cooperation with professional staff in local facilities, often learning better ways to approach clients within the regulations established by the facility.

The T.F. staff member also receives correspondence from clients or patients in treatment centers. Each request receives a response from the staff member along with A.A. literature. Some of these patients submit a request for help and are referred to local committees so that local committee members have the opportunity to extend the hand of A.A. Requests from professionals in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each professional is sent literature, and in most cases a contact with members of the local Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. Committee is arranged. The staff member on this assignment also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Mary Clare Lynch



CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2005 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Corrections has met three times.

At the recommendation of the 2005 Conference, A subcommittee was appointed to help review the revised draft manuscript of *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate* by working with the Publications Department to review the final selection of stories and illustrations, mindful of the concerns expressed during the 2005 General Service Conference discussion. The committee reviewed a draft manuscript and recommended that it be forwarded only to the members of the 2006 Conference Committee on Corrections prior to the 2006 General Service Conference for review and consideration.

The committee forwarded a progress report to the 2006 Conference Committee on Corrections on the development of an Informational Media Presentation Introducing A.A. to Training Academies and In-service Training Programs for Corrections Personnel.

The committee agreed that the draft service piece for Corrections Committee Presentations to Introduce A.A. to Correctional Personal Training Programs replace the current suggested guidelines for presentations found on page 6 of the Corrections Workbook at the next printing. The committee agreed that the service piece on "How to Conduct a Sharing Session" (F-111) referenced in the guidelines be included in the Corrections Workbook.

The committee agreed that the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) serve both the U.S. and Canada, taking into consideration geography and language.

The committee also discussed a request for a book of meditations written for and by inmates and took no action.

Chuck Barta, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Nearly 600 letters a month arrive from inmates, most requesting free literature, many asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A. upon their release. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Correctional Facilities committees. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing excerpts of sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

The Corrections Correspondence Service, coordinated by this desk, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. There is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. Yet whenever a G.S.O. staff member attending an assembly, convention, conference or other Fellowship function, mentions the tremendous need for C.C.S. volunteers and provides a supply of the service piece Corrections Correspondence—a Special Kind of A.A. Service (F-26), there is a substantial increase in the number of A.A.s wishing to correspond with those on the inside. Additionally, a letter explaining the Corrections Correspondence Service is sent twice a year to delegates and corrections chairpersons asking for A.A. volunteers to



write to inmates on an individual basis. This year, as in past years, a letter has been sent to current outside letter writers asking if they would like a new or additional inmate to correspond with. Also, the Grapevine printed a service opportunity alert telling A.A.s of the need for letter writers. At the request of the trustees' Committee on Corrections, the C.C.S. will serve both Canada and the United States. Translations and other necessary plans are in process to facilitate C.C.S. in Canada.

The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and correctional professionals throughout the United States and Canada enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Correctional Facilities committee. The mailing contains: information that A.A. pamphlets and books are available in languages other than English, a copy of the current special A.A. Grapevine issue that is bound specifically for correctional facilities, and language about A.A. that is particularly pertinent to selective correctional settings. The same issue of the A.A. Grapevine is also sent to all inmates who contact the office requesting prerelease assistance.

One of the most important duties of the assignment is communicating with area and district Correctional Facilities, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap Committees. Three or four times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs. This year, these chairs reviewed and commented on the draft guidelines on the Committee on Corrections' presentations to introduce A.A. to correctional personnel training programs that will be included in the next printing of the Corrections Workbook.

Following the three trustees' Corrections Committee meeting, a report of the meeting highlights is mailed to delegates on the Corrections, Treatment Facilities, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Public Information committees.

New Correctional Facilities chairs are welcomed with a Correctional Facilities Kit or Workbook to help them in their service.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in correctional service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Mary Dargan

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2005 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a slight profit from operations of approximately \$71,483, which after mid-year adjustments, resulted in an estimated loss of \$83,517. Actual results for 2005 were about \$1,000,000 better. While expenses for the year were within \$32,000 (three tenths of one percent) of budget, net revenues were significantly better than expected. At the end of 2006, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 8.75 months of operating expenses.

General Service Office — Our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2005 were again higher than the previous year, in this case by about \$225,000 (4.3%). This represents the eighth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and continues to reflect a positive trend. Contributions of \$5,282,000 received from groups and members were \$115,000, or 2%, greater than budgeted, and \$218,000 (4%) more than in 2004. The \$5,282,000 in contributions came from about 25,067 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 43.2% of the 58,067 groups registered with G.S.O., just slightly less than the 43.7% last year.

Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of

\$5,417,000, reflected in our 2005 financial statements, include approximately \$135,000 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000. While total contribution dollars were slightly higher again this year, and the number of groups listed at G.S.O. was also slightly higher, the percent of groups contributing has again decreased. It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$11,601,100, which was \$476,000 (4%) greater than budgeted, and \$303,500 higher than 2004. During 2005, with the exception of the Big Book, units of books sold generally increased slightly over 2004. (During 2005, the total number of Big Books sold was only 37,000 (3.7%) less than in 2004). This reflects the combined effect of buying and leveling off resulting from the mid year price adjustments of different titles two years in a row. In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were less than budgeted by a considerable margin. This was primarily a result of efforts by our new print purchaser. Gross profit of \$6,676,600 was \$943,000 more than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$12,103,100, some \$1,092,000 greater than originally budgeted.

Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2005 were \$11,126,900, approximately \$32,000 over budget and \$90,000 less than the previous year. Compared with the budget, the increase in revenues offset by the slightly increased expenses resulted in an operating profit of \$976,170 for the year, a substantial improvement from the budgeted loss of \$83,917.

Historical Reference For Price Adjustments — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was approaching the upper limit established by the General Service Conference of 12 months of combined G.S.O. and Grapevine operating expenses. We had accomplished the objective of lowering the Reserve Fund and then the actions taken to restore the revenue stream began to bear fruit. At December 2005, the calculating balance represented about 8.75 months of operating expenses. The adjusted balance used for the calculation, \$9,253,935, amounts to about \$159 per listed A.A. group. Contributions received averaged about \$91 for the 58,067 groups registered, while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$128. The adjusted balance used for the calculation has increased approximately \$178,500 from last year.

Turning to 2006, the G.S.O. budget, anticipates a return to more "normal levels" of unit sales following the price adjustments of the past two years. Last year, your responsible trusted servants, after reviewing financial matters, recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This follows by one year the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. Remember that the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), thus specifically reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prudence dictated that even though Contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement during the last several years, restoration of the overall revenue stream was appropriate. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs

of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. You should also be aware that as we continue to strive to have literature available—for our Service Conference, in the Spanish and French languages as well as English—lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits are an expected result, making price increases required from time to time.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget anticipates a slight increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately an 8.8% increase in costs when compared with 2005 actual results, and a 9% increase when compared with the 2005 budget. Based on these primary assumptions—an increase in dollar sales; a 2% increase in contributions; an increase in total operating expenses—the projection for 2006 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$656,000, which compares with the 2005 budgeted loss of \$83,517 following mid-year budget adjustments. As mentioned in prior reports, following three consecutive years of planned losses (1995-1997), the Reserve Fund was at a point where it was prudent to anticipate slightly better than break-even years, and we did! Then, following a very good year in 2000, both from operations and the Convention, the Reserve Fund was approaching the 12-month level. We were grateful when the Conference moved forward the "Floating Cap plan" allowing for the orderly "managing down" of the Reserve Fund. We are seeing the results of that action.

Just to expand a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship—in 2005, we spent \$7,443,300 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$189,000, or 2.5%, less than the \$7,622,288 spent in 2004. This compares with \$7,622,288 spent in 2004, \$7,088,055 in 2003, \$7,182,000 in 2002, \$6,685,600 in 2001, \$6,143,300 in 2000, \$5,876,500 in 1999, \$5,867,700 in 1998, and \$5,944,000 in 1997. Contributions provided 73%, and 27% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 68% and 32% in 2004; 72% and 28% in 2004; 71% and 29% in 2002; 70% and 30% in 2001; and 73% and 27% for 2000.) Services spending amounted to \$128 per listed A.A. group, down \$4 from the previous year, while contributions were about \$91 per group, up \$1. The 2005 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services 32.6% (which includes the Group Services assignment; Box 4-5-9; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 13.4%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 10%; trustees' and directors' activities, 7.6%; Regional Forums, 7.5%; Archives, 8.7%; C.P.C., 6.2%; Public Information, 4.9%; Correctional Facilities, 4.3%; and Treatment Facilities, 1.6%; Convention Activities, 2.7%, other various 0.5%.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately even with the prior year while average circulation was down approximately 3.7%. Average circulation during 2005 was 104,356, compared with 108,426 for 2004, 112,614 for 2003, 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine was \$1,163,000, which was \$11,000 less than last year but \$38,000 more than budgeted. Revenue of Other Items was \$85,000, less than budgeted and just about even with the prior year as well. Gross profit on Other Items, was approximately \$118,400 less than budgeted and approximately \$60,000 less than 2004. Therefore, total income, including interest income, was \$1,566,780, \$65,000 less than last year and about \$72,000 less than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and

administration were \$1,522,584. This is \$47,800 less than last year, and \$98,800 less than budget as well. As a result, the Grapevine (excluding La Viña) reported a profit from operations of \$44,200, compared with the \$60,950 profit last year.

The Grapevine's 2006 budget, excluding La Viña, anticipates magazine subscription income of \$1,813,794, essentially even with the \$1,794,126 realized in 2005, a decrease in magazine direct costs of \$18,500, and a gross profit of \$1,203,671. Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$88,500, while interest income should be about even. A profit for 2006 of \$19,883 is anticipated and, when achieved will make four successive positive years of Grapevine operations.

La Viña — As we all know, La Viña is the Spanish-language magazine project approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2005 average circulation of 9,453. This compared with 2004 average of 9,316, 2003 average circulation of 9,222, and 2002 circulation of 9,000. Past circulation is 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997. La Viña appears to be a first-rate product. Our hope is that it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past nine and one-half years. During 2005, subscription income was \$81,360 and direct costs of publishing were \$77,450, resulting in a \$3,907 gross profit. During 2005, La Viña realized approximately \$17,740 from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$129,388. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to La Viña. Therefore, the overall loss on the project for the year was \$107,739.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2006, the loss on the La Viña project is budgeted to decrease approximately \$27,000, to \$80,699, and circulation is projected to increase slightly to 9,700 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee will continue to monitor progress against the original business plan and inform the Conference. Since the inception of the project, \$1,100,000 has been invested in La Viña. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that La Viña continue to be published at the General Service Board's expense.

During the year, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee received reports from two subcommittees. One subcommittee studying Post Retirement Medical Benefit Obligations (FAS 106) recommended and the General Service Board approved the creation a separate "Board Designated Fund" of the General Service Boards to account for and receive funds to fund these future benefit obligations and that the operating corporations annually fund such amounts. A subcommittee responded to the 2005 Conference Finance Committees request create a "Draft Finance Card."

The 70th Anniversary Convention held in Toronto this past year realized income of \$3,919,300, and incurred direct expenses of \$3,958,400, which resulted in a modest loss of \$39,000 for the event.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side, and consideration of long-term obligations, help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. The outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry the message.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 55th General Service Conference, the board held three General Sharing Sessions. The topic of the July 2005 session was "Is the Conference Process Working? Pro and Con." The October topic was "The A.A. Grapevine and La Viña." In January 2006, the session focused on "Our Collective Group Conscience."

July 2005 — Tom Kraemer, Western Canada regional trustee, presented a positive viewpoint on the topic "Is the Conference Process Working?" Tom shared how he wrestled with how to proceed, as he believes the Conference to be a spiritual process with a practical application. While he did not know how to measure or quantify this, the fact that it is functioning well, and has been for 55 Conferences, is in itself a clear demonstration that the process is working. Tom pointed out that when the idea of an elected Conference, providing direct linkage between the A.A. groups and the trustees of the Alcoholic Foundation, was being advanced in the late 1940s, the plan was met with much hesitation, skepticism and outright fear on the part of many trustees. However, showing maturity, faith, and vision, the Foundation ultimately agreed to a series of five trial Conferences, the first convening in April 1951. Tom noted that at the 1955 Convention, held in St. Louis, most of these fears were reduced, if not dispelled, by the introduction of the Warranties that comprise Article 12 of the Conference Charter. Tom provided a clear and practical breakdown of how the Warranties guarantee that the Conference will remain, as stated in Warranty Six, "democratic in action and in spirit." Because the process is anchored in these Warranties, the Conference process works and will continue to work. In closing, Tom reflected that this does not mean that there is no room for improvement; there will always be a need to make operational adjustments and structural modifications to reflect the changing circumstances of our time. To not do so would be irresponsible and impractical.

Arnold Ross, general service trustee, presented the opposite viewpoint of, "Is the Conference Process Working?" and shared that having been a member of the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference, which has responsibility for suggesting ways to improve the Conference, he has become very familiar with the question posed. He shared his belief that we all know we aren't doing well enough with our Conference process. However, chances are better than ever that we may identify our misunderstanding of Bill's vision. Arnold shared that to speak about unity and our future necessitates speaking to current issues that tend to disunite. While we are communicating more and more, it has not reduced the potential for misinterpretation. Arnold also shared that another of his concerns regarding unity for the future has to do with how we treat each other and how the very diversity that makes our Fellowship unique and binds us together as one is perceived by some to be a threat. The Conference represents A.A. as a whole—it is a patchwork quilt consisting of many colors, fabrics, and textures. Today the history of the quilt itself transcends the single patch. In conclusion, Arnold noted that our founders wove together a world service structure, which would provide unity and continuity throughout our Fellowship, so long as we work to preserve it.

Highlights of subsequent sharing:

- The demand made on A.A. groups to provide an opinion on Conference agenda items seems to have created a collision between the desire to bring the groups into the process and the committee system.
- How effective have we been in assuming the leadership role of our founders? It is time to inventory all aspects of our service structure.

- Without doubt groups run A.A. because they carry the message, but this does not mean that they have to be involved in every aspect of the Conference process. Groups will always be able to let the Conference know if Conference actions help them carry the A.A. message or not.

- Trustees' committees could exercise stronger leadership and make decisions based on their experience without having to burden the Conference with excessive Conference agenda items.

- While we are communicating more, it does not seem to make us more effective.

- The strength of the committee system comes from focusing on specific topics. The attempt to grasp every Conference agenda item and have an informed opinion on everything may not really provide a well-informed decision.

October 2005: "The A.A. Grapevine and La Viña" — Robin Bromley, executive editor of the A.A. Grapevine, considered the question: "Is the AA Grapevine, Inc., Fulfilling Our Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service in a Changing World?" She shared that when she thinks of the A.A. Grapevine, several urgent but basic questions come to mind: What is its purpose? What are its responsibilities to the Fellowship? And how can we best fulfill them today? She went on to share that the Grapevine's purpose was very clear—"to tell as many people as possible about A.A., whether they are alcoholics or not." Using the Grapevine's purpose as her backdrop, Robin pointed out that the Grapevine and La Viña are powerful tools of personal recovery and that the magazines go a long way toward fostering unity in our Fellowship. Robin expressed some concerns about how well the Grapevine is fulfilling A.A.'s Third Legacy, Service. She spoke about the evolution of the Grapevine from the "International Journal of Alcoholics Anonymous" to "Our Meeting in Print," reflecting the culture of A.A. as a whole, and how the professional or nonalcoholic has slowly and steadily disappeared from the magazine's pages. In her opinion, it is evident that the magazine is not doing enough to carry the message to those outside, that is, the concerned professional or the individual still seeking a solution to his or her drinking problem. Robin posed the question, "What, if anything, can we do about this?" and concluded by offering the following options: report more fully on our vibrant society and its impact on the world; welcome articles from nonalcoholics who can help carry the A.A. message; encourage our trustees, staff, directors, and appointed committee members, to use the Grapevine as a means of communicating with people inside and outside of A.A.

Sharing on the question, "Is Our Service Structure Using the Grapevine and La Viña as Effectively as it Might?" Dorothy Hurley, A.A. Grapevine director, began by describing how she had gotten the assistance of a G.S.R. to take the pulse of a district with regard to this question. The G.S.R. reported that the district is involved with, and makes use of, the Grapevine in its work with treatment facilities and prisons. Dorothy noted that her G.S.R. reporter shared that five out of fifteen groups in the district held regular Grapevine meetings. Dorothy focused on the reasons she perceived as the under-use of La Viña throughout the service structure. She pointed out that the current management structure in place for the magazine is problematic and likened it to the "double-headed" management Bill W. refers to in Concept X, with the General Service Board and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. sharing responsibility for La Viña's future. Dorothy cited several Conference Advisory Actions since 1954 that, in her opinion, appear to encourage the use of the A.A. Grapevine as a Twelfth Step tool. In closing, she challenged her listeners to take an inventory on the topic at hand.

The following sharing ensued:

- The Grapevine magazine is not as visible throughout the Fellowship as it might be. Is there something that the members

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2006¹

	Groups	Members
United States	52,050	1,068,516
Canada	<u>6,214</u>	<u>110,449</u>
Sub-Total	58,264	1,178,965
Correctional facilities ²	2,527	65,843
Internationalists		71
Lone members		<u>245</u>
Total	60,791	1,245,124
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	<u>45,436</u>	<u>702,538</u>
Grand Total	106,227	1,947,662

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent an actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 57 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figures.

of the boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and A.A.s in general can do to make more people aware of the magazine? It is a magazine for everyone.

- 2006 marks the 10th Anniversary of La Viña, which is an opportunity to give the magazine more visibility by making it a part of A.A. conferences and conventions.

- The articles once included by professionals (gray pages) were important. As many members continue to rely on the printed word, in a changing world, GV has kept pace by introducing the "digital archives" feature to its Web site.

- Focus on the value of the magazine and not so much on the bottom line.

- It is good to be provoked in thought, but better to be provoked into action. GV helps with issues A.A.s face in sobriety and we can applaud those GVs that have been controversial. They help Alcoholics Anonymous.

January 2006: "Our Collective Group Conscience" — Cushing Phillips, Panel 55 delegate from Area 1, Alabama/N.W. Florida, addressed the question "Right of Decision—Trusted Servant or Messenger?" He stated that what is important regarding this Concept is achieving a healthy balance. On the one hand, as Cushing noted in quoting Concept III, our trusted servants have the discretion "to decide which problems they will dispose of themselves and on which matters they will report, consult, or ask specific questions." He made the point that the right of decision would more accurately be described as a responsibility. That being the case, the right of decision must not be allowed to undermine the ultimate authority of the A.A. groups. Being unresponsive to the group conscience is antithetical to the principle of the Third Concept. Groups and areas that forget this are not supporting this Concept, but rather destroying it.

Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff member, shared on the question

"Are We Trusting the Conference Committee?" Doug shared that from his perspective, the Conference appears to be evolving into a committee of the whole and in subtle ways it seems to be doing more and more of the committee's work on the Conference floor. Last year, he said, there were amendments and friendly amendments and friendly amendments to the friendlier amendments and not so friendly amendments, etc., etc. Some committees had to scurry around to reword their recommendations during a break or at a meal. Doug concluded by sharing that it's time to take A.A.'s inventory—to include an examination of the General Service structure that was so intelligently crafted for us. The Conference started in 1951 as an experiment in faith and he hopes it will continue as an enduring reality, endowed with our trust that the process works.

Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., address the question "Are We Setting Policy for A.A. as a Whole?" Dorothy first defined policy as a principle or course of action designed to guide decision-making. Policy is important, because without it chaos would reign at the group level. Policy is embodied in the Traditions, the Steps, the Concepts, and the General Service Conference itself. To the question, Who establishes policy in Alcoholics Anonymous?, she answered: we do. It has been Dorothy's experience that we need to be very careful about personal agendas, focusing rather on what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. Her questions to the Conference were: Are we too political? Are we self-seeking? Are we following policy? Are we placing principles above personalities? Finally, when making decisions, are we looking at what will best serve the Fellowship? Dorothy's conclusion was that the Conference is setting policy for A.A. as a whole, as it should be.

The following sharing ensued:

- One person shared that shortly after coming into the Fellowship, what he remembers most is that A.A. seemed to embrace everyone. These days it seems we are creating difficulty for those wishing to participate in general service and posed the question, "Are we setting the bar too high?" We have to trust that those coming into service will do a good job.
- While we do not always agree with the outcome of the committee's work, it is not always necessary to correct the committee's work on the floor of the Conference. When we don't agree we can always vote against it and there is no rush to resolve many of the issues that come before the Conference.
- One has to experience the Conference process in order to truly understand it.
- We may have gotten too caught up in the mechanics of the Conference process and because of that, we seem to be missing the mark. Our egos may prevent us from providing the help needed to those coming along.
- During the Conference process there is nothing wrong with debate, but A.A.s have to guard against their anger and frustration manifesting in other ways.

Bill Clark, chairperson

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office Report: The Grapevine had an exciting and challenging year in 2005 as we explored new ways of carrying the A.A. message through the magazine, its related items and developed an increasing presence in new media. This year we began offering Audio Grapevine, stories from the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña in audio format, which can be downloaded into computers and MP3 players. Our staff attended the International Convention in Toronto, where the center of our activities was the Grapevine/La Viña booth, staffed with the help of many enthusiastic volunteers. We welcomed thousands of visitors, answered questions, provided a large-screen demo of our digital archive, and distributed fly-

ers and free issues of the magazines. During the year we released an updated edition of *The Home Group: Heartbeat of AA*, a large-print edition of *The Best of Bill* and a new book of selected Grapevine stories, *I am Responsible: The Hand of AA*. For the first time, the Grapevine wall calendar and pocket planner were trilingual (English/Spanish/French), addressing the needs of the three main language groups of the U.S./Canada structure.

Another important event was the outsourcing of most customer service operations to our fulfillment house in Ohio, which already processes orders and subscriptions for the Grapevine and La Viña. New toll-free telephone numbers for the U.S. and Canada, as well as regular numbers for overseas customers, were made available for both English- and Spanish-speaking customers. French customers are now being serviced at the Grapevine office in their own language.

As of March 1, the Grapevine and La Viña will be printed and distributed by a company in Louisville, Kentucky.

In 2005 the Grapevine welcomed Milton McGriff as senior editor of the A.A. Grapevine. Our associate editor was promoted to production manager. In November, we were saddened by the passing of our mailroom clerk, Stanley Kims, who had worked for the Grapevine and A.A.W.S. for 15 years. Customer service continues to be coordinated by Jeff Monasch at the Grapevine office. The Finance and Fulfillment departments remain unchanged and are overseen by the controller.

Our international magazine in Spanish, La Viña, continues to grow as a tool for unity and communication among Spanish- and English-speaking A.A.s. La Viña ended the year with an average circulation of 9,380 issues, a slight increase over the previous year. La Viña's second CD in Spanish, *Historia de La Viña II: Pasos 1 a 6*, with stories by recovering men and women about practicing Steps One through Six was released in March 2005. The magazine will celebrate its 10th anniversary with the May/June 2006 issue. La Viña and the Grapevine continue to receive many invitations to participate in Regional Forums, Area District and Intergroup events, as well as international conventions. Highlights for 2005 were presentations and workshops at the Northeast Regional Forum in Portland, Maine, in June, the Utah State Service Assembly (Grapevine and La Viña) and Peru's National Convention in September, the East Central Regional Forum in Michigan, in November, and the Southwest Regional Forum in Rogers, Arkansas, in December.

Robin Bromley, executive editor

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: Responsibilities of the group services coordinator include supervising the production of service material. To assist groups, the General Service Office provides service material based on an indicated need to provide information and share experience not found in Conference-approved literature. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; A.A. Guidelines; Referral List of Fellowships Similar to A.A.; and a catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs. In addition, the group services coordinator serves as G.S.O.'s liaison for Intergroups and Central Offices and has a primary role in coordinating A.A.W.S.'s participation in the annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar. Finally, the staff member on this assignment responds to the inquiries and concerns of A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. Current ongoing projects:

- Working closely with the Special Projects manager regarding directories and central/intergroup office records and lists.
- Currently supervising the updating of service material such as A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, G.S.R., and D.C.M. Kits.

- Works closely with G.S.O.'s Intra-Office Web site committee to update and improve G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter and as the regional correspondent for the Southeast region of the United States.

Warren Stafford

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 19th World Service Meeting (WSM) will be held October 15-19 in Dublin, Ireland, with the theme "Anonymous, But Not Invisible." We are anticipating over 40 delegates representing over 30 countries or zones. Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., will be the first-term delegate, and Murray McIntosh, trustee-at-large/Canada, will be the second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager Greg Muth will be presiding at the event and staff member Doug Richardson will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Julio Espallat, Irene Kontje and Warren Stafford. John Kirwin will be the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities.

Literature Assistance — The 2006 Literature Assistance budget of \$207,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contributions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Interim Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at four zonal service meetings, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In 2005, Adrienne Brown attended, as an observer, the 2nd Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM) June 3-5 in Johannesburg, South Africa. Greg Muth and Doug Richardson attended, as observers, the 6th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Surfers Paradise, Australia. Doug attended the 13th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany, as an observer. Murray McIntosh and Dorothy Wilson were delegates to the 14th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in Puerto Plata, Dominican Republic, and Doug also attended as observer.

International Trips — The General Service Board and General Service Office responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, regional assemblies, and other events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Bahrain, Belarus, China, Dominican Republic, French Polynesia, Germany, Ireland, Japan, Mexico, Nicaragua, South Africa and the United Kingdom.

The committee agreed to forward to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter a request to add the following descriptive sentence on the role of Trustees-at-large to the second

paragraph on page S63 of *The A.A. Service Manual* under the section titled "Trustees-at-Large."

"In the year between the World Service Meetings, the trustees-at-large may attend a Western Hemisphere zonal meeting, the Meeting of the Americas, as delegates representing the U.S. and Canada."

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries who carry our message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Murray McIntosh, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 58 international general service offices and literature distribution centers. The International desk is also responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and it is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and the services of both our G.S.O. translators and outside professional services. In addition, G.S.O. staff members who are fluent in other languages aid in telephone or in person communications. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries. The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O. staff, cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature (most touching are the unanticipated translations of the Big Book lovingly prepared by an A.A. member), and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into about 52 languages, and additional translations are pending approval and/or funding.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Doug Richardson

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — The 2005 International Convention, held in Toronto, Ontario, last summer, was a wonderful experience for the approximately 43,800 paid attendees. For the first time, members from around the world who were not able to make it to Toronto had a limited opportunity to view an encrypted, anonymity-protected, delayed extranet broadcast of the opening Flag Ceremony. Doug Richardson, the Convention coordinator, other G.S.O. personnel, the Convention consultant and the Toronto Host Committee combined to provide a truly international celebration of sobriety. The General Service Board accepted a recommendation from this committee that Al-Anon/Alateen be invited to participate in the International Convention in San Antonio, Texas in 2010. This participation would be based on the very successful Toronto model.

After two solicitations for competitive bids, twelve organizations had either inquired or been contacted regarding bidding to be the 2010 International Convention Consultant/Management Firm. Only one responded to the request for proposal, and G.S.O. management has selected Talley Management Group, Inc. to be the convention consultant for the 2010 International Convention in San Antonio. The committee reviewed the request to add consideration of an area's history in A.A. into the bid process for International Conventions. The committee noted that if a city meets the minimum bid criteria, an area's history in A.A. is one of the many factors considered by the Site-Selection Committee.

Regional Forums — Since the 2005 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Northeast, West Central, East Central and Southwest Regions. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about the general service structure of A.A. In addition, a four-city Special Forum was held in Homer, Anchorage, Fairbanks and Juneau, Alaska. Many in attendance were experiencing their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. At the end of each Forum, many of those attending reported feeling re-energized. Following is a list of the committee's activities relative to Regional/Special Forums since the 2005 General Service Conference:

- Reviewed and accepted the 2006 Regional Forums schedule, which includes four Regional Forums: Western Canada, Pacific, Eastern Canada and Southeast.
- Reviewed requests for Special Forums and the General Service Board approved the committee's recommendations to hold the following Special Forums: October 2006, Special "Inner city" Forum, Philadelphia, PA; May 2007, Special "Remote" Forum, St. Thomas, U.S. Virgin Islands; 2009, Special "Remote" Forum, Northwest Ontario.
- Reviewed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires from the Alaska Special Forum and the Northeast, West Central, East Central and Southwest Regional Forums. These summaries include attendees' comments on Forum agendas, suggestions for improvements and suggestions for future Forum presentation and workshop topics.
- A subcommittee was appointed to create a report on restructuring and/or increasing Regional/Special Forums in response to a request by the 2005 Conference Committee. As a result, the committee accepted the subcommittee's suggestion to revise the G.S.O.'s A.A. Web sites' Definition of "Regional Forums and Special Forums" to reflect current experience and to emphasize "communication at all levels of our beloved Fellowship."

The report includes discussion of the value of Special Forums, suggestions to improve the process for requesting Special Forums and consideration of geographic rotation for Special Forums. The

committee looks for guidance from the 2006 Conference Committee to provide specific examples of changes or improvements they would like to see implemented in Regional and Special Forums.

2006		
May 20-21	Special	Banning, California
June 23-25	Pacific	Seattle, Washington
Sept. 15-17	Eastern Canada	Sudbury, Ontario
October 13-14	Special	Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
November 11-12	Special	Kenosha, Wisconsin
December 1-3	Southeast	Atlanta, Georgia

Ray Massey, chairperson

Staff reports:

International Convention — The International Convention assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary.

Last July saw the successful culmination of years of work by then coordinator Doug Richardson. Members of Alcoholics Anonymous and their families and friends from all over the world celebrated the 70th Anniversary of A.A., at the 2005 International Convention, held June 30th to July 3rd, in Toronto, Canada. The theme of the Convention, "I am Responsible" resonated throughout this joyous weekend. The 2005 Convention was a wonderful event, with meetings, panels, workshops, marathons and stadium events. The Convention began on Thursday evening with dances and a "Party in the Park" in Roundhouse Park across the street from the South Building of the Metro Toronto Convention Centre. Beginning at midnight on Thursday, marathon meetings got underway in all three languages of the General Service Conference U.S./Canada—one in English, one in Spanish and, for the first time, one in French—and these ran continuously until Sunday morning.

Opening ceremonies were held Friday night at the stadium, complete with the Parade of Flags of those countries represented at the Convention, followed by the Big A.A. Meeting. The 2005 General Service Conference approved "an encrypted, anonymity-protected, delayed extranet broadcast of the 2005 International Convention Opening Flag Ceremony." This broadcast was accessed 1,760 times over the weekend. Saturday night, there was an Oldtimers Stadium Meeting and on Sunday morning, the customary Closing Meeting at the Stadium. Local Toronto A.A. Host Committee volunteers, about 3,000, welcomed the many visitors to Toronto. For family members and loved ones that belong to Al-Anon or Alateen who accompanied us to Toronto, daytime meetings, workshops, marathons and other events were offered at the Westin Harbour Castle hotel overlooking Lake Ontario. We trust that all attendees experienced a milestone event of gratitude and the language of the heart in wonderful, exciting, friendly Toronto.

While still on the back burner, initial plans are under way for the next International Convention in San Antonio, July 1-4, 2010. Big meetings will be held in the Alamodome, and other meetings will take place in the San Antonio Convention Center and local hotels. Notifications about the Convention, including housing and registration information, will be made available as we get closer to the dates. Starting in 2009, there will be articles in Box 4-5-9, which is sent to the general service representative of every group listed with G.S.O. Information will also be available on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

Rick Walker

A.A. Regional Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional and Special Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and General Service Office staffs. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; there are four Forums annually. The work gets done with the help of a very able staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The responsibility for direct contact with the hotel is assumed by a local A.A. host contact working with the Regional Forums coordinator and regional trustee. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates the details of the Forum. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" Newsletter at each Forum and a Final Report of the Forum to all who attend. The Final Report includes answers to all questions asked in Sharing Sessions and Ask-It-Basket Sessions as well as unanswered Ask-It-Basket questions. Sometimes the sharing is so enthusiastic that there is not enough time to answer all questions from the Ask-It Basket at the Forum.

Special Forums: A region may request a Special Forum, which has fewer participants from the boards and staff over shorter time periods. Special Forums require the approval of the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums based on a detailed description on the purpose and goals to be accomplished by the Special Forum. They may be requested for remote, sparsely populated or urban areas. The Regional Forums coordinator works closely with the regional trustee, host delegate and host contact to tailor each agenda to local needs.

Regional Forums: May to December 2005 — The Northeast Regional Forum was held in Portland, Maine, May 20-22, 2005. There were 302 attendees, many of whom were first-time Forum goers.

September 30-October 2, 2005 the West Central Regional Forum was held in Great Falls, Montana. Three hundred and eleven A.A. members, families and friends joined us at this location just south of the Canadian border. There was a lively exchange of information and many questions covering a wide range of subjects. The final report was lengthy and detailed to reflect the many interests West Central A.A. members expressed at this Forum.

November 4-6, 2005 the East Central Regional Forum was held in Houghton, Michigan. Three hundred and twenty-seven A.A. members represented a great example of enthusiasm and commitment as A.A. members from around the region had to travel great distances—some driving for as long as 14 hours. Having a

Regional Forum in this location was a brave decision and eliminated the need for a Special Forum to bring Forum information to this community. By the end of the weekend, it appeared that almost all attendees benefited from this special occasion to share experience and to be an example of stepping away from "half measures."

Four hundred and sixty-eight A.A. attendees gathered in Rogers, Arkansas, which is located in the northwest reaches of the Southwest Region, the weekend of December 2-4, 2005. Although no Spanish-speaking members were preregistered, the translation committee from Area 68, Southwest Texas, drove to the Forum and were available to serve any Spanish-speaking attendees. Sharing during and after the Forum was extremely positive and focused on substantive A.A. questions and appreciative of the opportunity to learn board structure, hear reports from the Grapevine and General Service Office and to discuss local A.A. concerns. The Final Report included responses to over 115 questions.

Recent Regional Forums Assignment Activities — The following changes have been implemented in the Regional Forums assignment:

- Initiated seating in rounds at Forums to increase opportunities for fellowship and to create a less formal setting.
- Moved "Markings on the Journey" video to Friday night at Regular Forums. This move has generated positive feedback and helps put the Friday night board and G.S.O. presentations into a historical and spiritual context.
- Staff member is responsible for preparation of Forum Evaluation Questionnaires Summary rather than an outside consultant. This saves approximately \$400 plus per summary and helps raise staff member's awareness of both positive and negative attendees' sharing.
- Added question to Evaluation Questionnaires "How Did You Hear About This Forum?" to judge efficiency of G.S.O.'s mailings.
- Created new form to capture historical information to help future planning.
- Staff member is working with G.S.O.'s Finance Department to review and analyze Regional/Special Forum expenses and the budgeting process.

The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment also serves as secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

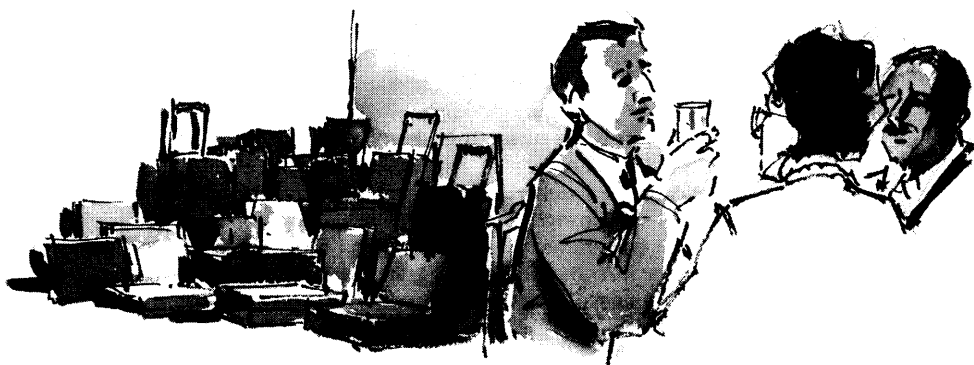
Valerie O'Neill

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: Following is a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2005 General Service Conference.

- *Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, Alcohólicos Anónimos* — The committee discussed the 2005 Advisory Action "that the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, continue to be developed, keeping in mind the 2004 Conference Advisory Action regarding the trustees' recommendations on contents, process and story solicitation and that a progress report and/or draft copy be brought to the 2006 Conference Literature Committee." The chair appointed Murray McIntosh, chairperson, and Ray Massey to the trustees' Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos* subcommittee.

Story Selection Process: To be under the direction of the trustees' Literature subcommittee on the Third Edition Spanish-



language Big Book; Story Selection subcommittee to be all bilingual — Spanish and English, include Spanish editors, Spanish-speaking staff members, and two bilingual A.A. members. The basic selection criteria: to use the same criteria as the English Fourth Edition Big Book based on Bill W.'s recommendations; each story must, as Bill W. recommended, reach out to the newcomer who is still looking for the A.A. solution; each story must be a standard A.A. story that tells what it was like, what happened, and what it is like today.

In August 2004, a request for Spanish-language stories was mailed to all Conference members, Spanish-language D.C.M.s, Spanish Literature Committee chairs, all central/intergroup offices listed in the U.S. and Canada, and G.S.O.s in Spanish-language countries with a deadline of September 1, 2005. Subsequently, the information was also included in *Box 4-5-9*, the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña.

At their October 29, 2005 meeting, the trustees' Committee on Literature agreed that the story selection process should not be rushed and extended the story submission deadline until June 2006. As of January 2006, 136 stories have been received. It would be ideal if the stories represented the experiences of a wider-range of Spanish-speaking alcoholics.

The Spanish 3rd Edition Big Book Story Selection subcommittee has carefully reviewed the current translation and provided suggestions for changes to the translation, as well as overall grammatical fine tuning. The review has covered up to page 115 in the chapter "The Family Afterwards." The changes suggested will provide a greater consistency with the original work in English.

As requested by the 2005 Advisory Action, the trustees' Committee on Literature agreed to forward the progress report from the subcommittee on the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, to the 2006 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *"It Happened to Alice!" pamphlet* — In response to the 2005 Conference Committee on Literature Additional Committee Consideration that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript, taking into consideration suggestions from the committee, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to finalize a draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet. The committee reviewed and accepted the final report from the subcommittee and noted that all suggestions were thoroughly reviewed. The committee agreed to forward the proposed revised pamphlet "It Happened to Alice!" to the 2006 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *"Too Young?" pamphlet* — In response to the 2005 Conference Committee on Literature Additional Committee Consideration that the Publications Department rewrite the manuscript, taking into consideration suggestions from the committee, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the G.S.O. Publications Department to finalize a draft manuscript of the revised pamphlet. The committee reviewed and accepted the final report from the subcommittee and noted that all suggestions were thoroughly reviewed and agreed to forward the proposed revised pamphlet to the 2006 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *"Young People and A.A." pamphlet* — Following its review of the 2005 Advisory Action that the pamphlet "Young People and A.A." be revised to include eleven current and eight new stories, a subcommittee was formed to work in conjunction with the Publications Department to finalize a draft manuscript. In addition, the trustees' committee discussed a request to revise pages 5-8 and page 43 of the pamphlet and asked the subcommittee to review the suggested revisions to the front matter.

The committee reviewed and accepted the final report from the subcommittee and noted that all suggestions were thoroughly reviewed and agreed to forward the draft manuscript containing

the revised eleven current and eight new stories and the revised front matter of the "Young People and A.A." pamphlet to the 2006 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *Distribution of background material for Conference Committee on Literature* — The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the draft manuscripts of the pamphlets "It Happened to Alice," "Too Young?," and "Young People and A.A." be forwarded only to the members of the Conference Committee on Literature prior to the 2006 General Service Conference.

If the Conference Committee on Literature recommends any of the draft manuscripts to the 2006 General Service Conference for approval, the General Service Office will make them available to all Conference members prior to the report of the Conference Committee on Literature to the 56th General Service Conference. All copies of recommended final draft manuscripts should be returned to the Conference workroom prior to the end of the 2006 General Service Conference.

Projects Completed:

- *"Questions and Answers on Sponsorship" pamphlet* — The text for the section titled "Service Sponsorship" that includes revisions suggested by the committee was added to the pamphlet "Questions and Answers on Sponsorship."

- *"The A.A. Group" pamphlet* — The revised pamphlet "The A.A. Group" that includes revisions suggested by the committee.

- *"Your A.A. General Service Office" pamphlet* — The text under the heading "The A.A. Grapevine" in the pamphlet "Your A.A. General Service Office" will be replaced with the suggested copy at the next printing.

- *"A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic" pamphlet* — The term "sexual preference" will be replaced with "sexual orientation" on page 10 in the pamphlet "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic," at the next printing.

- *Introduction to the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* — The introduction to the front matter in the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* that included minor post Conference editorial changes was completed. The trustees' Committee on Literature noted and agreed that with any draft manuscripts or works in progress, there may be minor editing, style, punctuation and/or spelling corrections prior to publication.

Paul Cleary, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

This was a year of extensive subcommittee activity, meetings, conference calls, deadlines and detailed reports. The literature coordinator served as secretary to "Too Young?," "It Happened to Alice!," and "Young People and A.A." subcommittees. Progress continued on the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*. The literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate all Literature assignment committee and subcommittee responsibilities.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups asking many literature-related questions: How can I order literature? Who does translations? Who can help me with my literature order problems? Where can I send my suggestion for a new literature format? Who can give

me specific text and/or historical information from our literature? Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 71 area literature chairpersons, 356 district literature chairpersons and 278 literature persons serving intergroups and individual A.A. groups.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for *Box 4-5-9*, published in English, French and Spanish with the following bimonthly distribution: 61,000 copies in English, 1,900 copies in French and 3,800 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O. editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in *Box 4-5-9*. The editorial committee welcomes ideas, suggestions and sharing on service from the Fellowship so that *Box 4-5-9* can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities.

As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Adrienne Brown

LONERS/INTERNATIONALISTS, HOMERS (LIM)

Staff report: The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable method of sharing for about 245 Loners in 58 countries, plus 71 Internationalists, and 209 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

The correspondence service also includes 496 Loner Sponsors, who are not "Sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list 57 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists, & Homers Directory* and a subscription to *Box 4-5-9*. Each LIM member receives the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication comprised of excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office. As with any directory or list distributed by G.S.O., LIM is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

In 2005, correspondence from around the world demonstrated that the A.A. program continued to be the basis of sobriety and our way of life. A single issue of LIM may include sharing from Australia, Belgium, Germany, England, India, Ireland, New Zealand, Peoples Republic of China, Slovenia, Taiwan, Vietnam, one or more countries in

Africa, as well as Canada and the U.S. The letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straight-forward sharing.

It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter unique challenges to their sobriety and courageously share their A.A. experience, strength and hope with one another.

Mary Clare Lynch

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: Since the 2005 General Service Conference, the Trustees' Committee on Nominating has met three times. At each meeting, the committee strives to fulfill the scope outlined for it in the *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, (p. 49):

"The Nominating Committee ...aids the Trustees in discharging their prime obligation to see that all vacancies—whether within their own ranks or among key service directors ...[or] staff members—are properly filled with members and workers of the greatest possible competence, stability, and industry.

"The recommendations of this committee to a large extent will determine the continuous success of our services. Its members will have the primary voice in choosing our future Trustees and non-Trustee workers. Careful deliberation, painstaking investigation and interviewing, refusal to accept casual recommendations, preparation well in advance of lists of suitable candidates — these will need to be the principal attitudes and activities of this committee. All temptation to haste or snap judgment will need to be faithfully and constantly resisted."

Recommendations of this committee in the past year have included:

- The committee recommended that the following language replace the current language in the Bylaws of the General Service Board in order to preclude Class B trustees from serving a total exceeding four years on the board except in the event of their election to the position of chairperson of the General Service Board. The new wording is indicated in boldface below, and the word "extended" has been deleted.

"All trustees shall be elected or re-elected at an annual meeting of the General Service Board. Class B member trustees, however, although elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board, shall be ineligible to serve for more than four successive annual terms, **following which, such member trustee shall be ineligible for any further service as a member trustee**, except with respect to a Class B member trustee, **or past Class B member trustee**, serving as chair of **The Board**, whose term shall be (~~extended~~) as hereafter provided for."

- The committee recommended to the General Service Board that Jane Sheppard serve as a general service trustee director on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, replacing Ron Gauthier; that Roberta Lindeman serve as a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, replacing Don Miller; that Howard Lowery serve as a trustee director on A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, replacing Gary Kluksdahl; and that Bob Mayer serve as a trustee director on Grapevine Corporate Board, replacing Mike Perry. All changes will take place following the April 2006 Conference.
- The committee recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2006, all candidates submit-



ted for Pacific regional and Eastern Canada regional trustees.

- The committee suggested that in the future all regional trustees should convey to areas in their region the importance of offering a candidate for regional trustee. The committee felt that in doing so regional trustees could reaffirm the importance of areas making certain that the widest possible offering of qualified candidates were available for election by the Conference voting body.
- The committee approved requests for appointed committee members to serve on the trustees' Public Information, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and Literature Committees.
- The committee spent several sessions reviewing background information and sharing pertaining to a request that the selection process for chairperson of the General Service Board be expanded to include past Class B trustees as candidates for this position. After a lengthy discussion, the committee agreed to forward the sharing to the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees for discussion.
- The committee discussed a subcommittee report on the efficacy of the "Diversity Statement" currently being used in vacancy letters and agreed to forward the topic to the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees for discussion.
- The committee reviewed and recommended the proposed slates of General Service Board members, officers of the board, and A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine directors following presentation at the 2006 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any.

Phyllis Halliday, chairperson

Staff report: This new and still-evolving staff assignment is responsible to the trustees' Nominating Committee, as well as to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to both committees when they meet, as well as preparing background, minutes and reports for the committees and reporting projects and activities to the Fellowship as a whole.

The staff member on this assignment also serves as a resource point for Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees within the Fellowship, sending out welcome letters, materials, and shared experience to district and area committee chairs, as well as serving as a Special Needs correspondent.

At the beginning of 2006, the packet of service materials for Special Needs was redesigned to include a pocket folder, a large-print service piece on Serving Alcoholics with Special Needs, and a two-color Special Needs catalog. A sample of the new packet was sent to each of the 144 current Special Needs/Accessibilities Committee chairs at the area, district and other levels. This was accompanied by an assignment activity update letter, which summarized the responses received to a letter sent in November 2005 requesting shared experience from the committees. The most notable aspect of the responses is that the common challenges of Special Needs committees can largely be solved only at the local level. These include such barriers to carrying the message as availability of sign language interpreters, wheelchair access to meetings, transportation challenges, etc.

Since only 40 of 93 General Service Areas have Special Needs Committees at the area level, copies of all communications are sent to the area delegates to pass along to interested parties in their areas.

Additionally, this assignment provides a central point for shared experience about Remote Communities work in A.A., and the staff member serves as the G.S.O. liaison to A.A. members involved in this service, and works with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting.

Gayle Solheim Riese

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership to carry the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); producing films about A.A.; preparing press releases and reports to the public; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

Television P.S.A.s — In response to the 2002 Conference Advisory Action that the trustees' committee produce one new television public service announcement (P.S.A.) every year for four years, the committee reviewed the concepts that had been submitted by four different candidates for consideration. A subcommittee on Television Public Service Announcements was formed to coordinate both the selection of one concept for development and the production of this P.S.A.

In October 2005 the trustee's Committee on Public Information recommended that the concept "Testimonials," submitted by Industrial Strength Productions, be developed as the 2006 TV P.S.A. In January 2006 the committee had viewed a rough cut of the P.S.A. "Testimonials" and made several suggestions for changes. The committee agreed to forward to the 2006 General Service Conference a revised version of the P.S.A. after review by the trustees' subcommittee.

Communications with the Media — The committee discussed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media regarding its effectiveness. The chair of the committee then suggested a subcommittee be formed. In January the committee heard a report from the subcommittee and agreed with the revisions made, and with the subcommittee's recommendation to personalize the memo and reformat it as a letter for mailing in March 2006.

Membership Survey — The committee reviewed the background on the historical scope and cost of the A.A. Membership Survey and agreed to forward to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee a request to discuss how to get more delegates involved in the survey process in 2007. The committee reviewed the draft of the "Alcoholics Anonymous 2007 Membership Survey Questionnaire," together with several suggestions for modifications, and forwarded them to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee for consideration.

Young People's Videos — The committee reviewed the recommendations for initial project steps involved in determining the feasibility of replacing current videos for young people ("Young People and A.A." and "A.A.: Rap With Us").

The committee approved, with modifications, a letter and questionnaire that was mailed to delegate areas and other A.A. entities involved with young people requesting young people's feedback after viewing the videos "Young People and A.A." and "A.A. Rap With Us," and requested that a report from this mailing and questionnaires be presented at their January 2006 meeting. In January the committee agreed to forward the full report on Videos for Young People to the 2006 General Service Conference.

Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to the Web site, updates on Web site activity, and a summary of

requests or correspondence from the Fellowship regarding the Web site and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests or correspondence. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board on the above areas, along with any additional comments from the trustees' Committee on Public Information, was forwarded to the 2006 Conference Public Information Committee.

P.I. Workbook — The committee discussed a suggestion to add the section on "Press Releases," that appears on page 21 of the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," to the P.I. Workbook and agreed to its inclusion at the next printing of the Workbook.

The committee remains committed to do all they can to assist the membership in carrying the message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Robert Pelot, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public — schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 700 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees, which are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), and radio P.S.A.s, in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio and films.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In March 2006 it was mailed to around 10,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. In 2004 the Survey was sent to over 700 groups in the United States and Canada, with instructions to delegates and to group representatives regarding timelines and instructions for responding. The results are then published in pamphlet form and as a large format table display, to present A.A. information at public events.

The success of any Public Information work at G.S.O. is measured the same way as any other A.A. service: Are we doing all that we can to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program?

Julio Espallat

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members make up the "G.S.O. Staff," with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2005, the staff received 35,935 such requests by mail, e-mail and fax, plus many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

Following the staff rotation in September 2005 a new assignment was created for Nominating. In addition to the duties of secretary to the trustees' Committee on Nominating and Conference Committee on Trustees, this assignment includes the responsibilities of alternate overseas correspondent, remote communities contact and special needs committee liaison.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further assure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, International Convention, Literature, Nominating, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. The staff coordinator chairs these weekly meetings and prepares a report on this weekly sharing session which is distributed to heads of various G.S.O. departments for their information. G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2005, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,818 individuals and 13 English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the open A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the *Quarterly Report*. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

Eva Sanchez

Area Service Highlights — Panel 56 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alaska: Area 2 covers the entire state of Alaska, an area that is equal in size to about 20% of the lower 48 states; most of the state is inaccessible by road. Next year we will celebrate 60 years of A.A. in Alaska, which means A.A. predates Alaskan Statehood. In carrying the message we are challenged by remoteness, language and culture. We have about 180 registered groups, divided into 12 districts. We have started a monthly area committee teleconference meeting, and a standing agenda item is to brainstorm and report on efforts to educate the Alaskan Fellowship about the Conference structure and work of G.S.O. In August we had the pleasure of hosting a marathon Special Forum covering four cities in four days. We are forming a statewide Remote Communities Twelfth Step List with a central coordinator to provide support to anyone living in a remote area. Lastly, we have been selected to host PRAASA 2008. Remembering one of our favorite lines in the Big Book, "We absolutely insist on enjoying life," we invite you all to be a part of this spiritual experience and as a bonus come early for a visit to the Last Frontier and perhaps even catch a little of the Last Great Race. — *Rick Horstmann*

Alberta/Northwest Territories: Area 78 is a very large geographic area made up of the Province of Alberta, the South East Kootany area of British Columbia, the North Peace River Block extending into British Columbia and the Northwest Territories. Basically from the U.S. border to the Arctic Circle. There are approximately 530 groups in 48 districts. Our area committee meetings, in January and May, move from district to district throughout our area and we bring the message of service in A.A. to many rural communities. Our area assemblies are in March and September and are in two central locations, so the largest number of G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s can attend. This year the area committee has set aside funds for travel assistance for District 35 (Yellowknife and surrounding communities in the Northwest Territories) to attend our Pre-Conference Assembly in March. In 2007 we will host a Special Regional Forum in Yellowknife. We are an active and productive area in A.A. and I am proud to serve as the Panel 56 delegate. We were saddened by the sudden passing of our past Western Canada regional trustee Ric D. He left us a wonderful legacy of service in A.A. and he will be missed. — *Patricia Long*

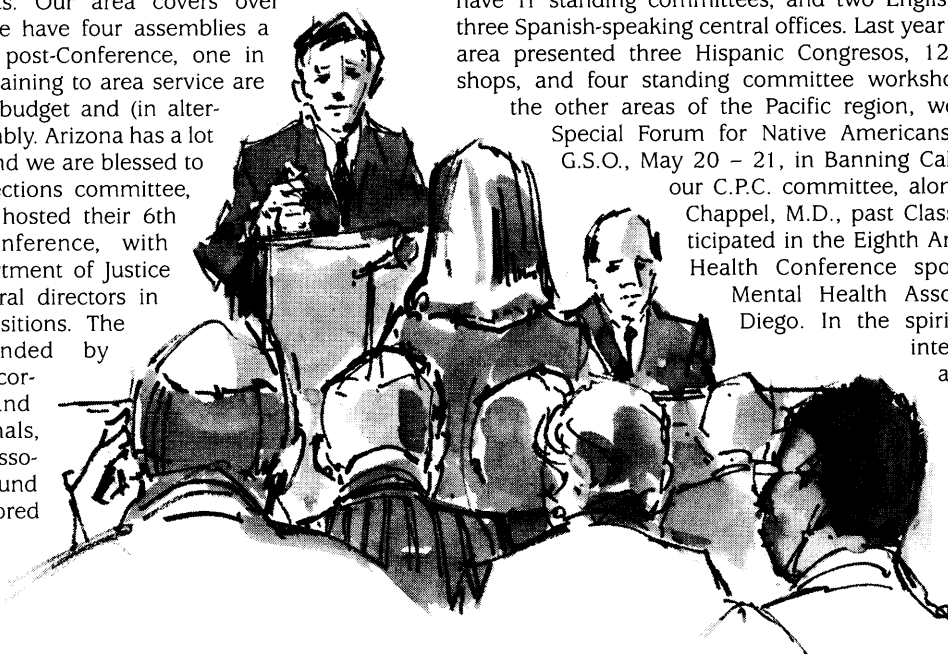
Arizona: Area 3 has over 900 groups serving a membership of 21,000 alcoholics spread over 15 county districts, and three Spanish-speaking districts. Our area covers over 114,000 square miles. We have four assemblies a year — pre-Conference, post-Conference, one in August, where issues pertaining to area service are decided, and November budget and (in alternate years) election assembly. Arizona has a lot of correctional facilities and we are blessed to have a very active Corrections committee, which this past January hosted their 6th annual Corrections Conference, with speakers from the Department of Justice in Washington and several directors in statewide corrections positions. The Conference was attended by approximately 80 A.A. corrections volunteers and about 40 professionals, including wardens and associate wardens from around the state. I am very honored

to be able to serve as a small link in this wonderful chain of A.A. service. — *John Staebell*

California (Mid-Southern): Welcome from all 1,850 listed A.A. groups representing about 58,000 members. Stretching from the desert to the sea we are indeed diverse with 23 districts, five being Spanish-speaking. We have three assemblies a year and six area service committee meetings. Having a large portion of our membership over the age of 65, there was a need to establish the second Cooperation With the Elder Standing Committee in the U.S. or Canada. In one smaller district a very proactive C.P.C. member has established a working relationship with the local drug court and visits it monthly so that they understand what A.A. is and is not. Our 14 standing committees (nine are Spanish) are active with numerous projects. In one of our larger districts, they have been able to reach out to alcoholics in the Cambodian section of their city. As one member of our area would say, "Make sure not to count the days, but make the days count." — *Bruce Henry*

California (Northern Interior): Area 7 encompasses the central valley of California, from the Oregon border to Tulare county in the south. The east-west borders are the Sierra Nevada mountain range and the California coastal range. There are about 700 groups and 27 districts, including two Spanish linguistic districts. Two challenging issues facing us, and under discussion, are the place of Bridging the Gap in our area, and the question of a Web site. We have eight area committee meetings, in a central location, during the four months that we do not hold assemblies. Assembly participation has grown over the last few years. Districts bid a year in advance for the honor of hosting an assembly, with voting taking place at the December area committee meeting. Area 7 has a relatively new Translation Committee, which does our verbal and written translation into Spanish; and the newly formed E-committee is just beginning to define its role in the area. The Conference process as a year-round event is a fact that we have been focusing on. The officers and district committee members work at educating the new G.S.R.s as to their role in the Conference process, and the concept that the journey is the real process in general service. — *Marianne Hawkins*

California (San Diego-Imperial): Area 8, has 1,429 registered groups, divided into 23 districts; three are Spanish-speaking. We have 11 standing committees, and two English-speaking, and three Spanish-speaking central offices. Last year the districts and area presented three Hispanic Congressos, 12 districts workshops, and four standing committee workshops. Along with the other areas of the Pacific region, we will co-host a Special Forum for Native Americans, sponsored by G.S.O., May 20 – 21, in Banning California. Last fall our C.P.C. committee, along with Dr. John Chappel, M.D., past Class A trustee, participated in the Eighth Annual Behavioral Health Conference sponsored by the Mental Health Association of San Diego. In the spirit of Unity, our intergroups and the area worked together to fund and build an Archives display room in the San Diego



Central Office. We now proudly display our Archives showing 65 years of A.A. in San Diego. — *Jerry Clarkson*

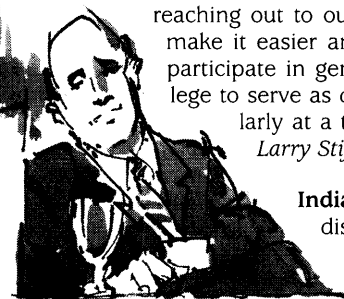
Delaware: Area 12 has approximately 220 groups in 13 districts, with a few meetings statewide for our Hispanic community. We hold five district committee meetings and four area assemblies a year. The assembly in April is to discuss, with our delegate, the Conference agenda items. We usually have 60 – 70% participation at assemblies. We have committees working with our three intergroups to carry the message throughout the state. We are a small area, but hopefully you can hear the message of hope from our cities to our farms. I am humbled and honored to serve this wonderful area as the Panel 56 delegate to the General Service Conference. So, if you are passing through our Small Wonder, please stop and look us up. We would love to have you join us. — *George Master*

Georgia: Area 16 has approximately 19,500 members, represented by around 740 groups. There are 17 districts served by 51 D.C.M.s. We conduct three assemblies per year in Macon, which is centrally located. We also have seven annual forums, based on the current year's Conference theme, which are geographically scattered throughout Georgia. We hold an annual prepaid convention during the third weekend of October. We make use of eight committees; Communications is a new committee which offers expertise associated with resources such as Web sites, newsletters, flyers and any other vehicle we use to carry our message of recovery. We have an assembly office, which also houses our Archives. Our pre-Conference meeting is used to discuss agenda items anticipated at the Conference and is a useful tool for our delegates. In December we will host the Southeast Regional Forum. It is my personal prayer that I be enabled to give away what was given to me, and consequently encourage other A.A. members to participate in their own recovery through service. — *David Schaffner*

Idaho: Area 18 has over 3,500 sober alcoholics, and 11 districts, with just over 200 groups. Our area covers 138,600 square miles; we have groups from Eastern Oregon, Western Wyoming, and Northern Nevada. We cover all of Idaho excluding the Panhandle. We have three area committee meetings — in January, March and August, and area assemblies in May and October. These are full-bodied assemblies, including G.S.R.s., that rotate around the area. We generally have about 50% of the groups with a G.S.R. present at the assemblies. We recently have made a Web site, www.idahoarea18.aa.org. We have one of the most complete archives in existence, with several original First Edition Big Books and all of the original Grapevines since they started printing in the 1940s. I am very humbled and proud to have the honor to serve A.A. and Area 18. — *Tony Tunison*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 covers the northern third of Illinois, excluding Chicago and its immediate suburbs. We have 24 districts, including one Spanish-speaking district, 1,100 groups, and a membership of nearly 23,000. We host a Spring Service Conference and a one-day Big Book Conference annually. Every third year we host the annual Illinois State Conference. This year we are working with host Area 75, Southern Wisconsin, to provide a special forum for the Hispanic members of the Fellowship in our area. We have established a committee to consider changing the

way the area conducts business. Among other things we will consider ways of patterning our structure after the General Service Conference committee system with the hope of encouraging more participation not only by G.S.R.s but by other district trusted servants as well. We are making attempts at reaching out to our membership to find ways to make it easier and more attractive for them to participate in general service. I count it a privilege to serve as delegate from my area, particularly at a time with so much promise. — *Larry Stiff*



Indiana (Southern): Area 23 has 25 districts with about 815 groups and meetings. We have 5 active intergroup, and a new Spanish intergroup in Indianapolis;

statewide we have 17 Spanish groups with 500 members strong. Area 23 has 11 standing committees with members randomly drawn by lot from our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. We have five area assemblies yearly with our pre-Conference assembly in early April. We hold a spring D.C.M. conference in early March to discuss agenda items with G.S.R.s and have a sharing session. Our committees are very active, from hosting state conventions, managing displays at health fairs and human resources. We were invited to five companies for presentations. Treatment centers and jails used Bridging the Gap and the Special Needs committee put a workbook together for Education and Awareness presentation. But our uppermost concern is how to better carry our message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Chuck Leck*

Kansas: Area 25 has an estimated membership of 8,750, with 374 registered groups, in 28 districts, two of which are linguistic districts. Our largest district has 41 active groups and the smallest has four active groups. We hold two full assemblies each year in Great Bend, centrally located. Two committee meetings are held each year; they include all the committee members, D.C.M.s, and any interested A.A.s. Each year we hold a State Conference and any district can bid to host it. Area 25 has the privilege of hosting the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly, October 13-15, 2006 in Wichita. Our Corrections committee has grown; 22 of our 28 districts are actively participating in carrying the message behind the walls. Last year over 6,000 pieces of literature were carried to incarcerated inmates. I can't say enough about the good work all Area 25 committees are doing and their commitment to carrying the message. It is an honor and a privilege to be of service to Alcoholics Anonymous and Area 25. — *Mike Sumpter*

Kentucky: Area 26 covers the state of Kentucky, the Metropolis of Indiana, and a small part of Ohio. We have 35 districts, 673 actively registered groups and 39 prison groups. In the past year, Area 26 has had a major overhaul. We began with the pursuit of non-profit status, and it was granted. We have redefined the role of our past delegates. We removed their vote, their voice and remuneration to any Area 26 functions. This does not include the chairperson or the past delegate, who rotated out of the chairperson's seat, so we still will have some past experience to fall back on. We also experienced the loss of two of our past delegates: Panel 36, Jack Jones with 28 years of sobriety and Panel 6, Naomi Bryerly, with over 60 years of sobriety and service to Alcoholics Anonymous. — *Darryl Miller*

Maine: Area 28 has 461 registered groups and 7,105 members, with the possibility of unrecorded groups and members hidden

away in remote and isolated townships of northern Maine and New Brunswick, Canada. Our area has two native languages, French and English, and we recently started translating our area minutes into French for districts that request them. We hold two assemblies and five committee meetings per year. Because of our large geographical area we try to rotate our service assemblies. The area sponsors four "Love and Service" days a year to assist any districts that need support, either with structure or lack of activity. Each spring we hold a pre-Conference forum and the delegate reports back with a post-Conference forum. With 25% group participation at assemblies, this area has a well informed, enthusiastic, and active group of A.A. members. There are 14 active committees. Area 28 has an annual Round-up. It has been happening every summer for 28 years. We invite all of you to come to Sugarloaf Mountain and help us celebrate sobriety! — *Denny Owen*

Manitoba: Area 80 covers 251,000 square miles, has 14 districts representing approximately 155 groups. We have four full assemblies, with two in Winnipeg and two in rural or remote locations. With an overall population of one million people, carrying the message throughout the sparsely populated areas, particularly north, presents a definite challenge. Our focus recently has been on instilling a strong sense of A.A. leadership in our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s, attracting new members into the service structure. We have solid A.A. in all areas of Manitoba and work hard to keep groups, particularly in the north and other remote areas, connected to the General Service Structure. I wish to thank all those that came before me in Area 80 Manitoba and the Western Canada region for setting a superb example of what service is about and teaching us that this is our legacy, our responsibility. — *John Sanders*

Maryland: Area 29 covers the state of Maryland, with the exception of Montgomery and Prince George's counties, that belong to Area 13. We have 965 registered groups, approximately 15,815 members, 47 districts and are served by 10 intergroups. We hold five assemblies and four committee meetings yearly, and have standing committees that mirror G.S.O. Each year we host two area conventions, in June and October, that run for four days and are attended by 850-1,100 people each. Our weekend mini-conference is held in April prior to the General Service Conference; a past delegate chairs the mini-conference to share his or her Conference experience. We are hosting NERAASA 2007 and have an enthusiastic committee making preparations. For several years we have focused on illuminating our dark districts and increasing participation in general and it appears we have had great success. We will continue to stress unity and service and look for ways to spark interest in general service. — *Barbara Bolt*

Massachusetts (Western): Area 31 has had several thorough ad-hoc committees. It was determined that there is a wide variety of special needs, and for some who are sick and suffering meetings are not always available. An Accessibility Committee was recommended and voted in at the 2005 Fall Assembly. Our area committee and all six standing committees meet monthly. We have six districts where G.S.R.s from over 250 groups meet; there are approximately 4,800 members. Eastern and Western Massachusetts will join forces for a weekend of fellowship and recovery at our 43rd Annual Massachusetts State Convention in November. Once a year, for the past eight years, over 100 of us board two buses — destination the General Service Office of Alcoholics Anonymous. The result — love, gratitude, and enthusiasm to pass on our gifts of sobriety and grace. — *Bobbi Padden*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 is composed of over 570 groups. Our assembly meets once a month and is hosted by one of the 15 districts. At area assemblies we have been discussing restructuring into two inter areas, a Northern, which already exists and a new Southern. Area 34 would then meet 4-6 times per year between the two Inter Areas. This is generating a lot of discussion and has brought people to the assembly where old and new faces are seen. Our committees are doing a wonderful job, but like other areas getting people to volunteer and serve on a continuing basis is a constant struggle. The state of Michigan has three major delegate areas, Areas 32, 33 and 34. On a quarterly basis we meet at the Statewide Service Committee in Lansing. Here we help coordinate and share our experiences. Hosting a mock Conference at the end of March helps prepare our delegates. This is the most difficult and rewarding journey I've been on. I have used everything I thought I knew and asked everything I can think of to ask and have listened to all levels of A.A. and take that conscious voice to the 56th Conference. It will be an honor and privilege to serve Area 34 for the next two years. — *Chuck Walters*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 encompasses the northern half of Minnesota, approximately 69,000 square miles. We have 18 districts, broken down into four geographical zones, and 560 groups with approximately 9,000 members. We meet seven times a year with two assemblies, four committee meetings and a workshop. The four committee meetings are held in the same place at approximately the center of the area. The two assemblies are rotated so that each zone will host an assembly once in a two-year rotation. The workshop is also rotated. Twice a year we have a "Zonal Forum," patterned after Regional Forums, where all five area officers visit and put on a presentation and discussion. Each zone is visited once in a rotation. The area continues to grow with more people wanting information so that we can make an informed group conscience. We have 11 action committee chairs with all but one (the archivist) having voting privileges. Newly-elected D.C.M.s are drawn out of the hat and placed on an action committee. — *Jerry Saari*

Mississippi: Area 37 has 24 districts serving 235 groups. Our area assembly meets quarterly in Jackson and we have an annual area convention, which is moved around the state on a scheduled rotation. We also have area workshops, which are held at various locations during the year to promote interest and participation in service work at all levels. We have 11 standing committees. Through our Web committee, we continue to seek ways to improve and expand the use of our web page. In fact, during Hurricane Katrina, the web master started a web log to keep everyone up-to-date on meeting changes and other events as they happened. Area 37 is grateful to the Fellowship for your generosity and many acts of kindness in response to the devastation caused by Hurricane Katrina. Attendance at meetings on the coast of Mississippi is temporarily down because so many have evacuated, but meetings are still being held, and attendance will bounce back as rebuilding takes place. All we ask is that you keep us in your thoughts and prayers. — *Glenn Harrison*

Nebraska: Area 41 embraced change and switched to a General Service Conference-style committee system. Our area-wide hotline answered over a thousand calls in the last year. Workshops on nearly every conceivable topic happened all across the area with tremendous regularity. Our Remote Communities committee sent a couple dozen Big Books to our soldiers in Iraq. Our bilingual Spanish district celebrated their 1st Anniversary as a district, and attended every area meeting. We printed new Area "Where &

When's." Our Corrections committee provided hundreds of dollars of literature to our prisons and implemented the pink can system that has helped finance translators for A.A. meetings in our prisons. We believe our best work is yet to come. — *Charlie Hanna*

New-Brunswick/Prince Edward Island: Area 81 has 13 districts, 9 in New-Brunswick, and 4 on the Island. All A.A. functions are conducted in both French and English; even our Web site is bilingual. We have to cross the Longest Bridge Over Water, in the World, (12.9 kms or 8.01 miles) to go to the Island. The area has 187 registered groups, with 3,400 members, 330 A.A. meetings weekly, 275 in English and 65 in French. Meetings are held each week in Federal and Provincial penitentiaries, many members have been cleared by Ottawa to attend meetings behind the walls, and a few are appointed to take inmates to outside meetings, workshops, and conferences and round-ups. We have two regional (three days) conference-round-ups in May and October, and two workshops and business meetings. D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s, have good communication and P.I.-C.P.C., literature, correction and treatment committees are active. The area's goal is to always be in communication with all districts, and encouraging members to get involved in service. — *Adrien Gionet*

New Hampshire: Area 43 has 15 districts, 569 groups, 643 meetings, and well over 10,000 members. There are nine active standing committees. We have quarterly area assemblies hosted by different districts. Two assemblies are "Pre- and Post-Conference" discussion, conducted by our delegate. A third assembly is for elections in odd numbered years and for an area inventory in even numbered years. Continued financial support has sustained our area budget, allowing us to support our elected officers and provided limited support for our standing committee chairs. We have hosted various Northeast region events and are looking forward to hosting the Bridging the Gap Convention in 2007. A member of our state correction committee will be involved with the convention, and attendees will be afforded a visit to Bill W's birthplace. Our area Web site continues to provide much requested information. Corrections is putting on meetings at state, county and local facilities, including the criminally insane facility, and is coming up with new meetings almost every week. The area Grapevine chair is traveling constantly throughout Area 43. A.A. continues to grow in our area with more awareness and support! — *Dale Kendall*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 has over 8,300 sober A.A.s in 487 registered groups, including 270 members of prison groups. Our assembly consists of four sections, 29 districts, 16 standing committees, six panel officers and representatives from our three intergroups. In addition to our quarterly assemblies we hold a mini-Conference to prepare our delegate for the General Service Conference. The young-at-heart among us enjoy an annual "young people's" weekend at a rustic campground. The Corrections and Treatment committee hosts an annual inter-area conference. Keeping our Twelve Traditions ever in mind, we conduct a searching and fearless biennial area inventory. With an eye toward staying right-sized, the Area 45 theme for the next two years is "We trust infinite God rather than our finite selves," from page 68 in the Big Book. Southern New Jersey is honored to be hosting the Northeast Regional Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (NERAASA) in February 2008. It is a privilege and a pleasure to serve the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous as a trusted world servant. — *Jimmy Sell*

New Mexico: Area 46 has approximately 350 active groups, 16 districts and one Spanish-speaking district. The area assemblies

are hosted by districts through a bid process and are held in March, September, and December with an area convention held in June. Through sponsorship, we encourage newcomers and G.S.R.s to pick two of the 12 committee meetings to attend regularly. This provides for a better informed group conscience at the area committee level, it fosters an environment of sharing ideas, and it plants the seeds for new standing committee chairs. The Saturday evening session is customarily hosted by the delegate and the alternate to discuss the upcoming Conference or report on the past Conference. — *Lori Padilla*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): Area 48 covers from Poughkeepsie to the Canadian Border, from the Massachusetts-Vermont border east to just past the Rome-Utica area west. We have two assemblies a year, an Inventory Day, Delegates Day, and three area meetings, and our area convention. Our first central office is in the Albany area and the 17 districts put on workshops almost on a monthly basis. My first serious A.A. meeting was in my kindergarten classroom in Rensselaer, N.Y. where I learned my second set of ABC's (Ashtrays, Books & Chairs) and thus started my path into service work. I went to my first area meeting with an old drinking buddy who was the area chair, and was asked to serve as the area records keeper. Thus started my area service work. Even when I didn't hold an area position. I kept going to our meetings. I have met some very wonderful people. To think just a short 17 years ago I was crying in my last drink at the kitchen table! I don't think they could have written a better story than the one I am living today, One Day at a Time. — *Bobby Fryer*

New York (Western): Area 50 has just under 400 groups, four very active intergroups in 23 districts, and most importantly, approximately 6,000 members. We annually host a Spring Convention, which was originally designed for the delegate to report back from Conference. We also host a booth at the Erie County Fair in Hamburg, N.Y. for 12 days in August, where about one million people visit this function annually. Our standing committees work together with the intergroups. Archives and Grapevine travel to all events throughout the area. We are seeing C.P.C. and P.I. working more together, while Corrections and Treatment are working better on more of an intergroup level and report back to assembly. Officers and committee chairs take part in the N.Y. State Convention, and N.Y.S. Information Workshop, which are hosted in turn by Areas 47, 48, 49, and 50 annually. Our task is to pass it on in a changing world, and I'm grateful and humbled to be a small part of something so huge, just one of the many miracles I've found in A.A. Please let us know how Area 50 can help better serve A.A. as whole. — *Bruce Akin*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeastern): Area 55 has 17 districts and over 500 meetings, of which 315 are registered. We have three intergroups, six standing committees, eight assemblies each year, quarterly D.C.M. meetings, a mini-Conference and a Web site-www.area55aa.org. Some districts have been hosting the assembly regularly and the area hopes we can rotate continually. At the beginning of 2005 we started a Correctional committee for the districts that once was handled by the intergroup. We have a District Correctional committee, a multi-district Correctional committee, and an area chairperson to serve as coordinator and liaison between the Correctional committees and the Correctional Facilities; recently the Area Correctional Committee has developed two Spanish meetings behind the walls. One of our greatest challenges is getting people to understand the importance of spirituality and money and how they work together to carry the A.A. message. This year



Area 55 will host the Ohio State Southeast Michigan Convention, which rotates within the four areas of Ohio. Area 55 has some very strong districts and I feel it is a great honor to attend and be a part of the monthly meetings. — *Kelly Thomas Carew*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 is composed of 29 districts, with over 500 registered groups in the 15 counties we serve. We hold six assemblies and four committee meetings a year. In January we held our 8th annual Unity Day Workshop with sharing sessions about our Third Legacy. We have a G.S.R. orientation for all new G.S.R.s. In March we host a mini-Conference patterned after the General Service Conference to offer interested members a Conference experience and give the delegate an informed conscience. We recently published a comprehensive area handbook, which is a valuable tool for both new and experienced trusted servants. Our biggest challenge as an area is to increase participation. Area 56 is blessed with many wonderful trusted servants whose dedication to our Third Legacy helps carry our message to those still suffering. I am humbled and grateful to represent Southwest Ohio at the General Service Conference. — *Mary Swart*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has more than 530 groups in 24 districts and over 10,000 members. Many of our groups can trace their beginnings back to Buffalo, Toronto and Detroit, and interest in group, district and area coming is increasing. Our area committee has many new people coming on and we appreciate the past delegates who continue to attend area functions and share their service experience on committees and in workshops. The Toronto A.A. International Convention was a great success, and an excellent time, with hundreds of volunteers from Western Ontario, and many members from Area 86 participating. It is our intention to try to attract a larger number of groups into participating at our area assemblies, and to encourage more groups to support general service at all levels. There is always a need for the greater communication of an informed group conscience within and outside the Fellowship. It is the area committee's hope that we may help to increase communication and sharing within Area 86, and throughout A.A. as a whole. Thank you for the honor of serving this wonderful Fellowship. — *Tom Vida*

Oregon: Area 58 is made up of 34 active districts, two are Spanish-speaking, and 871 registered groups. We have four assemblies a year and aspire to celebrate our diversity and enhance our unity by practicing the informed group conscience and honoring minority opinion. Our Web site is designed to be of particular value to those who serve A.A. Recently we were able to help G.S.R.s in Iceland when one sought information about the G.S.R. Schools that we conduct. The Pacific North West Conference (PNC) is the

oldest continuing conference in A.A., and Oregon gets to host PNC this year, June 30 – July 2 in Hermiston, Oregon. We are also hosting PRASSA 2007, in Portland. We look forward to seeing many of you there. — *Eric Knudsen*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 has 129 groups in eight districts, with approximately 1,500 members. We have an area office with two A.A. paid employees that provide services six days a week to all the groups on the island. The office receives all contributions, has a permanent inventory of literature, provides follow up to Twelfth Step calls and prepares all reports requested. We hold monthly area meetings. Every year we conduct several activities, such as: Convention, Services Seminar, Organized Services Celebration, A.A. Anniversary, Budget Assembly and close the year with a Christmas party. This year approved guides to help the area and districts take their inventory, as well as two bulletins, in Spanish and English, to report all A.A. activities in Area 77. Our Web site will be www.aa.area77.org. — *Tito Torres*

Quebec (Northwest): Area 90 has 25 districts, two local committees in a mainly French area with 386 groups, of which 18 are in detention centers, 18 in treatment centers and 17 English groups being served by Area 87, Southwest Quebec. District 27 serves remote communities and Nunavut/Nunavik territories. The area offers information sessions and has a workshop in March on the upcoming Conference. Area 90 is at its 17th delegate, of which 13 are alive and still contributing their experience. The area hosted one Eastern Canadian Territorial Forum in 1992 and two Special Forums in 2005. Our strength and unity comes from its members dedication to serve our Fellowship. Even if large in territory, members and groups stay in close contact with the committee chairs, the work groups and their area officers. Area 90 is grateful to Dave B., for his desire to stop drinking and bringing A.A. to Quebec and starting the path for Area 90. For all the above, I consider it a gift from my Higher Power to represent Northwest Quebec at the 56th Conference. — *Lynda Bergeron*

Québec (Southwest): Twelve years ago I arrived in A.A. and joined my home group. By the time I was group chair, G.S.R. or D.C.M., I realized that these members were full of defects of character, and I was sure that the delegates were perfect. So here I am! I serve the smallest geographical area—half of the Montreal island and its suburbs. There are about 550 groups, holding 750 meetings a week. The meetings are mostly in French, but many are in English, and a few in Spanish. There are four French-speaking areas in the Province of Québec, but ours is the only one considered bilingual, which means we provide English services in our area, and English correctional facilities services in the whole province. Each year we hold 11 seminars concerning the A.A. service structure and 10 area assemblies. We also hold four inter-area meetings with the three other areas of the province. We have 13 area committees, some in French, some in English, and many are bilingual, such as Internal Communications. It's not always that easy, but it certainly gives us a great opportunity to understand what Bill meant when he wrote the First, Second and Fifth Traditions. The area is proud to participate in A.A.'s primary purpose of carrying the message by sending G.S.O. each month our financial contribution. By this, we assure that our area is part of this wonderful Fellowship that brings life and cures the souls of millions of alcoholics around the world. — *Luc Rainville*

Rhode Island: Area 61 has about 249 groups and 8 districts; one district is Spanish-speaking. Each district holds a special meeting every year—"Joy of Service"—also an annual service oriented

"Round-Up." We hold three assemblies a year and one pre-Conference assembly at the beginning of April. In March we hold the Newport State Convention, which is well-attended from all around the Northeast region. We work on carrying the message to the still-suffering alcoholic through the different committees. The Grapevine/La Viña committee sponsors subscriptions to many libraries and some schools. The Archives committee is working on taping oral histories from oldtimers. We have a Web site, www.rhodeisland-aa.org, which provides the area and all members with information on what is happening in Area 61. District 8 is working closely with all committees because our primary purpose is to carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic. We hold many bilingual meetings, that way we are breaking the language barrier. — *Jorge Flores*

Saskatchewan: Area 91 is very diverse with its 300 groups and 3,500 members widely dispersed from the rolling prairie grain fields of the south to the forests, rock and lakes of the north. I have attended meetings in a garage heated by wood in the winter and on a lakeshore called Serenity Point in the summer, and also in the usual church basements. Our area committee meeting in January and our spring and fall assemblies are rotated to different centers. This year we are implementing a temporary contact program for treatment facilities under bridging the gap. We usually have 100% representation from our 21 districts at assemblies and committee meetings, partly because the area covers the expenses of the D.C.M.s. Approximately one-third of the groups in our area are represented at assemblies. Those who do participate, though, do so in a very generous fashion so that Area 91 is financially and spiritually blessed. — *John Fraser*

South Carolina: Our area Web site, Area62.org, provides useful local and worldwide services; in the first four days of January, it had 10,958 hits from 683 sites representing 24 countries. In addition to meeting schedules, one can also research accommodations for people with special needs. The Convention committee's information on the annual State Convention, and *Keep in Touch*, our quarterly newspaper. The Archives committee recently posted an article on the history of A.A. in South Carolina. During the assembly preceding the Conference, D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s, and standing committee members shared their conscience on Conference agenda items. Our regional trustee will join us in June, sharing his experiences in general service. This year, Area 62 will incorporate the 56th General Service Conference theme, *Sponsorship, Service and Self-Support in a Changing World*, through activities such as an inventory to assess the effectiveness of our services. Self-support being more than \$1.00 in the basket, Traditions and Concepts, and sponsorship will be discussion and information topics. Through being well-informed Area 62 will continue to contribute to A.A.'s ability to fulfill its role in passing it on. — *El Nault*

South Dakota: Area 63 consists of 14 active districts and approximately 120 registered groups. Area assemblies are held in the form of two conferences and two workshops per year, and include voting members who are G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee chairs and area officers, but anyone and everyone is always welcome to attend and learn more about A.A. Our area officers also chair various committees. Currently our past delegates are nonvoting members of the assembly, but we have been known to change this policy from time to time. Being a mostly rural area, communication is enhanced by the use of our Web site, e-mail and the good old telephone to help our area service structure connect with local A.A. groups. There are many dedicated and caring people in Area 63. If you are ever in the neighbor-

hood, come check out one of our meetings, we will have the coffee on for you. — *Estelle Grote*

Tennessee: Area 64 has approximately 500 groups located in 41 districts, two of which are Hispanic. Cultural diversity can be evidenced by the music peculiar to each region, and these districts are as diverse and unique as the areas in which they meet as evidenced in area business meeting discussions, which can be quite lively. Area assemblies are held quarterly and assemblies and the single state convention rotate throughout the state. Many of our past delegates are active and involved in area assemblies. There are six active standing committees: Treatment and Correctional committee members are active in the Bridging the Gap program, the Archives committee members work to preserve our memorabilia. P.I. and C.P.C. committee members work hand-in-hand to insure that the public and professionals are involved and encourage members to contribute articles for publication. Our Web site is "up and running" and is an invaluable in providing services for A.A. in Area 64. — *Becky Brown*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66 has 11 districts serving approximately 200 groups with 8 of the districts actively involved; three of the active districts are Spanish-speaking. We encourage Spanish-speaking membership by providing translation equipment at the assemblies. We have many rural groups and traveling can become quite challenging. Area assemblies are held four times a year, rotating throughout the various districts. The committee activity throughout the area has been a challenging endeavor to stimulate continued growth, focusing on building active, working committees. We have 11 standing committees, which include a Web site and Bilingual committee. The area Archives recently traveled over 3,000 miles to attend the Spiritual Homecoming in St. Louis. Area 66 is continuing to build participation and financial support, and the assembly attendance has doubled over the last few years. The need for communication with respect to the area committee and D.C.M.s has proven to be a necessity. We are committed to learn and grow together and I am proud to be a member of Area 66. — *Diane Dixon*

Texas (Southwest): Area 68 has approximately 490 groups, with 11,290 members, located in 34 districts, seven of these serving Spanish-speaking members. Our area meets quarterly for a two-day weekend, at locations rotated among the districts. We are fortunate that past delegates often attend and provide their experience and sponsorship. The area provides translation equipment, which allows the bilingual Spanish to translate for the Spanish-speaking members. We also translate minutes, agendas, and flyers. An annual Correctional Facility Committee Conference is held to help promote understanding and cooperation with these professionals. We look forward to welcoming everyone to the 2010 A.A. International in San Antonio and are excitedly preparing for this wonderful time. It is an honor to be allowed to serve A.A. as delegate of SWTA and I am very grateful to have the opportunity. — *Jamie Wheelless*

Vermont: Area 70 has 252 registered groups in 11 districts, with an estimated 4,362 A.A. members. These districts are linked by seven area committee meetings, and host our four area assemblies on a rotating basis. Our pre-Conference assembly forms the area conscience to guide our delegate. Small in size and numbers, we face the challenges of a largely rural area, yet, we have many small pockets of A.A. enthusiasm. It was exciting to host NER-AASA 2006 in Burlington. We continue to discover our connection to A.A. as a whole and hope to have kindled a renewed commitment to service work. Vermonters have a tradition of inde-

pendence, but, as alcoholics, must not be isolated lest we wither and die. A major concern is filling area, district and group service positions and keeping them filled. Service work kept me connected during some rough times, and I pray that others find this to be true for them as we trudge the Road of Happy Destiny. My gratitude to Area 70 for allowing me to be of service. — *Becky Collette*

Washington State East: Area 92 has 467 groups in 24 districts. We have groups and districts in southeast British Columbia, Eastern Washington, north Idaho, parts of western Montana and two Spanish-speaking groups in Oregon. We have three nongeographic linguistic districts that serve Spanish-speaking members. One of our challenges now is to develop a translation committee, which was created in 2002. We are also seeing the development of special needs committees and Young People in A.A. groups. We are celebrating our 10th year as a new delegate area in 2006. We are gaining a broader base of past trusted servants as each panel rotates and makes themselves available to share their experience. Service to my home group, Area 92 and A.A. as whole has changed my life. Thank you for allowing me to serve and participate in this great Conference. — *Dave McCallum*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has over 630 groups in 24 districts. Our area committee has been given a more active role in serving the groups, and meets more frequently than in the past. We have also found that area assembly meetings have become much more productive. In conjunction and cooperation with Area 75 (Southern Wisconsin), our Unity Conference, or state convention, was started in 2001. Its purpose is to provide an annual forum for Areas 74 and 75 members of A.A., Al-Anon and Alateen to share experience on the Three Legacies. Currently we are looking at restructuring our conference, changing dates, site parameters, etc., to encourage more attendance and participation. We hosted the 2005 East Central Regional Forum in Houghton, Michigan last fall and really put "a face" on the General Service Office for many of those in attendance. Area 74 had our first trustee, Bob Mayer, elected from among our ranks last year. I am thoroughly enjoying serving as delegate and look forward to our journey together. — *Jeff Campbell*

Wyoming: Area 76 is made up of 12 districts, with approximately 70 active A.A. groups. We hold two business assemblies and two conventions each year. Our committees include Treatment Facilities, which coordinates our Bridging the Gap program and Corrections where A.A. meetings are organized to be taken into the Wyoming State Penitentiaries. Others carry the A.A. message through Literature, the Grapevine and A.A. pamphlets and publications. The committee system is working well, with excellent participation by A.A. members from around the state. Our area conventions, in the spring and fall, are primarily social occasions. Our newsletter, *The Tributary*, announces upcoming area events such as campouts and jamborees which A.A. members and their friends enjoy in Wyoming's great outdoors. Our Web site can be reached through links with www.aa.org or at www.area76wyaa.org. Wyoming has many small towns but most have an A.A. group or a meeting where visitors are always welcome. There are not as many A.A. members to help with all of the service work and each individual's contribution is important. We are grateful for our sobriety and the Grace of a power greater than ourselves and show our gratitude through service and carrying the A.A. message of recovery to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Pat Milligan*

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation form and suggested that the section on laptop usage be modified in light of the 2004 Advisory Action allowing use of personal computers at the General Service Conference.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook, including the revised "Ownership of Material" statement and revised "Deed of Gift" form. The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee review a legal opinion of the revised sample "Deed of Gift" form before inclusion in the next printing of the Archives Workbook
- The committee considered annually reviewing a list to be compiled by G.S.O.'s archivist of proposed archival recordings (format to be determined by A.A.W.S.) to be produced for sale by A.A.W.S. so that the Conference might provide guidance prior to production. The committee requested that the trustees' Archives Committee develop oversight procedures for the boards and Conference Archives Committee for possible production and distribution of selected archival recordings, and that the proposed procedures, along with a sample descriptive list of archival recordings, be brought to the 2007 Conference Committee on Archives for their consideration.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee noted that the following points may be helpful in developing the three video segments directed to professionals:
 - Describe how professionals can use A.A. as a resource, including utilizing G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and local A.A. Web sites, requesting presentations from local C.P.C. committees, and connecting alcoholics to local A.A. service committees.
 - Utilize Class As or other nonalcoholic friends of A.A. in the videos to share their experiences of cooperating with A.A.
 - Include footage from A.A. Conference-approved videos and other sources to make these videos more dynamic and interesting to professionals, as appropriate.
 - Exercise care to ensure that the videos attract rather than promote.
 - Make videos available in DVD and other formats to be used by local C.P.C. committees for presentations and at exhibits at professional conferences.
- The committee discussed participation of local C.P.C. committees at exhibits at local professional conferences, emphasizing the role of local A.A. committees as a resource for professionals who come into contact with alcoholics.
- The committee discussed the practice of inviting professionals to local A.A. events (e.g., C.P.C. luncheons, events targeted to spe-

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

cific professions, and A.A. conventions, conferences and round-ups), and agreed that these are valuable ways to cooperate with professionals.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities develop sample presentations for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit, and report back to the 2007 Conference Committee on C.P.C.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook and asked staff to gather sharing from local C.P.C. committees pertaining to attractive design of A.A. booths at professional conferences and effective training methods for booth volunteers, for possible inclusion in the C.P.C. Workbook.
- The committee discussed how important it is to bring a spirit of enthusiasm and fun to local C.P.C. committee service so that more A.A. members may be attracted to C.P.C. service.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the Kit and Workbook and noted that some local committees prefer the term "Bridging the Gap" when referring to pre-release contacts and asked that acknowledgment of this local custom be included in the Workbook.
- The committee suggested that the Correctional Facilities Kit and the Correctional Facilities Workbook be retitled "Corrections Kit" and "Corrections Workbook" and that this terminology be reflected in Corrections service material where appropriate.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed the draft "Finance Card" and thanked the trustees' Finance Committee for its work. The committee asks the trustees' Committee to consider the following suggested short language for use on the card:

"The Seventh Tradition states that Alcoholics Anonymous is self-supporting through our own contributions. The contributions help cover the group's expenses. But the Seventh Tradition is more than simply paying for rent and other group expenses. It is both a privilege and responsibility of both the groups and individual members to insure that our organization, at every level including group, intergroup/central office, local services, district, area, and the General Service Office, remain forever self-supporting and free of outside influences that might divert us from our primary purpose.

"The monetary amount of our contribution is secondary to the spiritual connection that joins us in unity with our groups around the world."

- The committee discussed a request from an area regarding removing pie charts and a request from another area regarding adding additional pie charts to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix" and took no action.
- The committee discussed requests to eliminate the discounts on volume purchases of A.A.W.S. literature and took no action.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and made no changes.

- The committee urged the A.A. Grapevine Board to produce a Spanish translation of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook as soon as financially possible.

- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce an anthology of La Viña stories in the year 2007 or later.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee noted the development and addition of registration flyers to the Regional Forums section of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site in response to a suggestion from the 2005 committee.
- The committee accepted the Report on Restructuring and/or Increasing Regional/Special Forums from the trustees' International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and asked that the trustees' committee consider the following suggestions:
 - Add the topic "Regional/Special Forums" to the A.A. Grapevine's i-Say Forum.
 - Add articles regarding personal Forum experience to future issues of *Box 4-5-9*.
 - Implement a subscription process for ordering Final Forum Reports.
 - Distribute a summary of past Conference committee suggestions on ways to encourage interest in Regional and Special Forums to local Forum host committee contacts.
- The committee accepted the reporting on the 2005 International Convention, and acknowledged the work of our convention consultant in helping coordinate a successful event. The committee noted that the financial results of the Convention showed a loss of \$39,039, less than one percent under budget.
- Gratitude was expressed for the extranet broadcast of the opening Flag Ceremony, and committee members encouraged further exploration of this type of access to future International Conventions. The committee also discussed how special needs challenges are handled at International Conventions, and briefly reviewed the site selection process for International Conventions.

LITERATURE

- The committee suggested that the word "largely" be added, when appropriate, to references in A.A. World Services service material concerning any changes to the first 164 pages of the Big Book.
- The committee discussed a request to develop an intergroup/central offices pamphlet and took no action. The committee acknowledged that in many areas, intergroup/central offices have a vital role in carrying the A.A. message; however, they felt that there appears to be sufficient information available about intergroup/central offices in A.A. Conference-approved literature and service material. As the structure and function of intergroup/central offices vary throughout the United States and Canada, it was the consensus of the committee that, where a need may exist for an intergroup/central offices pamphlet, it can be best addressed locally.
- The committee considered a request to develop an A.A. history book covering the years 1955-2000, and reviewed the history of the agenda item, which included past financial expenditures, and following a lengthy discussion on the logistics of going forward, the committee agreed to take no action.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

- The committee considered developing a pamphlet concerning Alcoholics Anonymous, religion and spirituality. After a thorough discussion, the committee felt that there are already numerous references to this subject in the existing A.A. Conference-approved literature, and took no action.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee discussed the request that the Conference be mindful of balancing the number of odd and even panel delegates when decisions are made that affect delegate rotation and took no action.
- The committee accepted the report from the General Service Board on the feasibility of more balanced composition/structure of regions and, after lengthy discussion, took no action. The committee agreed with the conclusion in the board's report that it is feasible to change regional boundaries and that the procedures are included in the "Suggested Guidelines for Changing Regional Boundaries" accepted by the 1996 General Service Conference.
- The committee acknowledges the magnitude of the current General Service Board's Ad Hoc "Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Committee" project, which was defined by the General Service Board chairperson following the 2005 General Service Conference and involves extensive review of background material. The committee requested that the General Service Board forward a final report to the 2007 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions for review.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee reviewed the 2005 annual report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the new and improved redesigned Web site. The committee also encourages a continued sensitivity to individuals with special needs in future design and development of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the P.S.A. "Living in Chaos."
- The committee discussed how to get more area delegates involved in the distribution and collection of the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaires and suggested that a presentation on the relevance and the process of the survey be included as part of the General Service Conference agenda in the years in which the survey is scheduled.
- The committee considered a request to add the categories "Sober between 11-20 years" and "Sober more than 20 years" to the "Length of Sobriety" section in the "2007 A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet and took no action. The committee noted that "length of sobriety" categories are not part of the survey questionnaire, and that the categories are developed from data extracted from the question, "I had my last drink in ____" on the survey questionnaire. The committee agreed that, although no action was necessary at this time, additional length of sobriety categories may be considered by the trustees' and Conference P.I. Committees that would review the next survey and "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet.
- The committee considered the request to add a "Sexual

Orientation" category to the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire and took no action.

- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review the wording in the "A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire" for consistency with the wording used in the "A.A. Membership Survey" pamphlet. The committee noted the desirability of including a term that would better describe the "Native American" option under Question 4: "Race." The committee also suggested that option K: "Transportation (equipment operator)" of Question 12: "What is the nature of your employment status now?" be clarified or better defined.
- The committee reviewed a request that the list of early symptoms derived from outside literature on page 17, item #19, in the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings," be replaced with a list derived from A.A. literature and took no action. The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information make a thorough review of the pamphlet, "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" and that a report of their findings be forwarded to the 2007 Conference Committee on Public Information for consideration.
- The committee reviewed the P.I. Kit and Workbook.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee reviewed a list of proposed editorial changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* and forwarded suggestions to the Publications Department.
- The committee discussed the discrepancy between the Conference Charter and *The A.A. Service Manual* regarding panel rotation of district committee members (D.C.M.s) and took no action.
- The committee considered a request to include a description of the duties of a district committee member chairperson (D.C.M.C.) on page S30 of *The A.A. Service Manual* and requested that a list of duties be developed and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review.
- The committee considered a request to insert into *The A.A. Service Manual* an inverted triangle graphic similar to the one found in "The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated" pamphlet and took no action.



- The committee considered a request to revise page S28 of *The A.A. Service Manual* to more accurately reflect the number of groups in a metropolitan district and requested that a description be developed and brought back to the 2007 Conference Committee on Report and Charter for review.

- The committee reviewed the *Final Conference Report* and noted the timeliness of the distribution process.

- The committee considered a suggestion to restore *The Twelve Concepts for World Service* by Bill W. to its original form as published in 1962 and requested that the Publications Department restore *The Twelve Concepts for World Service* to its original form keeping in mind the 1985 Conference Advisory Action and all subsequent Advisory Actions regarding *The Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

- The committee considered a request to attach an explanatory letter regarding the appropriate use of the A.A. Directories and requested that the statement on the front cover of each A.A. Directory regarding "appropriate use" be made more prominent.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed the name of the "Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities" and took no action.

- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities gather additional sharing from the Fellowship regarding use of the video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* by those A.A. members carrying the message into treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments.

- The committee requested that the A.A.W.S. Board consider the development of a pilot electronic bulletin board on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site for those bringing the A.A. message to treatment facilities and other noncorrectional environments.

- The committee reviewed the revisions and additions to the Treatment Facilities Workbook forwarded from the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities. These revisions and additions were based upon the shared experience received from local treatment facilities committees in response to a questionnaire sent to areas, districts and intergroup/central offices in 2004.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all candidates for Pacific and Eastern Canada regional trustee.

- The committee discussed the report from the trustees' Committee on Nominating on the efficacy of the "Diversity Statement" currently being used in vacancy letters, and agreed that the current wording of the statement continues to convey the idea of an inclusive and diverse Fellowship. The current wording is:

"In seeking applications for all vacancies in Alcoholics Anonymous, the Fellowship is committed to creating a large applicant file of qualified persons which reflects the inclusiveness and diversity of A.A. itself."

The committee felt the impact of the statement may be

improved by positioning it closer to the beginning of relevant vacancy announcement letters.

- The committee discussed the option of having a Class B trustee serve as chairperson of the General Service Board, and requested that additional relevant background be gathered and reported to the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees, to include specific questions raised by the 2006 Conference Committee on Trustees.

The committee also suggests that all delegates consider discussing this topic in their areas and forward any responses to the trustees' Committee on Nominating by October 2006.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

FINANCE

- The committee recommended that the current small-order freight charge policy be replaced with a policy of charging shipping on all orders, which seems to be more in keeping with the spirit of treating everyone equally.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

- It is recommended that an intergroup/central offices pamphlet be developed and a draft copy or progress report be brought to the 2007 General Service Conference. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

- That the title of *A.A. In Prison: Inmate to Inmate* be changed to *A.A. Member to A.A. Member Behind the Walls*. **(Not Approved)**

- To make available the talk by Bill W. given at Amy's presentation to anyone at this Conference through e-mail or CD by anyone requesting. **(Not Approved)**

- That under the section "Domestic Status" in the 2007 A.A. Membership Survey Questionnaire, we add the option of "Domestic Partner." **(Conference voted not to consider)**



**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION

December 31, 2005 (with comparative totals for 2004)

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2005	Consolidated 2004
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Convention Fund				
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 1,038,052	\$ 749,226		\$ 47,479	\$ 864,851	\$ 371,664	\$ 3,071,272	\$ 3,301,275
Accounts and interest receivable		109,253			455,322	64,659	629,234	395,900
Intercompany balances	(1,106,881)	(1,587,400)		(47,479)	1,148,115	1,593,645	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					2,077,048	182,131	2,259,179	2,599,353
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					85,457	23,587	109,044	125,408
Investments - at fair value								
U.S. Treasury Notes and Bills due 2006/2014 (Cost: 2005 - \$9,886,504 2004 - \$9,441,843)		9,982,857					9,982,857	9,702,384
Property and Equipment								
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software, (net of accumulated depreciation - 2005 - \$3,304,400; 2004 - \$3,121,739)			\$ 433,448		198,699	18,018	650,165	582,904
Deferred charges and deposits	15,562				99,592	48,277	163,431	158,170
Prepaid conventions - 2010/2010/2015	117,801						117,801	994,378
Total Assets	64,534	9,253,936	433,448	-	4,929,084	2,301,981	16,982,983	17,859,772
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable	\$ 4,784				\$ 916,879	\$ 185,622	\$ 1,107,285	\$ 636,973
Accrued royalties					37,786		37,786	32,225
Deferred income								
- Orders and subscriptions	2,737				23,226	1,586,665	1,612,628	1,600,035
- 2005 Convention							-	2,267,815
Accrued postretirement health benefits		\$ 3,892,640					3,892,640	4,334,810
Accrued pension benefits		\$ 2,419,228					2,419,228	1,964,804
Total Liabilities	7,521	6,311,868	\$ -		977,891	1,772,287	9,069,567	10,836,662
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	57,013	2,942,068	433,448	\$ -	3,951,193	529,694	7,913,416	7,023,110
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	64,534	9,253,936	433,448	-	4,929,084	2,301,981	16,982,983	17,859,772

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2005 (with comparative totals for 2004)

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. Grapevine, Inc.				
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	English	Spanish Magazine	Consolidated 2005	Consolidated 2004
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales				\$ 11,923,839	\$ 2,531,799	\$ 104,039	\$ 14,559,677	\$ 14,234,495
Less: Discounts				322,773	54,659	-	377,432	380,853
Net Sales				11,601,066	2,477,140	104,039	14,182,245	13,853,642
Cost of Literature Distributed								
Printing				(3,438,800)	(437,945)	(48,814)	(3,925,559)	(4,638,014)
Royalties on books				(164,798)	-	-	(164,798)	(164,985)
Direct shipping and warehousing				(1,320,840)	(532,693)	(33,576)	(1,887,109)	(1,738,772)
Gross Profit from Literature				6,676,628	1,506,502	21,649	8,204,779	7,311,871
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$ 5,417,046						5,417,046	5,191,634
2005 International Convention (Net of direct expenses of \$3,958,372) (Schedule 1)	(39,040)						(39,040)	-
INVESTMENT INCOME	2,592	\$ 178,426		6,810	60,280	-	248,108	212,202
Total Income	5,380,598	178,426		6,683,438	1,566,782	21,649	13,830,893	12,715,707
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	4,697,284			2,116,641	934,924	129,388	7,878,237	7,999,021
Supporting services	2,746,011	12,254	\$ 149,456	1,566,969	587,660	-	5,062,350	6,612,615
Total Expenses	7,443,295	12,254	149,456	3,683,610	1,522,584	129,388	12,940,587	14,611,636
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(2,062,697)	166,172	(149,456)	2,999,828	44,198	(107,739)	890,306	(1,895,929)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS								
GSB La Viña support	(107,739)	-	-	-	-	107,739	-	-
Other Transfer	2,170,436	-	-	(2,170,436)	-	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	166,172	(149,456)	829,392	44,198	-	890,306	(1,895,929)
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	2,775,896	582,904	3,121,801	485,496	-	7,023,110	8,919,039
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	2,942,068	433,448	3,951,193	529,694	-	7,913,416	7,023,110

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2005 (with comparative totals for 2004)

OPERATING EXPENSES	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	International Convention	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	Spanish Grapevine	Supporting Services	2005 Total	2004 Total
Salaries	\$ 624,589	\$ 784,502	\$ 145,856		\$ 92,757	\$ 147,122	\$ 1,143,363	\$ 349,961	\$ 100,573	\$ 2,122,124	\$ 5,510,847	\$ 5,520,083
Payroll taxes	46,781	56,153	9,090		7,935	9,757	88,731	31,269	3,134	158,163	411,013	409,812
Health and group insurance	104,224	96,968	12,943		11,484	12,944	162,458	60,495	5,418	423,223	890,157	936,946
Retirement expense - funding	81,711	98,093	15,879		13,883	17,044	154,138	19,777		244,475	645,000	422,847
Other program printing	254,889	37,601	56,119			15,184	297			-	364,090	548,501
Mailing labor	117,737	7,055				12,963	8,402			-	146,157	169,041
Postage and express	198,790	103,499	56,395		1,124	51,826	39,082	6,465	720	41,030	498,931	521,516
Writers fees	4,865	20,372	7,650			1,675	68,769			1,427	104,758	88,584
Foreign literature assistance		163,072								-	163,072	188,662
Selling expenses							157,005	153,569	6,763	878	318,215	289,058
Professional fees									120	188,712	188,832	228,383
Contracted services	32,085	255,571	7,170		3,437	23,297	73,038	149,840	7,308	462,700	1,014,446	818,993
Occupancy	86,457	115,519	8,960		6,620	9,792	157,935	84,784		322,222	792,289	756,554
Telephone	17,201	16,087	2,258			2,146	15,310	13,269		46,993	113,264	118,777
Equipment maintenance		45				272	6,309			48,430	55,056	78,077
Furniture and equipment depreciation	5,989	7,610	749		749	749	8,897		177	21,103	46,023	78,583
Stationery and office	84,218	2,637	9,001			1,807	5,442	32,747	737	70,032	206,621	243,746
Office service and expense	9,782	8,152	19,654		1,132	2,606	9,345	32,748	687	262,821	346,927	402,776
Travel, meals and accommodations	1,832	54,814	464,351		209	72,591	18,120		3,456	451,799	1,067,172	1,222,292
Bad debts									295	20,715	21,010	22,765
Delegate fees			(138,796)								(138,796)	(258,317)
Total Operating Expenses	1,671,150	1,827,750	677,279	-	139,330	381,775	2,116,641	934,924	129,388	4,886,847	12,765,084	12,807,679
Postretirement health benefits										(442,170)	(442,170)	481,128
Retirement expense adjustment										454,424	454,424	933,229
Severance benefits										13,793	13,793	110,885
Digital Preservation Project										-	-	74,842
Capital projects depreciation										149,456	149,456	203,873
Total Expenses	1,671,150	1,827,750	677,279	-	139,330	381,775	2,116,641	934,924	129,388	5,062,350	12,940,587	14,611,636
Allocation of supporting services to activities	1,034,478	1,131,418	419,250	-	86,248	236,327	1,566,969	587,660	-	(5,062,350)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	2,705,628	2,959,168	1,096,529	-	225,578	618,102	3,683,610	1,522,584	129,388	-	12,940,587	14,611,636
Services	\$2,705,628	\$2,959,168	\$1,096,529	\$ -	\$225,578	\$618,102					\$7,605,005	\$9,240,519
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$ 3,683,610				3,683,610	3,595,030
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	\$1,522,584	\$129,388		1,651,972	1,776,087
											<u>12,940,587</u>	<u>14,611,636</u>
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2004	<u>\$3,184,272</u>	<u>\$3,596,775</u>	<u>\$ 1,232,433</u>	<u>\$169,234</u>	<u>\$288,229</u>	<u>\$769,576</u>	<u>\$3,595,030</u>	<u>\$1,645,255</u>	<u>\$130,832</u>	<u>\$ -</u>	<u>\$14,611,636</u>	

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
Year Ended December 31, 2005
(with comparative totals for 2004)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2005</u>	<u>2004</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ 890,306	\$ (1,895,929)
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	159,510	140,336
Amortization of bond premiums	2,792	4,152
Depreciation	195,479	203,873
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(233,334)	32,084
Inventories	356,538	(344,330)
Deferred charges and other assets	871,316	(619,012)
Accounts and accruals payable	475,873	(384,744)
Deferred income	(2,255,222)	2,234,644
Accrued pension benefits	454,424	933,229
Postretirement health benefits obligation	(442,170)	481,128
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u> <u>By Operating Activities</u>	 <u>475,512</u>	 <u>785,431</u>
 FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(262,740)	(69,550)
Proceeds from sales of investments	6,957,051	9,774,663
Purchases of investments	(7,399,826)	(9,506,825)
 <u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u> <u>By Investing Activities</u>	 <u>(705,515)</u>	 <u>198,288</u>
 Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	 (230,003)	 983,719
 Cash, beginning of year	 <u>3,301,275</u>	 <u>2,317,556</u>
 Cash, end of year	 <u><u>3,071,272</u></u>	 <u><u>3,301,275</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

March 13, 2006

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015
Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2005 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2004 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated March 4, 2005, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2005 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Our audit was conducted for the purpose of forming an opinion on the basic financial statements taken as a whole. The schedule of Direct Income and Expenses of 70th Anniversary convention (Schedule 1) is presented for purposes of additional analysis and is not a required part of the basic financial statements. Such information has been subjected to the auditing procedures applied in the audit of the basic financial statements and, in our opinion, is fairly stated in all material respects in relation to the basic financial statements taken as a whole.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2005

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of

assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the

A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in four separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND - This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from

A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND - This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND - A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

Amounts shown as prepaid expenses in the Convention Fund on the consolidated statement of financial position represent funds paid in advance for future conventions. These costs include site selection expenses, deposits on facilities and professional convention management expenses.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$716,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The GENERAL FUND - This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Prior to 2005, normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment were considered to be immaterial and were charged to expense in the year of purchase. Effective in 2005, however, such expenditures have been capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2005 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,105,871	\$ 48,041	\$1,961,746
Furniture	8 Years	689,598		689,598
Computer - hardware	3 to 5 Years	652,021	46,023	435,305
- software	5 Years	507,075	101,415	217,751
		<u>3,954,565</u>	<u>195,479</u>	<u>3,304,400</u>

Investments: As described above, all of the investing activity of the operating entities is consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity. The investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis. Investment income for 2005 and 2004 is comprised of the following:

	2005	2004
Interest	\$414,089	\$356,222
Realized gains on redemptions	4,678	5,144
Change in unrealized appreciation	(164,188)	(145,480)
Investment expenses	(6,471)	(3,684)
	<u>248,108</u>	<u>212,202</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the *Box 4-5-9* newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense is recorded in accordance with SFAS 87, in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 requires, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference

between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense since it is a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status, assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2005:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 11,563,413
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	<u>17,337,438</u>
Funded status	<u>(5,774,025)</u>

Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	\$ 2,419,228
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The difference between the Plan's funded status and recognized pension benefit liability is attributable to deferral and amortization of Plan assets and obligations as prescribed under SFAS 87, as well as unrecognized actuarial losses.

Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	6.0%
Expected return on plan assets	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.0%
Benefit cost	\$1,053,995
Employers' contributions	\$ 599,571
Benefits paid	\$ 983,166

Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 599,571
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	454,424
	<u>1,053,995</u>

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2006	\$980,000
2007	974,000
2008	940,000
2009	943,000
2010	951,000
2011 - 2015	5,432,000

The employers' contributions for 2006 are expected to be comparable to 2005.

Plan assets at December 31, 2005 were composed as follows:

Short term cash	\$ 160,297
Mutual funds	<u>11,403,116</u>
	<u>11,563,413</u>

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2005, A.A. World Services, Inc., as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2005 is \$1,707,000.

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are pro-

vided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from G.S.O. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The plan is unfunded. The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 5%. A discount rate of 6.0% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B. The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2005:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$3,892,640
Benefit cost	\$ (229,852)
Benefits paid	\$ 212,418

The excess of payments for benefits over cost of benefits of \$442,170 has been reported on Exhibit C as a non-operating expense (recovery) since it does not affect the current outlay of cash.

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2006	\$ 223,039
2007	234,191
2008	245,901
2009	258,196
2010	271,106
2011 - 2015	1,572,933

The Organizations have elected to defer accounting for the effects of the Medicare Prescription Drug, Improvement and Modernization Act (The Act) of 2003 pending authoritative guidance for the Act's federal subsidy. Accordingly, the benefit obligation shown above does not reflect any possible impact of the Act on the plan's cost.

Note 6 Tax Status: The Organizations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.



The Budget Highlights

2006 G.S.O. Budget

This budget describes the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office. It includes expenses of A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities). It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, or the Capital Projects Fund. The Grapevine operations are described below in a separate report.

Income: The 2006 budget projects net sales of \$12,655,000, an increase of approximately \$1,250,000 (11 %) from the 2005 budget and \$700,000 more than the 2005 actual results. The 2006 budget includes an expected return to "normal" levels of Big Book sales, and full-year effects of increases in the price of books and booklets and the shipping and handling charge instituted 7/1/05.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted higher than 2005 but less than 2004. The primary reason being for the reduction from 2004 is good shopping on the part of our new print purchaser. Royalties are budgeted at \$175,000.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately even with the 2005 results. While there may be expected increases in operational costs due to inflationary pressures, our warehousing group has shifted warehouse facilities and anticipated more cost-effective operations. In addition we intend to continue to ship products using less expensive methods even if it takes a day or two longer to reach their destination.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$7,235,400 or 58.8 %. This is about \$560,000 more than 2005. The gross profit compares with \$6,676,000 (57.7 %) for 2005. It should also be remembered that as we continue to strive to have literature available—for our Service Conference in Spanish and French as well as English—lower print runs in those languages could result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, individual lower overall gross profits may occur that may effect the overall gross profit and thus price increases may become necessary as things progress.

Prudence dictates that even though contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement during the last several years, other actions have been necessary. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied.

Contributions for 2006 have been budgeted at \$5,520,000 in total. Contributions received for the year 2005 were \$223,000 greater than 2004.

During 2005, contributions from groups and individuals of \$5,282,000 were \$114,000 (about 2 %) greater than budget and \$218,000 (4 %) greater than 2004. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International literature fund amounted to \$135,000 approximately \$7,000 more than 2004. In total, contributions received for 2005 were just over \$5,417,000.

Total Operating Revenue for the period is anticipated at \$12,758,400, approximately 15 % more than the 2005 budget and 5 % greater than the 2005 actual results.

Total Operating Expenses for 2006 have been budgeted at \$12,102,425, approximately \$975,500 or 9 % more than 2005 and \$1,007,000 or 9 % more than the 2005 budget as well. It should be remembered that this larger than usual increase follows a 2005 budget that was \$277,000 (2.5 %) less than 2004 expenses and \$377,000 (3.3 %) less than the 2004 budget. (Last year we noted that the 2005 decrease represented considerable efforts to reduce costs without significantly affecting service.) The 2006 budget includes increases for such items as the G.S.O. U.S.A. net expense for the World Service Meeting, increased funding cost for the pension plan and funding for the Retiree Medical Benefits Program.

For 2006 the G.S.O. budgeted anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$656,000. This compares with an actual income for 2005 (excluding the Convention) of \$976,172 and the \$83,517 loss budgeted for 2005 (after mid-year adjustments).

The expected 2006 operating income, the 2005 actual income as well as other transfers will work to assist in rebuilding the Reserve Fund balance.

2006 Grapevine Budget

The 2006 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation of 105,500, approximately 1,000 copies fewer than the 2005 budget and approximately 1,000 copies more than the 2005 paid circulation number of 104,356. Circulation for the last several years was as follows: 2004, 108,203, 2003, 112,614, 2002, 115,753, 2001, 115,034, 2000, 115,734, 1999, 116,000, and 1998, 117,300.

Income: Magazine income of \$1,933,000 is expected, about \$22,000 greater than 2005. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$644,500, approximately \$78,000 higher than 2005. The increase in the "other items" category anticipates sales of new products.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,635,715 is budgeted for 2006 compared with \$1,506,500 achieved for 2005 and the 2005 budget of \$1,587,152.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2006 are budgeted at \$1,673,300, approximately \$150,700 more than the 2005 actual of \$1,522,600.

Net Income: For 2006 the Grapevine anticipates a profit of \$19,900. This compares with a 2005 budgeted profit of \$17,783 and an actual profit from operations of \$44,200.

2006 Spanish Grapevine Budget

Following the 1995 General Service Conference Advisory Action #7, the publication of the Grapevine magazine in Spanish was approved by the Grapevine Board of Directors and the trustees' Finance Committee of the General Service Board. Recognizing this publication as a new venture, both boards will review the financial impact on the Fellowship and the progress of circulation and continue to monitor the viability of this venture. In 2001 The Board recommended and the 2001 Conference approved that the Spanish magazine continue to be published by the Grapevine but Funded by the General fund instead of continuing to draw funds from the Reserve Fund.

For 2006 La Vina expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$17,900 compared with a \$3,900 gross profit for 2005. Circulation for 2006 is estimated at 9,700, slightly higher than the 2005 average of 9,400. Other Publishing income is estimated at \$18,000, which after deducting cost of product of \$3,900, expects to contribute \$14,100 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$112,759 for 2006, compared with \$129,388 for 2005. The 2006 budget projects a net loss of \$80,699, compared with a loss of \$107,739 for 2005.

To date the La Vina project has incurred start-up costs/operating losses of approximately \$1,100,000 as follows: \$29,500 in 1995, \$138,290 in 1996, \$102,140 in 1997, \$66,182 in 1998, \$59,224 in 1999, \$49,570 in 2000, \$119,385 in 2001, \$103,815 in 2002, \$111,638 in 2003, \$111,592 in 2004, and \$107,739 in 2005.

The General Service Office 2006 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2005 Budget	2005 Actual	2006 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$11,400,000	\$11,923,839	\$12,655,600
Discounts allowed	275,000	322,773	352,800
<u>Net Sales</u>	11,125,000	11,601,066	12,302,800
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	4,000,000	3,438,800	3,600,000
Royalties	175,000	164,798	175,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	6,950,000	7,997,468	8,527,800
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,216,373	1,320,840	1,292,400
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	5,733,627	6,676,628	7,235,400
Contributions Received	5,275,000	5,417,046	5,520,000
Interest Income	2,500	9,402	3,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	11,011,127	12,103,076	12,758,400
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	4,864,000	4,776,251	5,106,500
Payroll taxes	343,000	350,959	361,500
Insurance	791,300	765,315	776,100
Retirement expense	436,800	612,966	892,800
Other program printing	492,900	364,090	400,100
Mailing, labor, etc.	164,707	146,156	113,500
Postage & express	444,412	491,745	451,200
Writers' fees	101,500	104,758	124,700
Other literature assist	200,000	163,073	207,500
Selling expenses	131,500	157,882	146,950
Professional fees	173,500	149,474	262,500
Contracted services	749,700	857,298	858,600
Occupancy	647,000	663,143	693,600
Telephone	97,000	94,071	91,050
Equipment maintenance	48,200	29,559	38,800
Furniture & equipment	46,500	45,193	80,000
Stationery & office expense	162,800	173,137	173,300
Office service & expense	353,925	298,651	334,825
Travel, meals, & accommodations	835,900	880,437	978,900
Bad debts	10,000	2,748	10,000
<u>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</u>	\$11,094,644	\$11,126,906	\$12,102,425
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	(83,517)	976,170	655,975

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2006 BUDGET

	ENGLISH			SPANISH		
	2005 Budget	2005 Actual	2006 Budget	2005 Budget	2005 Actual	2006 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	106,500	104,356	105,500	9,500	9,453	9,700
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,816,678	\$1,794,125	\$1,813,794	\$68,259	\$67,815	\$70,125
Single copies and back issues	54,600	78,994	62,614	9,000	13,542	13,546
Digital Archives Project subs	12,000	37,680	47,679			
Audio Grapevine			8,910			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	1,883,278	1,910,799	1,932,997	77,259	81,357	83,671
<u>Total direct costs</u>	758,051	747,804	729,326	67,476	77,450	65,763
Gross Profit on Magazine	1,125,227	1,162,995	1,203,671	9,783	3,907	17,908
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	650,970	566,341	644,536	34,836	22,683	18,000
<u>Total direct costs</u>	189,047	222,834	212,492	7,084	4,941	3,848
Gross Profit on Special Items	461,923	343,507	432,044	27,752	17,742	14,152
Total Gross Profit	1,587,150	1,506,502	1,635,715	37,535	21,649	32,060
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	251,730	220,714	260,778	66,707	66,620	68,265
Payroll taxes and benefits	74,984	67,422	102,808			
Occupancy costs	74,679	75,143	78,900	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	19,100	17,393	17,393	1,028	733	1,000
Product development	46,264	30,997	67,217	0	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	466,757	411,669	527,096	67,735	67,353	69,265
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	447,852	413,309	451,079	34,038	33,956	17,444
Payroll taxes and benefits	132,242	140,954	142,807	8,726	8,552	3,789
Kable fulfillment	103,200	118,843	129,233	7,500	7,308	6,555
Occupancy costs	71,496	73,196	76,856	0	0	0
Office supplies and expenses	46,820	48,102	49,102	0	0	0
Selling expense-regular	141,850	141,245	108,700	7,700	6,763	10,200
-GvR program	35,400	12,324	27,900	0	0	0
Postage	16,520	6,465	6,814	1,179	719	1,000
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	995,380	954,438	992,491	59,143	57,298	38,988
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Employee's Severance	0	13,793	0	0	0	0
Computer Consulting	20,500	25,496	29,000			
Leasehold Improvements	0	0	0			
Insurance	9,500	6,184	6,184	795	689	500
Professional fees	42,850	39,239	42,850	240	0	240
Meetings and conferences	54,000	44,483	54,483	2,500	3,456	3,500
Furniture and equipment		654	0	500	177	100
Canadian exchange and other	5,440	2,552	2,552	0	0	0
Bank service charges	14,419	6,105	6,105	0	0	0
Bad debts	12,571	17,971	12,571	460	415	166
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	159,280	156,477	153,745	4,495	4,737	4,506
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	1,621,417	1,522,584	1,673,332	131,373	129,388	112,759
Interest earned	52,050	60,280	57,500			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	17,783	44,198	19,883	(93,838)	(107,739)	(80,699)

2005 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS	SPECIAL MEETINGS	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
01.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	427	208	48.7%	40,468	8,756	\$4.61	1,239	\$50.00	409	25	\$42,190.75	\$4.82
02.	Alaska	191	81	42.4	14,958	3,307	4.42	1,565		1,418	13	\$17,954.51	\$5.43
03.	Arizona	903	398	44.0	102,740	21,343	4.81	11,455		1,428	221	\$115,844.32	\$5.43
04.	Arkansas	257	134	52.0	18,142	4,639	3.90	197	50	585	244	\$19,217.21	\$4.14
	California												
05.	Southern	1,141	415	36.3	108,205	39,795	2.71	13,675	2,200	2,783	2,829	\$129,691.63	\$3.26
06.	N. Coastal	1,833	1,084	59.0	248,961	56,284	4.42	9,442	2,650	4,656	439	\$266,147.40	\$4.73
07.	N. Interior	812	408	50.1	78,685	22,771	3.46	807		574		\$80,066.21	\$3.52
08.	San Diego/Imp.	833	360	43.1	82,860	25,260	3.28	3,636		2,299	207	\$89,002.25	\$3.52
09.	Mid-South.	1,808	778	43.0	185,243	56,692	3.27	7,364	25	3,309	433	\$196,374.44	\$3.46
10.	Colorado	661	366	55.4	99,265	15,860	6.25	12,260	75	31,057	142	\$142,798.28	\$9.00
11.	Connecticut	1,477	575	38.8	100,692	35,922	2.80	7,630	1,445	34,015	1,159	\$144,940.49	\$4.03
12.	Delaware	213	120	56.2	30,979	3,386	9.15	470		300	35	\$31,784.38	\$9.39
13.	D.C.	416	193	46.3	40,319	14,017	2.88	1,514	50	91		\$41,974.53	\$2.99
	Florida												
14.	North	770	368	47.7	81,917	16,394	4.99	9,316	2,625	7,466	1,130	\$102,454.01	\$6.25
15.	South/	1,681	849	50.5	179,964	37,215	4.84	10,764	2,030	56,585	286	\$249,629.66	\$6.71
16.	Georgia	730	410	56.2	77,729	16,292	4.77	1,028	150	6,261	113	\$85,281.84	\$5.23
17.	Hawaii	281	155	55.1	30,292	5,158	5.86	906		1,237	48	\$32,483.95	\$6.30
18.	Idaho	216	92	42.6	19,649	3,971	4.94	565	1,000	1,656		\$22,870.58	\$5.76
	Illinois												
19.	Chicago	1,139	275	24.1	74,110	27,147	2.72	3,438		7,431	326	\$85,304.27	\$3.14
20.	North	1,118	398	35.6	54,766	22,895	2.38	1,563		14,479	383	\$71,190.78	\$3.11
21.	South	469	163	34.7	26,106	8,631	3.01	656		75		\$26,837.07	\$3.11
	Indiana												
22.	North	658	250	38.0	33,271	9,610	4.46	902	60	1,264	20	\$35,516.53	\$3.70
23.	South	605	265	43.8	34,759	10,626	3.27	306	25	365	64	\$35,519.33	\$3.34
24.	Iowa	652	271	41.6	45,722	13,667	3.34	913	20	372		\$47,027.32	\$3.44
25.	Kansas	381	177	46.5	30,778	9,765	3.14	3,691	300	2,732	1,500	\$39,000.96	\$3.99
26.	Kentucky	673	274	40.6	56,227	10,395	5.41	7,453		1,013	15	\$64,709.02	\$6.23
27.	Louisiana	566	163	28.7	29,809	11,873	2.50	664		177	30	\$30,679.53	\$2.58
28.	Maine	475	158	33.2	18,948	8,007	2.36	293	25	1,104	192	\$20,563.47	\$2.57
29.	Maryland	942	393	41.6	80,349	15,405	5.21	3,925	115	675	20	\$85,084.21	\$5.52
	Massachusetts												
30.	East	1,420	485	34.1	104,178	48,686	2.13	3,719	500	2,250		\$110,646.81	\$2.27
31.	West	260	149	57.2	19,155	4,799	3.98	255	1,020			\$20,429.92	\$4.26
	Michigan												
32.	Central	603	238	39.4	37,702	14,031	2.69	1,874		1,176	30	\$40,781.41	\$2.91
33.	Southeast	823	283	34.3	60,172	19,735	3.05	1,152		2,250		\$63,573.21	\$3.22
34.	West	532	209	39.2	36,885	10,794	3.41	436	377	1,183		\$38,881.39	\$3.60
	Minnesota												
35.	North	544	250	46.0	25,286	9,006	2.80	328		625	210	\$26,448.26	\$2.94
36.	South	1,025	401	39.1	70,183	24,660	2.85	1,518		1,140	100	\$72,940.38	\$2.96
37.	Mississippi	239	78	32.6	14,837	4,695	3.16	409		2,115		\$17,361.37	\$3.70
	Missouri												
38.	East	519	247	47.5	55,278	8,687	6.36	3,427	229	979	49	\$59,961.76	\$6.90
39.	West	215	98	45.5	14,776	6,537	2.26	753	25			\$15,553.58	\$2.38
40.	Montana	279	119	42.6	19,199	4,434	4.33	42		458		\$19,699.57	\$4.44
41.	Nebraska	687	338	49.1	51,353	15,307	3.34	386	30	1,120		\$52,888.15	\$3.46
42.	Nevada	485	182	37.5	29,670	12,011	2.46	3,708	500	8,090	604	\$42,572.62	\$3.54
43.	New Hampshire	545	244	44.8	30,469	10,653	2.86	440		1,884		\$32,793.03	\$3.08
	New Jersey												
44.	North	1,220	473	38.8	88,344	29,703	2.96	11,808	383	1,085	44	\$101,663.74	\$3.42
45.	South	487	259	53.2	57,353	8,304	6.91	880	458	1,596	1,596	\$60,452.09	\$7.28
46.	New Mexico	333	160	47.9	26,622	6,249	4.25	1,575	500	\$681	50	\$29,428.31	\$4.71
	New York												
47.	Central	718	250	34.7	40,159	11,122	3.60	2,260	300	6,000	1,000	\$49,719.43	\$4.47
48.	H./M./B.	718	297	41.4	29,365	11,145	2.63	1,524	790	3,418	110	\$35,206	\$3.16
49.	Southeast	1,757	700	39.7	199,222	56,753	3.51	10,118	25	2,545	198	\$212,108.29	\$3.74
50.	West	334	77	23.0	11,760	5,942	1.97	225				\$11,984.37	\$2.02
51.	N. Carolina	994	452	47.8	88,528	15,294	5.78	3,599	1,650	1,510	750	\$96,036.47	\$6.28
52.	North Dakota	140	43	30.6	5,917	3,137	1.88	25		859		\$6,801.22	\$2.17
	Ohio												
53.	Cent. & S.E.	682	185	27.1	25,504	9,886	2.58	1,125	500	770		\$27,899.06	\$2.82
54.	Northeast	1,472	290	19.7	35,887	22,385	1.59	1,490		727		\$38,103.28	\$1.70
55.	N.W. Ohio/ S.E. Mich.	291	105	36.0	12,278	4,206	2.91	87	100			\$12,464.85	\$2.96
56.	S.W. Ohio	539	225	41.6	39,772	10,838	3.66	458	15	91	200	\$40,536.23	\$3.74
57.	Oklahoma	394	177	44.8	26,810	7,077	3.78	1,147	63	837	400	\$29,256.95	\$4.13
58.	Oregon	903	386	42.7	68,860	18,045	3.81	4,161	200	3,233	298	\$76,751.28	\$4.25

Pennsylvania													
59.	East	1,426	680	47.7	137,372	31,107	4.41	5,469	1,290	4,242	190	\$148,562.71	\$4.78
60.	West	828	392	47.3	50,130	11,770	4.25	1,015		977		\$52,122.32	\$4.43
61.	Rhode Island	261	111	42.4	20,561	5,413	3.79	274	500	\$2,234		\$23,568.90	\$4.35
62.	South Carolina	342	176	51.4	36,833	7,580	4.85	409	300	2,997		\$40,538.73	\$5.35
63.	South Dakota	170	68	40.0	7,142	4,054	1.75	276		351		\$7,769.29	\$1.92
64.	Tennessee	511	244	47.6	49,314	11,678	4.22	680	100		50	\$50,144.01	\$4.29
Texas													
65.	Northeast	508	208	40.8	60,333	19,992	3.02	3,027	200	3,023	250	\$66,832.55	\$3.34
66.	Northwest	225	68	30.1	12,736	5,350	2.37	481	10	1,087		\$14,314.01	\$2.68
67.	Southeast	575	251	43.7	46,827	17,351	2.69	4,515	1,275	2,482	30	\$55,128.89	\$3.18
68.	Southwest	524	220	41.9	53,177	11,639	4.56	842	1,050	526	60	\$55,655.46	\$4.78
69.	Utah	265	153	57.6	29,299	5,292	5.54	1,048	65	25		\$30,437.59	\$5.75
70.	Vermont	255	107	41.9	16,140	4,646	3.47	2,346	25	400		\$18,910.83	\$4.07
71.	Virginia	1,186	622	52.3	117,215	21,830	5.36	6,451	1,125	4,215	79	\$129,084.97	\$5.91
72.	Western Washington	1,184	534	45.1	101,181	26,078	3.87	4,332		8,197	111	\$113,820.22	\$4.36
73.	West Virginia	309	122	39.5	10,951	3,415	3.21	169	60	666		\$11,845.39	\$3.47
Wisconsin													
74.	N. Wis./Upper Pen. Mich.	649	223	34.4	24,367	10,406	2.33	523	125	310		\$25,324.72	\$2.43
75.	South	965	414	42.9	49,069	18,299	2.68	419		2,257	55	\$51,800.08	\$2.83
76.	Wyoming	108	50	46.3	10,276	1,994	5.14	289	250	1,556	500	\$12,870.46	\$6.45
77.	Puerto Rico	133	64	48.1	5,467	1,499	3.65	10		120		\$5,597.48	\$3.73
78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	509	220	43.2	45,866	8,417	5.45	1,836		4,177	457	\$52,336.56	\$6.22
79.	B.C./Yukon	733	362	49.4	78,443	14,015	5.59	543		3,291	390	\$82,668.22	\$5.90
80.	Manitoba	150	50	33.3	6,552	3,958	1.66	79		1,052		\$7,682.23	\$1.94
81.	N.B./P.E.I.	189	75	39.6	8,018	3,602	2.23	4			42	\$8,065.02	\$2.24
82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	248	77	31.0	7,014	3,217	2.18	20	82			\$7,116.62	\$2.21
Ontario													
83.	East	565	212	37.4	48,080	14,612	3.28	456	41	7,773	336	\$56,685.81	\$3.88
84.	Northeast	151	68	44.9	11,101	1,999	5.55	221				\$11,322.35	\$5.66
85.	Northwest	70	20	28.6	3,001	1,201	2.49	108		1,364		\$4,472.56	\$3.72
86.	West	562	178	31.7	38,162	10,240	3.73	724	600	12,891		\$52,377.16	\$5.11
Quebec (1)													
87.	Southwest	532	518	97.3	12,692	14,912	0.84	2,606		15,221		\$30,518.81	\$2.05
88.	Southeast	197	128	65.0	2,273	3,106	0.72	169		9,655		\$12,096.91	\$3.89
89.	Northeast	330	308	93.2	3,112	6,702	0.45	925		21,737		\$25,773.96	\$3.89
90.	Northwest	351	308	87.6	2,409	6,506	0.36	491		74,754		\$77,653.81	\$11.94
91.	Saskatchewan	305	123	40.3	14,651	3,704	3.96	203		1,943	100	\$16,896.68	\$4.56
92.	Washington East	450	161	35.8	17,755	6,173	2.87	170		871		\$18,794.93	\$3.04
93.	Central Calif	865	371	42.9	70,590	23,717	2.97	4,279		1,872	231	\$76,971.82	\$3.25
	Total U.S./Canada	58,067	25,067	43.2	\$4,559,542.44	1,294,678	3.52	221,973.40	\$27,658.79	\$423,273.35	\$18,396.64	\$5,250,844.62	\$4.06
Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings					\$268,028.83								
Specials					\$423,273.35								
Total for U.S. & Canada					\$5,250,844.62								
FOREIGN AND OTHER													
Online Meetings					\$444.58								
Correctional & Hospital facility groups					\$23.00								
Foreign					\$165,519.79								
Loners					\$214.00								
Birds of a Feather													
International Doctors in A.A.													
International Lawyers in A.A.													
Grand Total					\$5,417,045.99								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON - 2004-2003 (in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTIONS PER CAPITA	TOTAL PER CAPITA INCLUDING SPECIALS ETC		
U.S. & Canada									
2005	58,067	25,067	43.2%	\$4,559,542.44	1,294,678	\$3.52	\$4.06		
U.S. & Canada									
2004	57,523	25,140	43.7%	\$4,419,803.91	1,286,621	\$3.44	\$3.92		
Increase (Decrease)	544	(73)	-0.5%	\$139,738.53	8,057	\$0.08	\$0.14	EST. COST OF SERVICES PER CAPITA	
								2005	2004
								\$5.75	\$5.93

¹ Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed through their Conference Areas (per info from areas)

2006 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Kelly Carew
Terry Coates
Adrien Gionet
¹Keith Hashimoto
Chuck Hood
Eric Knudsen
²Gail Lee
Bobbi Padden

Secretary: Rick Walker

Cooperation With the Professional Community

²Chip Berkley
Barbara Bolt
Amalia Castillo
¹Dick Frohock
Marianne Hawkins
Chuck Leck
Reiner Rehbein
David Schaffner

Secretary: Irene Kontje

Corrections

Bruce Akin
Estelle Grote
Una Healey
Rick Horstmann
²Mike Ohlson
Meri Ray
¹Pete Roth
Larry Stiff

Secretary: Mary Dargan

Finance

Bobby Fryer
Laura Jackson
Gene Kroll
Luc Rainville
²Alan Siebel
¹Susan Taylor
Tony Tunison
Jamie Wheelless
Jim Whipple

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

²Fran Bigras-Galipeau
Jerry Clarkson
Jorge Flores
Glenn Harrison
Pat Long
Mike Nelson
Jesse Perry
Mary Swart
¹Naomi Zeiller

Secretary: Hernán Merea

Literature

Lynda Bergeron
¹Vicki Bunnell
Mark Cruz
Jerry Saari
John Sanders
Michael Scott
Mike Sumpter
²Debbie Temple

Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Policy/Admissions

Becky Brown
Dick Donahue
Nancy Gusner
¹Don Massey
George Masters
²Rondell Miller
John Staebell
Chuck Walters

Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Public Information

Diane Dixon
John Fraser
Barbara Kelly
Dale Kendall
²Mark Miller
Joyce Pettitt
¹Nancy Poillucci
Tito Torres

Secretary: Julio Espaillet

Report and Charter

Francisco Almada
Becky Collette
Charlie Hanna
²Madeline Humphreys
Gary Lutz
El Nault
Charles Pederson
¹Cushing Phillips III
Tom Vida

Secretary: Warren Stafford

Treatment Facilities

¹Bill Ciccaroni
Alice Heath
Bruce Henry
Darryl Miller
Pat Milligan
Patricia Roy
Jimmy Sell
²Jack Taylor

Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

Trustees

Jeffrey Campbell
Liz Croop
Dave McCallum
Connie McPherson
Carl Mizell
Denny Owen
²Steve Pacheco
Lori Padilla
Michel Pelletier
¹Scott Weiss

Secretary:
Gayle Solheim Riese

³Archives

Terry Coates
Marianne Hawkins
¹Chuck Hood
Don Massey
²Patricia Roy
John Sanders
Mary Swart
Susan Taylor

Secretary: Amy Filiatreau

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Becky Brown
²Amalia Castillo
¹Nancy Gusner
Charlie Hanna
Keith Hashimoto
Pat Long
Michel Pelletier
Mike Sumpter

Co-secretaries:
Rick Walker
Valerie O'Neill

2007 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee Chairperson

Agenda	Eric Knudsen, Oregon
Cooperation With the Professional Community	David Schaffner, Georgia
Corrections	Estelle Grote, South Dakota
Finance	Jamie Wheelless, SW Texas
Grapevine	Glenn Harrison, Mississippi
Literature	John Sanders, Manitoba
Policy/Admissions	John Staebell, Arizona
Public Information	Diane Dixon, NW Texas
Report and Charter	Tom Vida, Western Ontario
Treatment Facilities	Jimmy Sell, So. New Jersey
Trustees	Lori Padilla, New Mexico
¹ International Conv./Regional Forums	Becky Brown, Tennessee
Archives	Mary Swart, SW Ohio

Alternate

Bobbi Padden, Western Massachusetts
Marianne Hawkins, California Northern Interior
Larry Stiff, No. Illinois
Tony Tunison, Idaho
Pat Long, Alberta/Northwest Territories
Michael Sumpter, Kansas
George Master, Delaware
Tito Torres, Puerto Rico
El Nault, South Carolina
Pat Milligan, Wyoming
Denny Owen, Maine
Mike Sumpter, Kansas
Marianne Hawkins, California Northern Interior

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2006 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 56th General Service Conference.

2006 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Herbert Goodman, *chairperson*
 Chuck Barta
 Dorothy Hurley
 Howard Lowery
 Don Miller
 Arnold Ross
 John Skilton
 Michelle Mirza, *secretary*

Audit

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*
 Allen Ault
 Ron Gauthier
 Herb Goodman
 Arnold Ross
 Don Meurer, *secretary*

Conference

Arnold Ross, *chairperson*
 Bill Clark
 Ron Gauthier
 Vince Keefe
 Tom Kraemer
 George Martin
 Murray McIntosh
 John Skilton
 Dorothy Wilson
 Rick Walker, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Alan Ault, *chairperson*
 Chuck Barta
 Bill Clark
 Tom Kraemer
 Bob Pelot
 John Skilton
 *Andy Talbert
 Jane Tolar
 Jeanne Woodford
 Irene Kontje, *secretary* — C.P.C.
 Mary Clare Lynch, *secretary*
 — Treatment Facilities

Corrections

Chuck Barta, *chairperson*
 Allen Ault
 James Branscome
 Paul Cleary
 Don Miller
 *Bill Noonan
 Bob Pelot
 *Bill Thomson
 Jane Tolar
 Jeanne Woodford
 Mary Dargan, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Vince Keefe, *chairperson*
 Paul Cleary
 Herbert Goodman
 Gary Kluksdahl
 Howard Lowery
 Ray Massey
 Mike Perry
 Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
 Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Murray McIntosh, *chairperson*
 Ward Ewing
 Phyllis Halliday
 Vince Keefe
 Tom Kraemer
 George Martin
 Bob Mayer
 Dorothy Wilson
 Doug Richardson, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Ray Massey, *chairperson*
 Herbert Goodman
 Dorothy Hurley
 Howard Lowery
 Bob Mayer
 Don Miller
 Jeanne Woodford
 Rick Walker, *secretary*
 — International Convention
 Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*
 — Regional Forums

Literature

Paul Cleary, *chairperson*
 James Branscome
 Bill Clark
 Dorothy Hurley
 Murray McIntosh
 Ray Massey
 Bob Mayer
 *Ray Reese
 Jane Tolar
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
 Adrienne Brown, *secretary*

Nominating

Phyllis Halliday, *chairperson*
 Allen Ault
 Ward Ewing
 Ron Gauthier
 Gary Kluksdahl
 Mike Perry
 Arnold Ross
 Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

Public Information

Bob Pelot, *chairperson*,
 James Branscome
 Ward Ewing
 *Larry Fennelly
 Ron Gauthier
 Phyllis Halliday
 George Martin
 Dorothy Wilson
 Julio Espallat, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Bill Clark, *chairperson*
 Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."



Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
 Leonard Blumenthal
 First vice-chairperson
 Allen Ault
 Second vice-chairperson
 Herbert Goodman
 Secretary
 Ron Gauthier
 Treasurer
 Vincent Keefe
 Assistant secretary
 Eva Sanchez
 Assistant treasurer
 Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers
 is given on page 12.

*Denotes appointed committee members

**Leonard Blumenthal and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2006 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D. (23205 Hwy 623, Rolly View, Alberta TOC 2KA, Canada) was elected chairman of the board in April 2005, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person.

Allen L. Ault, Ed.D. (College of Justice and Safety, 354 Stratton Bldg., 521 Lancaster Ave., Richmond, KY 40475-3102) was elected a Class A trustee in 2001. Allen is dean of the College of Justice and Safety, University of Eastern Kentucky, Richmond, KY. Prior to this position he served as chief for the National Institute of Corrections in Washington, D.C. During his career, Allen has been a director of corrections for five governors in three states, warden of a maximum security prison, a rehabilitation counselor, director of State Programs for the Mentally Retarded, and president of a national criminal justice consulting firm. Allen chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Audit, Corrections and Nominating Committees.

William D. Clark, M.D. (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School. Bill retired as medical director of the Addiction Resource Center (Brunswick, ME) and was attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Brunswick until 2004. He has taught in medical schools and post-graduate programs (residency), as well as presenting seminars and programs on alcoholism. He serves on the Conference, Literature and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

Ward B. Ewing, D.D. (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. Ward serves on the International, Nominating, and Public Information Committees.

Herbert I. Goodman (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international corporation involved with petroleum products and energy conservation. He chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Audit, International Conventions/Regional Forums and Finance & Budgetary Committees. Herb is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

Vincent E. Keefe (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and currently serves as a director on the boards of seven companies. Vince chairs both the Finance & Budgetary Committee and the Audit Committee. He also serves on the Conference and International Committees.

Jeanne S. Woodford (California Dept. of Corrections and

Rehabilitation, P.O. Box 942883, Sacramento, CA 94283-0001) was elected a Class A trustee in April 2005. Jeanne's background is in criminal justice and she has served in various positions, from correctional counselor to warden, at the California State Prison, San Quentin. She is currently undersecretary, California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation, Sacramento. Jeanne serves on the Corrections, International Conventions/Regional Forums, and Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Charles Barta (1320 43rd St. SE, Cedar Rapids, IA 52403) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2004. A former Panel 51 delegate, Chuck is active in his region and area and in district correctional and treatment facilities meetings. He currently works in the construction industry as an electrician. Chuck chairs the Corrections Committee and serves on the Archives, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Paul E. Cleary (2963 Butler Street, Oceanside, CA 92054) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. Paul started in service work in young people's groups. As a Panel 42 delegate he chaired the 1993 Conference Literature Committee, and was a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board from 2002–2005. A clinical social worker, Paul is currently an account executive for a behavioral healthcare firm. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Corrections Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Ronald Gauthier (81 Lake Drive, South Hamilton, MA 01982) was elected general service trustee in April 2002. A Panel 41 delegate from Eastern Massachusetts, he has served as an A.A.W.S. director for the past seven years. His background is in banking and finance; for over 20 years he has worked as a commercial lender at various banks in the Boston area. Ron serves on the Audit, Conference, Nominating and Public Information Committees.

Phyllis Halliday (P.O. Box 8277, Lacey, WA 98509) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2002. As a Panel 47 delegate, Phyllis chaired the Conference Committee on Trustees. Her professional background is in human resource management and she is an agency Human Resource director for the state of Washington. Phyllis chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the International and Public Information Committees.

Gary Kluksdahl (11187 Tamarron Place, Parker, CO 80138) was elected Southwest regional trustee in May 2003. A former Panel 43 delegate, Gary is active in local, area and regional A.A. He has been in the oil and gas exploration and production industry for 33 years. Gary serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees, and chairs the A.A.W.S. Board.

Tom Kraemer (Box 121, Vibank, Saskatchewan S0G 4Y0, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2004. A Panel 48 delegate, Tom's service background includes longtime involvement with Regina Intergroup. He has served on a number of other A.A. service committees as well. He has been employed by Canada Post Corp. for over 32 years. Tom serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community/

¹ Rotating at the close of the 2006 Conference meeting.

Treatment Facilities and International Committees, and is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Howard Lowery (P.O. Box 684, Columbia, MS 39429) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 42 delegate, Howard is actively involved in his home group, sponsorship, and district and area A.A. activities. He owns and manages a local retail store. Howard serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Archives, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Murray McIntosh (426 Cuyler Street, Thunder Bay, Ontario P7A 1B2, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in May 2003. A Panel 49 delegate from Northwest Ontario, Murray is active in group and area activities. Now retired, he was a professor in human services at a local college. Murray chairs the International Committee and serves on the Literature and Conference Committees.

Raymond Massey (79 Edenwold Place NW, Calgary, AB T3A 3T8, Canada) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 44 delegate, Ray has been involved in Canadian Remote Communities and Young Offenders meetings. He has served as nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He owns and operates a Painting and Decorating Contracting business and is a member of the Alberta Apprenticeship & Industry Training Board. Ray chairs the International Conventions/Regional Forums Committee and serves on the Literature and Finance & Budgetary Committees. He is a member of the Grapevine Board.

Robert Mayer (Box 405, Oak Creek, WI 53154-0405) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2005. A Panel 50 delegate, Bob has been treasurer of the East Central region and is a member of the Areas 74 and 75 Unity Conference Committee. A forester, he is now Forest Fire program manager, Ottawa National Forest. Bob serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums, Literature and International Committees.

Robert Pelot (1020, Louis Ritchie, St-Jérôme, Québec, Canada J5L-1X6) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2002. Bob, a former Panel 46 delegate, is active in his area with remote communities and in correctional service. Now retired, he worked for 25 years for a large corporation in various supervisory positions. Bob chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and Corrections Committees.

Michael D. Perry (11 Mechanic Street, Fair Haven, VT 05743) was elected Northeast regional trustee in May 2003. A Panel 50 delegate, Mike has continued to serve his area as the convention chair on the area committee. He has taught high school biology for over 30 years. Mike serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees, and chairs the Grapevine Board.

Arnold L. Ross (227-G East Northern Parkway, Baltimore, MD 21212) became a general service trustee in May 2003, after having served three years as a nontrustee

director on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board. A former Panel 46 delegate, Arnold is chief of financial administration for a nonprofit organization. Arnold chairs the Committee on the Conference, serves on the Audit, Archives and Nominating Committees and is a director on the Grapevine Board.

Dorothy Wilson (2602 Walker Avenue, Indianapolis, IN 46203) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2005. A Panel 44 delegate, Dorothy had remained active in her group, district, area and region. She has worked with children in a variety of educational programs. Dorothy serves on the Conference, International and Public Information Committees.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2006 Conference

Madeleine Parmley (9242 N. Sunset Dr., Pocatello, ID 83201) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2006. She served as a Panel 52 delegate and has long been active in carrying the message into jails and prisons, and has volunteered as a camp counselor for incarcerated mothers and their children. Madeleine is a trauma care nurse.

Jane T. Sheppard (6850 Rose Rd., Beasley, TX 77417) was elected general service trustee in April 2006. As a Panel 47 delegate Jane chaired the Conference Literature Committee and also served as A.A.W.S. director, 2001-2005. Currently retired, Jane's background as an attorney was in family law.

Denis Vezina (8245 Boul. St-Laurent, apt. 902, Brossard, Québec, Canada J4X 2A6) was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 2006. A Panel 52 delegate from SW Québec, Denis is active in his group and area and was chairman of the Québec Volunteers (bilingual) for the 2005 International Convention. Presently retired, his background was in marine transportation engineering, human resources and information technology.



A.A. World Services Directors

Gary Kluksdahl, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Chuck Barta, *regional trustee*
 Paul Cleary, *general service trustee*
 Ron Gauthier, *general service trustee*

George Martin, *director*
 Don Miller, *director*
 Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 Jane Tolar, *director*
 Eva Sanchez, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Michael Perry, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 James Branscome, *director*
 Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Herbert Goodman, *Class A trustee*

Dorothy Hurley, *director*
 Tom Kraemer, *regional trustee*
 Raymond Massey, *general service trustee*
 Arnold Ross, *general service trustee*
 John Skilton, *director*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *senior adviser to general manager*
 Adrienne Brown
 Mary Dargan
 Julio Espaillet
 Irene Kontje

Mary Clare Lynch
 Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV, director of Internet operations*

Hernán Merea, *La Viña editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Ellie Biscuti, *staff assistant*
 Daniel O. Brown, *desktop/web manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./admin. asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *general office clerk*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish translator*
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*
 Sheila Coppin-Thorn, *staff assistant*
 Lise Cote, *French interpreter*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennen, *staff assistant*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Amy Filiatreau, *archivist*
 Doug Grude, *Japanese interpreter*
 John Hackett, *associate editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*
 Milton McGriff, *GV senior editor*
 Natalya Malamud, *staff assistant*
 Ayleen Martinez, *staff assistant*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Michelle Mirza, *asst. archivist*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Luis Oquendo, *copy room clerk*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Jeanelle Roman, *staff assistant*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Sharisse Seabury, *staff assistant*
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *purchasing supervisor*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeriti

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn
 Elaine McDowell, Phd.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 56th Conference includes Panel 55 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 56 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	55	Cushing Phillips III 319 S. Capital Parkway Montgomery, AL 36107
Alaska	2	56	Richard (Rick) Horstmann HC Box 560H Willow, AK 99688
Arizona	3	56	John Staebell 700 N. Virginia Willcox, AZ 85643
Arkansas	4	55	Pete Roth 615 N. Pine, #1 Little Rock, AR 72205
California Southern	5	55	James (Jim) Whipple 2580 Morningside St. Pasadena, CA 91107
Central	93	55	Vicki Bunnell Box 5583 Montecito, CA 93150
Northern Coastal	6	55	Rafael (Francisco) Almada Box 553 Soquel, CA 95073
Northern Interior	7	56	Marianne Hawkins 310 Rosa Ave. Winters, CA 95694
San Diego/Imperial	8	56	Jerry Clarkson 9970 Mesa Madera Dr. San Diego, CA 92131
Mid-Southern	9	56	Bruce Henry 22420 Ocean Ave., #30 Torrance, CA 90505
Colorado	10	55	Susan Taylor 116 Brewster Ln. Florence, CO 81226
Connecticut	11	55	Amalia Castillo 103 West Hartford Rd. Newington, CT 06111
Delaware	12	56	George Master 237 Landau Way Bear, DE 19701
District of Columbia	13	55	Laura Jackson 29 Franklin St., NE Washington, DC 20002
Florida North	14	55	Michael Scott 3199 Suntree Blvd., #6 Suntree, FL 32955
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I./ Antigua	15	55	Stephen (Steve) Pacheco 24 Palm Haven Dr. Lake Placid, FL 33852
Georgia	16	56	David Schaffner 24 Rose Hill Dr. Savannah, GA 31419
Hawaii	17	55	Keith Hashimoto 232 Thomas St. Wahiawa, HI 96786
Idaho	18	56	Anthony (Tony) Tunison 22658 Caitlin Lane Middleton, ID 83644

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Illinois				Montana	40	55	Scott Weiss 2101 Fairview Pl. Billings, MT 59102
<i>Chicago</i>	19	55	Mark Cruz 5422 N. Menard Chicago, IL 60630	Nebraska	41	56	Charles (Charlie) Hanna 5345 Lillibridge Lincoln, NE 68506
<i>Northern</i>	20	56	Larry Stiff 9913 Forest Lane Union, IL 60180	Nevada	42	55	Joyce Pettitt Box 612317 South Lake Tahoe, CA 96152
<i>Southern</i>	21	55	Carl Mizell 4352 Bohm School Rd. Edwardsville, IL 62025	New Hampshire	43	56	Dale Kendall 17 School Lane Woodsville, NH 03785
Indiana				New Jersey			
<i>Northern</i>	22	55	Meredith (Meri) Ray 208 S. Range St. Wolcott, IN 47995	<i>Northern</i>	44	55	Debbie Temple 86 Mt. Prospect Ave. Belleville, NJ 07109
<i>Southern</i>	23	56	Charles (Chuck) Leck 1816 E. Edgewood Ave. Indianapolis, IN 46227	<i>Southern</i>	45	56	Jimmy Sell 19 E. Pine St. Audubon, NJ 08106
Iowa	24	55	Terry Coates 12801 Rte. 52 N Dubuque, IA 52002	New Mexico	46	56	Lori Padilla 62 Isleta Dr. Los Alamos, NM 87544
Kansas	25	56	Michael (Mike) Sumpter 5928 N.W. Brickyard Rd. Topeka, KS 66618	New York			
Kentucky	26	56	Darryl Miller 409 Depot St. Greensburg, KY 42743	<i>Central</i>	47	55	Elizabeth (Liz) Croop 212 Groton Ave. Cortland, NY 13045
Louisiana	27	55	Donald (Don) Massey 3928 Uri St. Metairie, LA 70002	<i>Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire</i>	48	56	Robert (Bobby) Fryer 15 Deerfield Place Ballston Spa, NY 12020
Maine	28	56	Denny Owen Box 153 Morrill, ME 04952-0153	<i>Southeast</i>	49	55	William (Bill) Ciccaroni 103 Mt. Joy Ave. Freeport, NY 11520
Maryland	29	56	Barbara Bolt 7464 Players Blvd. Seven Valleys, PA 17360	<i>Western</i>	50	56	Bruce Akin 10 Juliet St. Jamestown, NY 14701
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	55	Dick Frohock Box 777 Reidsville, NC 27323-0777
<i>Eastern</i>	30	55	Nancy Poillucci 7 Pinebrook Lane, #1 South Easton, MA 02375	North Dakota	52	55	Michael (Mike) Nelson 4720 County Rd., 15 West Minot, ND 58703
<i>Western</i>	31	56	Roberta (Bobbi) Padden 26 S. Winthrop St. Chicopee, MA 01020	Ohio			
Michigan				<i>Central Southeast</i>	53	55	Madeline Humphreys 3405 Wicklow Rd. Columbus, OH 43204
<i>Central</i>	32	55	Jesse Perry 3219 Old Farm Rd. Flint, MI 48507	<i>Northeast</i>	54	55	Alice Heath 6245 New London Rd. Ashtabula, OH 44004
<i>Southeast</i>	33	55	Eugene (Gene) Kroll 3565 Port Cove Dr., Unit 69 Waterford, MI 48328	<i>NW Ohio/SE Mich.</i>	55	56	Kelly Carew 878 Quigley St. Holland, OH 43528
<i>Western</i>	34	56	Charles (Chuck) Walters 67101 N. M66 Sturgis, MI 49091	<i>Southwest</i>	56	56	Mary Swart 241 Loraine Ave., #2 Cincinnati, OH 45220
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	55	Jack Taylor 17330 N. 129th E. Ave. Collinsville, OK 74021
<i>Northern</i>	35	56	Gerald (Jerry) Saari 5917 Long Lake Rd. Makinen, MN 55763	Oregon	58	56	Eric Knudsen 2324 SW Mitchell St. Portland, OR 97239
<i>Southern</i>	36	55	Mark Miller 2815 Zanzibar Lane N. Plymouth, MN 55447	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	56	Glenn Harrison 1220 Meadowood Rd. Columbia, MS 39429	<i>Eastern</i>	59	55	J. Gary Lutz 2210 13th St. Bethlehem, PA 18020
Missouri				<i>Western</i>	60	55	Charles (Chuck) Hood 611 Water St. Warren, PA 16365-1313
<i>Eastern</i>	38	55	Thomas (Chip) Berkley 19300 Hwy 63S Hartsburg, MO 65039				
<i>Western</i>	39	55	Rondell Miller 1345 E. Burntwood Springfield, MO 65803				

State	Area no.	Panel	
Rhode Island	61	56	Jorge Flores 74 Lenox Ave. Providence, RI 02907
South Carolina	62	56	Eleanor (El) Nault 588 Crowe Mountain Rd. Walhalla, SC 29691
South Dakota	63	56	Estelle Grote Box 1162 Aberdeen, SD 57402
Tennessee	64	56	Rebecca (Becky) Brown 204 Nancy Lane Clinton, TN 37716
Texas			
Northeast	65	55	Naomi Zeiller 616 Frontier Court Colleyville, TX 76034
Northwest	66	56	Diane Dixon Box 60042 Midland, TX 79711
Southeast	67	55	Charles Pederson 708 S. Second St. Nederland, TX 77627
Southwest	68	56	Jamie Wheelless 12603 Silver Spur Austin, TX 78727-4346
Utah	69	55	Michael (Mike) Ohlson Box 701045 West Valley City, UT 84170
Vermont	70	56	Rebecca (Becky) Collette 675 Route 4A Castletown, VT 05735
Virginia	71	55	Gail Lee 706 Maupin Pl. Williamsburg, VA 23185
Washington			
State East	92	56	David (Dave) McCallum 618 East 17th Ave. Spokane, WA 99203
Western	72	55	Richard (Dick) Donahue 12 Bellwether Way, #110 Bellingham, WA 98225
West Virginia	73	55	Alan (Al) Siebel 2010 S. Seventh St. Ironton, OH 45638
Wisconsin			
No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI	74	56	Jeffrey (Jeff) Campbell 4095 Cherry Rd. Sturgeon Bay, WI 54235
Southern	75	55	Nancy Gusner 4204 Jerome St. Madison, WI 53716
Wyoming	76	56	Patrick (Pat) Milligan Box 2661 Jackson, WY 83001
Puerto Rico	77	56	Alberto Luis (Tito) Torres Box 372 Aguadilla, PR 00605-0372

CANADA

Province	Area no.	Panel	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	56	Patricia (Pat) Long 8203-149 St. Edmonton, AB T5R 1B1
B.C./Yukon	79	55	Connie McPherson 2615 Keats Ave. Campbell River, BC V9H 1R8
Manitoba	80	56	John Sanders 162 Parkville Dr. Winnipeg, MB R2J 2J1
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	56	Adrien Gionet 27 rue La Croix Caraquet, NB E1W 1B6
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	55	*Una Healey 101 Elizabeth Dr. Gander, NL A1V 1G8
Ontario			
Eastern	83	55	Barbara (Barb) Kelly 752 Skyline Rd. RR #1 Oakwood, ON KOM 2M0
Northeast	84	55	Francyne (Fran) Bigras-Galipeau c/o Trendsetter 109 Elm St. Sudbury, ON P3C 1T4
Northwest	85	55	Reiner Rehbein Box 781 Keewatin, ON P0X 1C0
Western	86	56	Thomas (Tom) Vida 105-780 Elm St. Port Colborne, ON L3K 4R4
Quebec			
Southwest	87	56	Luc Rainville 5055, boul. Laurier St-Hyacinthe, PQ J2S 3V4
Southeast	88	55	Patricia Roy 771, 25e Avenue St-Prospier, PQ G0M 1Y0
Northeast	89	55	Michel Pelletier 585 Bon Pasteur, Apt. 201 Québec, PQ G1R 5J2
Northwest	90	56	Lynda Bergeron 197 Hector Lanthier #5 Saint Eustache, PQ J7P 1Z8
Saskatchewan	91	56	John Fraser Box 171 Colonsay, SK S0K 0Z0

